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OMARA VENTURES INDIA LIMITED operates the OMARA jewellery brand and is engaged in the curation and marketing of fine jewellery comprising natural diamonds, precious gemstones and precious metals. The Company serves its clientele through its flagship boutique in Sector 9-C, Madhya Marg, Chandigarh, and its digital platforms. The Company undertakes design development, product curation, material selection, quality control and client relationship management in-house, with a focus on design-led fine jewellery and personalised client experience.

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‘Completely broken’: Vance calls for end to H-1B visa programme

WASHINGTON, OCTOBER 2 US Vice-President JD Vance has branded the H-1B visa programme as “completely broken”, indicating he would back its total abolition on the grounds that corporations exploit the framework to substitute American personnel with cheaper international staff.

Sharing his stance via a video on the social media platform X, Vance asserted that the system had been “totally taken advantage of” across technology firms, accounting practices and various other sectors. He drew a distinct line between recruiting elite international talent and utilising H-1B permits merely to cut labour expenditures.

“If you’re going to bring in an accountant making \$45,000 a year to replace an accountant who is an American making \$60,000 a year, that’s not you using the programme to bring in a genius,” Vance said. “That’s you destroying American jobs and defrauding the American people,” he said.

New York Governor removes DA probing Cornell rape case

New York’s Governor Kathy Hochul appointed a special prosecutor on Thursday to oversee an investigation into a woman’s allegations that she was gangraped at a Cornell University fraternity house, saying she had lost faith in the local district attorney’s ability to handle the case.

Hochul said she had signed an executive order appointing the office of New York Attorney General Letitia James as the special prosecutor to oversee the investigation, which had initially been closed without charges in 2024. AP

Furthermore, Vance defended the White House’s controversial \$100,000 levy applied to certain H-1B petitions. — ANI

Will hit Iran ‘very hard’ if linked to flydubai attack, warns Trump

Guterres condemns incident | Israel to question Omani co-pilot

JERUSALEM, OCTOBER 2 US President Trump on Thursday said if Iran was linked to the co-pilot who tried to crash an Israel-bound flight, the Islamic Republic would be struck “very hard” for the attempt on the lives of more than 180 people aboard the jet.

Trump issued the warning as investigators worked to determine why the co-pilot stabbed the flight’s captain, causing the flydubai plane to plummet before others on board stopped the attack and landed the airliner in Saudi Arabia.

He was asked by mediapersons whether he had been briefed about any links between the pilot behind the attack and Tehran. He said, “We’re working on it right now. I would say the answer, based on what I’m hearing, is yes, but we’re working on it right now,” Trump said.

Asked if the US would retaliate against Tehran if it was behind the attack, Trump said, “Oh they’ll be hit, very hard, don’t worry. You just ask



US President Donald Trump at a midterm election rally in Oklahoma.

JAY CLAYTON LIKELY TO BE AI CZAR

■ US President Trump was expected to name Jay Clayton as his AI czar, CNN reported on Friday. Clayton is the US Director of National Intelligence. Last month, he said he planned to appoint an AI adviser, known as an “AI czar”, and create an “AI force”.

them,” he added. “They know what happened. They’ll be hit very hard.”

Meanwhile, Israel is expected

to question the co-pilot. The co-pilot was transferred on Thursday to the UAE, where sources said Israeli officials were

Claims Tehran war will end very quickly

US President Donald Trump has said the war with Iran will conclude “very quickly” and forecast a sharp decline in oil prices once the hostilities ceased, depicting Iran as degraded both economically and militarily.

“Iran will very soon be ending one way or the other,” he said. “It’ll either just say, look, they have 301 per cent inflation. They have no money, they have no currency. And, one way or the other, it’s going to end very quickly. And when that ends, oil prices are going to drop like a rock,” he stated. ANI

expected to question him. UN Secretary-General Guterres has also expressed deep concern over the incident. — AP

Cops, students clash as France struggles to quell school protests

PARIS, OCTOBER 2 The riot police clashed with high school students across France on Friday and unions called for teachers to strike as President Emmanuel Macron’s government battled to contain increasingly violent protests over classroom conditions and funding.

Tear gas clouded the streets in the eastern city of Strasbourg, fireworks were aimed at police lines in Marseille in the south and rubbish bins set ablaze in Rennes in the west.

Protesters in Pantin, on the outskirts of Paris, set items including fences on fire and threw firecrackers at the riot police, before running away.

After a government crisis meeting on Thursday, a source said the demonstrations had morphed from a protest movement to urban violence, and Justice Minister Gerald Darmanin said it had been hijacked by “outsiders”. Education Minister Geffray said 65 education staff had been hurt during the unrest, including 40 head teachers. — Reuters

Eiffel probe finds ‘no proof’ of Hindu group asking for removal of women employees

A Hindu group has said investigations have established it did not request female employees be “hidden, removed or excluded” during its delegation’s visit to the Eiffel Tower in Paris.

This came after Eiffel Tower staff went on strike last month over allegations that female employees were moved away during a visit by around 100 people associated with BAPS (Bochasanwasi Akshar Purushottam) Swaminarayan Sanstha. The strike triggered a day-long closure of the iconic monument located in the Paris. BAPS Paris said, “From the outset, BAPS has consistently stated that it never asked for female employees to be hidden, removed or excluded.” PTI

G7 nations to release 100 mn barrels of oil as Trump seeks to ease diesel prices

WASHINGTON, OCTOBER 2 The Group of Seven industrial nations said they agreed to release 100 million barrels of oil, starting with “substantial” amounts of diesel after the fuel recently hit record high prices in the United States, where President Donald Trump said the diesel release would happen “immediately”. Trump and his Republican Party face pressure to address surging prices ahead of November’s midterm elections.

REPUBLICANS’ TEXAS CAMPAIGN BEGINS

■ US President Trump began a 32-day campaign blitz on Thursday with stops in Texas and Oklahoma, aiming to bolster Republican candidates as his party fights to hold onto its slim congressional majorities in November’s midterm elections.

Trump announced the action Friday on social media, saying, “Europe has just

agreed to release a massive amount of their heavily stocked diesel oil. The process will begin immediately.”

He faces lagging approval ratings as the Iran war and his trade battles have increased US prices for oil and other goods. Gas prices in the US and abroad have soared during the eight-month-long war, a cost Trump has repeatedly said was worth it for making sure Iran did not obtain nuclear weapons. — AP

Pak govt meets Imran party leaders to defuse tensions ahead of march

ISLAMABAD, OCTOBER 2 The federal government and leaders of the Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf party of jailed former PM Imran Khan held talks on Friday to defuse political tensions ahead of the Opposition party’s planned long march to Islamabad.

The developments come a week after the party announced that its long march to Islamabad would start on October 4, postpon-



Jailed Pakistan ex-PM Imran Khan

ing it by a week. The negotiations were being held in the chamber of National

Assembly Speaker Sardar Ayaz Sadiq, who is facilitating the dialogue between the two sides.

Party’s international spokesman Zulfiqar Bukhari said the government was holding talks with the party. He said the party’s key demands included an “immediate” meeting with Khan and a decision to take him to a hospital where his personal doctors could examine him. — PTI



A student holds a board reading, “We want the BAC (high school diploma), not the BAC (anti-criminality units)”, during a protest in Lille.

BUSINESS

USD \$	EURO €	POUND £	JPY ¥	YUAN ¥	CAD C\$	AUD A\$	SGD S\$	HKD HK\$
₹96.22	₹108.42	₹127.37	₹0.61	₹14.37	₹67.56	₹66.94	₹75.29	₹12.28



BSE	NSE	GOLD	SILVER
570.59 71,909.70	198.50 22,421.95	₹147,770 Mumbai	₹221,443 Mumbai

IPO fundraising hits record ₹94.2K cr in H1, NSE leads surge

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Fundraising via primary board initial public offerings (IPOs) achieved a record Rs 94,205 crore in the initial half (H1) of financial year (FY) 2027, driven by a surge in large-ticket issues such as the Rs 22,563-crore offering from the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE), as per data from Prime Database.

A total of 78 companies accessed the main board from April to September, raising 35 per cent more than the Rs 69,533 crore gathered by 65 IPOs in the same timeframe of FY26. The latest figure represents the highest first-half IPO activity ever recorded, even with a slow beginning to the financial year and fluctuations in the secondary market.

India-US trade deal not imminent: Greer

ADITYA RANGROO
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer announced that the India-US trade agreement was close to finalising negotiations, but he cautioned that there was nothing “imminent” while both sides address a specific list of remaining issues.

Greer stated that US President Donald Trump and Prime Minister Narendra Modi might have another conversation “very soon” to assess the advancements in the discussions. “I would describe it, as we say in the US, we’re in the final stages. I believe we’re nearing the conclusion,” Greer remarked during a press conference after the G20 Trade Ministers’ Meeting in Milwaukee on Thursday.

“Simultaneously, I don’t



US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer

believe anything is imminent, but we have indeed recognised the range of items that are obstacles. We’re putting in a lot of effort to achieve them,” he mentioned.

On Thursday, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal and Greer had engaged in a “constructive conversation” regarding the progress on an interim trade agreement between India and the United States.

At G20, Goyal calls for WTO-compliant approach to fix global trade distortions

Holds bilateral talks with ministers of France, Canada, Saudi, S Korea

ADITYA RANGROO
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Union Minister of Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal on Friday said India’s manufacturing capacity served its domestic and global needs and that, in the sectors identified by the G20 Presidency, India did not have structural excess capacity.

He called for a World Trade Organization-compliant approach to tackle trade distortions during his address on the concluding day of the G20 Trade Ministers’ Meeting in Milwaukee, Wisconsin.

Goyal said India shared the concerns of many members that trade-distorting support in some economies could lead to dumping and predatory pricing.



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal with Australia’s Trade Minister Don Farrell in Milwaukee, Wisconsin. ANI

ing. He said such concerns were addressed through WTO-consistent measures, including anti-dumping and countervailing duties, based on evidence and subject to judicial review.

He emphasised that indus-

trial capacity in itself was not the issue, while distortions could arise where geographical concentration of production was driven by hidden subsidies and support.

He said diversification of pro-

Banks incurred \$500 mn forex ‘losses’ after RBI’s position curbs

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Indian banks faced approximately \$500 million in market-to-market losses on their foreign exchange (FX) trading portfolios during the first half of 2026, following regulatory changes by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) that compelled lenders to close out positions, as per the research by Crisil Coalition Greenwich.

The research indicated that banks later regained approximately \$400 million of the losses as market spreads expanded and positions returned to normal. The losses came after the RBI issued a directive on March 27, limiting authorised dealer banks’ end-of-day net open positions in onshore rupees to \$100 million.

duction and supply chains was a legitimate objective, but could not be used as a pretext for measures outside WTO rules or for shifting the burden of adjustment onto developing countries, which must retain policy space to industrialise. He also said sharing of statistics and data should take place within existing mechanisms.

He emphasised that consensus remains central to the WTO and that special and differential treatment must be preserved to enable developing countries to catch up with developed economies.

Goyal also met his counterparts from France, Canada, Saudi Arabia and South Korea and discussed furthering bilateral trade relations with the respective countries.

Meta smart glasses in eye of storm over privacy concerns

AMSTERDAM, OCTOBER 2 Privacy concerns surrounding Meta’s Ray-Ban smart glasses intensified on Friday after one of the largest Dutch eyewear retail chains suspended sales of the device in the Netherlands and Belgium, marking one of the first such moves by a retailer.

“The decision follows the ongoing public and political debate surrounding smart glasses and the questions being raised about the conditions under which this technology can be used,” a spokesperson for the Hans Anders chain



said.

A growing Dutch outcry over the glasses mirrors a broader backlash against smart glasses equipped with cameras.

In Britain, pub chain Wetherspoon has restricted use of Meta’s glasses over concerns about covert recording, while Meta and Luxottica face a US

suit alleging videos captured by the glasses were viewed by human annotators without the knowledge of people filmed.

A Meta spokesperson said the company was continuing to develop the popular glasses. “Every pair with a camera has a bright light on the front that blinks when you take a photo

or video - it can’t be turned off, and the camera is disabled if someone covers or tampers with it,” they said.

In the Netherlands, privacy regulator AP warned that videos made with smart glasses showing identifiable people could not generally be shared or published without their permission,

which would be difficult to obtain in a public place.

Consumer rights group Consumentenbond this week said it would take Meta to court unless the company changes the glasses to comply with privacy law. Offlimits, a group that combats online abuse, on Friday also urged Meta and Ray-Ban owner EssilorLuxottica to voluntarily remove the glasses from sale until a way could be found to make surreptitious recordings impossible. EssilorLuxottica could not immediately be reached for comment. — Reuters

MUMBAI, OCTOBER 2 Candidate integrity risks in recruitment are becoming increasingly complex during the evaluation stage, with a growing number of applicants using AI to manipulate assessments and interviews, according to a report.

Cheating in assessments rose to 45 per cent in 2025-26 from 32 per cent in 2021-22, meaning nearly one in two assessments in the latest year showed an integrity concern, recruitment platform HirePro’s report —

Assessment cheating rises to 45%, recruiters grapple with AI abuse

■ Hiring for artificial intelligence and machine learning (AI/ML) roles grew 20% YoY in September even as overall white-collar hiring remained largely steady, pointing to a continued shift in demand towards specialised skills and experienced professionals, according to the Naukri JobSpeak report.

Candidate Integrity in Job Assessments and Interviews-2026 — has revealed.

Interview-related cases also rose to 2.5 per cent in FY26 from 1.4 per cent in FY22, it added. HirePro’s report is based on an analysis of an annual sample of around 1 million assessments and 1,00,000 interviews between FY21 and FY26, supplemented by industry expert input. It revealed a significant shift in how candidates engage in malpractice during assessments and interviews. In assessments, external assistance remains the largest category at 43 per cent of cases in 2025-26. — PTI



NEED TO CLEAR STOCKS BEFORE PADDY ARRIVAL: MANN >> PUNJAB



VANDE TRAIN CROSSES CHENAB, ANJLI BRIDGES AT 100 KMPH >> J&K



A BEFITTING END TO THE DRISHYAM TRIQUEL >> REVIEW

PUTIN PRAISES MODI'S UKRAINE PEACE PUSH >> BACK PAGE



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SATURDAY | 3 OCTOBER 2026



Indian players after winning the gold medal in the women's hockey final, defeating China 1-0 at the Asian Games 2026 in Japan. PTI

Women hockey gold ends 44-yr drought

INDIEVIR GREWAL
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 2

The Indian women's hockey team ended a 44-year wait for an Asian Games gold medal with a gritty 1-0 win against defending champions China in the final at Kakamigahara, Japan, on Friday. The title win in the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games also sealed India's spot in the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

Senior forward Lahremisami's reverse-stick strike in the 10th minute proved to be

Secure berth in the Los Angeles Olympics

the difference between the two sides after India's defence stood firm to protect their lead for 50 minutes in a high-pressure game. While veteran goalkeeper Savita Punia played her part by saving a penalty stroke in the second quarter, her young understudy Bichu Devi also made some crucial saves.

"I always tell the girls that the basics are good defending, disci-

pline and keeping on running," coach Sjoerd Marjine said. "You saw some players come off the pitch tired, and then the next one came, and the next one. That is how you win these matches," he added.

India's previous gold medal came in the 1982 New Delhi Games, when women's hockey was first introduced in the continental event. Since then, India have

remained among the top-four, collecting two silver and four bronze medals. But they could not clear the final hurdle, suffering close defeats in the finals in 1998 and 2018.

The team of 2026, though, was determined to change the colour of the medal. India made an aggressive start, trying to catch the higher-ranked China off guard. They were rewarded when Lahremisami, playing in her 200th game for India, received a pass in the semicircle. In a flash, the 26-year-old

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8

Couldn't let anyone die, flydubai pilot tells Modi

Says opened cockpit door despite continuous attack

ADITI TANDON
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

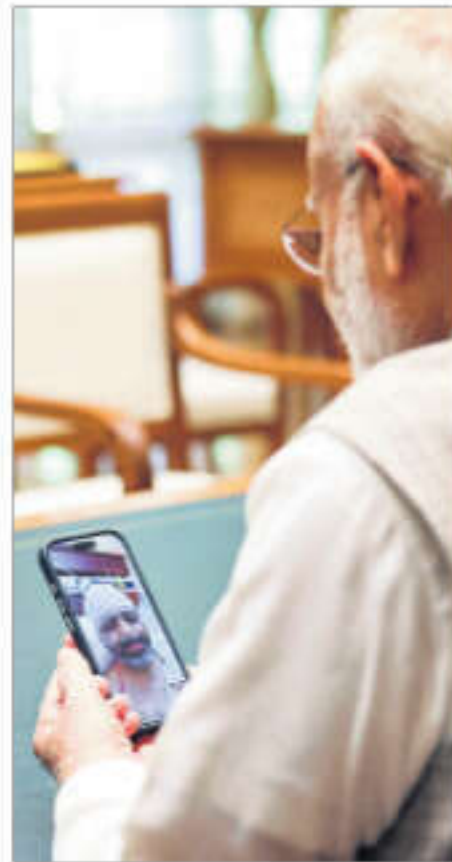
NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

Making his first public appearance since helping save 180 passengers and crew aboard a flydubai flight on Wednesday, Indian pilot Capt Smit Machchhar said he was injured but could not have let others die.

In a video call with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday, Machchhar said he was lying on the floor and still under attack when he realised the plane was losing altitude and he had only seconds to act and save lives.

Machchhar was stabbed by his Omani co-pilot, who attempted to crash the Dubai-Tel Aviv flight on Wednesday. Despite his injuries, he managed to force open the cockpit door, allowing other passengers to enter. Together, they overpowered the perpetrator and regained control of the situation.

"You have shown the world that Indians do not take lives, they save lives. Everyone in the world wants to speak to you. Today is Gandhi Jayanti and you have lived and demonstrated the true essence of non-violence," PM Modi told Machchhar, who spoke from



PM Narendra Modi speaks to Capt Smit Machchhar, pilot of the flydubai flight, on Friday. ANI

GUTERRES SLAMS ATTACK

UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres voiced deep concern after the Indian pilot was seriously injured while allegedly preventing his co-pilot from crashing a flydubai aircraft.

his hospital bed in Abu Dhabi.

Flight FZ1073 plunged more than 17,000 feet about two-and-a-half hours into the journey and sent emergency signals to

air traffic control before transmitting a hijack code. Machchhar told the Prime Minister that he was continuously reciting Hanuman Chalisa while battling his injuries and taking life-saving decisions.

"I have been a pilot for 17 years. While I was on the floor after the attack, I knew the plane was going down and I had to act to save lives. So I made one last push to open the cockpit door from inside. Then others came in and they too played a role in saving the passengers. I was fighting for my own life, but I knew I would not let others die," Machchhar said.

The Prime Minister hailed his courage and also praised the resilience of his parents and wife Sonal, with whom he also spoke.

PM Modi also conversed with Machchhar in Gujarati and said shrines across India were holding prayers for his recovery and long life. The Somnath and Kashi Vishwanath temples, two of the 12 Jyotirlingas, began elaborate rituals for Machchhar on Thursday, with more temples joining the effort on Friday. The Prime Minister praised the pilot's bravery and said

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8

Special EC drive to enrol left-out voters

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission has directed all chief electoral officers to conduct a special drive for the enrolment of left-out and first-time voters. The directive comes amid criticism of the poll panel over the deletion of around 13 crore names in 20 states and UTs where the special intensive revision of electoral rolls has been completed. **INSIDE**

2 Pak intruders shot dead by BSF along IB

FEROZEPUR: Two Pakistani intruders were killed by BSF troops near the Rajoke border outpost along the India-Pakistan border on Friday. At around 11.40 am, troops spotted three intruders crossing into Indian territory ahead of the barbed-wire fence and opened fire as they advanced further. **INSIDE**

HP bridge collapse kills one, injures 4

HAMIRPUR: One labourer was killed and four others injured, two of them seriously, when an under-construction bridge on the Shimla-Matour four-lane highway collapsed over Hathali Khud near Hamirpur on Friday. Eight labourers were reportedly working at the site when the incident occurred. **INSIDE**

Cong banks on 3-time MLA Pargat to dribble Pb affairs ahead of poll

ADITI TANDON & RAJMEET SINGH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI/CHANDIGARH, OCT 2 Former Punjab Sports Minister Pargat Singh was today appointed the new president of the state Congress hours after Ludhiana MP Amrinder Singh Raja Warring put in his papers after meeting Rahul Gandhi.

A Padma Shri and Arjuna awardee, Pargat is a former captain of the Indian hockey team.

A three-time MLA from Jalandhar Cantt and former Education and Sports Minister, Punjab, Pargat (61) is learnt to have been strongly backed by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge.

The Congress, which, sources said, mulled appointing Hindu face Vijay Inder Singla as the state chief, ultimately settled for a Jat Sikh face to replace Warring, also from the community. The party also settled for a state leader



Pargat Singh

to steer the Punjab unit instead of a Lok Sabha MP.

Insiders said the decision was taken considering ground realities wherein current state politics is revolving around the politically influential Jat Sikh community, with the BJP also appointing Kewal Dhillon from the community as the state president and AAP defending its term under Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, also from the segment.

Pargat faces the task of taking along a largely fractious Punjab Congress unit where several leaders are harbouring chief ministerial ambitions.

His appointment appears to be both a tactical move and ideological shift by the Congress high command ahead of the 2027 Assembly elections. His elevation is significant given his unique political journey — from an international hockey player to

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8

4-GOLD HAUL BY HARYANA PLAYERS

DEEPENDER DESWAL
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

HISAR, OCTOBER 2

It was a day that belonged to Haryana at the Asian Games in Nagoya, Japan, as athletes from the state seemed unstoppable, winning four gold medals, including two in boxing and one each in wrestling and archery.

The first gold came in the morning when 20-year-old Kirti Sharma, who hails from Ritoli village in Jind district, helped the Indian women's recurve team defeat South Korea 5-3 in the final. Kirti, along with Ankita Bhakat and Kumkum Mohod, won India's first Asian Games gold in women's team recurve archery.

Then came Haryana's first boxing gold of the day, as Parveen Hooda from Rurki village in Rohtak district won the women's 65 kg title. She defeated Chinese Taipei's former world champion Chen Nien-chin 3-2 in an intensely fought final. She comes from a farming family where her mother, Neelam Devi, is the sole breadwinner, earning a living by selling milk. Her father, Lakshpat Hooda, who is battling cancer, has been a major source of support in her sporting journey.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8



KIRTI SHARMA ARCHERY (WOMEN'S RECURVE TEAM)



PARVEEN HOODA BOXING (WOMEN'S 65KG)

ANKUSH PANGHAL BOXING (MEN'S 80KG)



SUJEET KALKAL WRESTLING (MEN'S 65KG)

LOVLINA WINS GOLD IN WOMEN (75KG) BOXING | NEERU TO BE FLAG-BEARER AT CLOSING EVENT

Indian hockey official sent back from Japan over 'misconduct'

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

JALANDHAR, OCTOBER 2

Amid an impressive performance by Indian athletes at the Asian Games in Japan, hockey umpire and technical official Gurinder Singh Sangha has reportedly been sent back following allegations of misconduct and sexual harassment during the event.

Sangha was appointed as an umpire by the Asian Hockey Federation for the games. The allegations and the circumstances surrounding his departure could not be verified.

Hockey Punjab president Nitin Kohli said he was aware of the reports and was verifying the information. Sangha, meanwhile, has denied the allegations. He said there had been disagreements at the start of the games and that he had already indicated this would be his last event.

This is not the first time such a complaint has been made against Sangha. During the Hockey India League in Ranchi in 2025, a female umpire lodged a complaint against him. However, a three-member panel did not find sufficient evidence against him. (With PTI inputs)



A juvenile atop a MIG-23 aircraft displayed at the LPU, Phagwara. FILE

Juvenile among 9 held in LPU case; 2 nabbed over Chitkara unrest

APARNA BANERJI & AMAN SOOD
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

JALANDHAR/PATIALA, OCTOBER 2 Nine persons, including a juvenile who climbed atop a MiG-23, have been arrested for arson and vandalism during protests at Lovely Professional University (LPU) in Phagwara, near Jalandhar, on September 27 and 28.

Two persons have also been arrested in connection with the student unrest at Chitkara University in Rajpura, Patiala, on the intervening night of September 25-26.

In the LPU case, those arrested have been identified as university students James Dahiya (Sonapat), Ashutosh (Uttar Pradesh), Antriksh Dutta and Sahil Singh (Jammu), and Krishna Kumar and Bhavishya Karan (Maharashtra), along with two outsiders, Gagandeep and Jasmeet Kumar, who worked as pizza delivery boys in Phagwara.

The juvenile, whose image atop a MiG-23 at LPU became the face of the protest, hails from Mandi in Himachal Pradesh.

The police have so far identified 40 accused, including social media influencer Farhat Dev, a BBA student at LPU. With 21,000 Instagram followers, Farhat went viral during the protest. He is yet to be arrested.

PROBE LINK: HC

The Punjab and Haryana High Court has asked the state if there was a possible connection between "false information" circulated on social media about Chitkara University and LPU.

Speaking to mediapersons, DIG, Jalandhar Range, Naveen Singla said: "As many as 20 persons have been nominated in two FIRs registered in Kapurthala and Phagwara on September 28. The special investigation team has formed multiple teams and scanned digital evidence from social media, news channels and CCTV footage from LPU, among other sources. The accused have been found involved in arson, rioting, robbery, unprovoked attacks on police personnel, blocking the national highway and ransacking LPU infrastructure. Some students posed as protesters and later engaged in arson."

The DIG said, "Several accused are from the Law Gate area outside LPU, where an entire ecosystem of alumni, traders, PG accommodations, rental units and dealers exists."

He said the investigation was being carried out simultaneously in the rape case registered at the Satnampura police station in Kapurthala, the

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8



ANTI-CEC PROTESTS IN DELHI, MUMBAI

Opposition parties and student organisations took to the streets in the national capital and Mumbai seeking the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar on Gandhi Jayanti. Nearly 700 protesters were detained in Delhi as CJP's Abhijeet Dipke led protesters at Mumbai's Shivaji Park. **INSIDE**

AJAY BANERJEE
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

India on Friday formally named several natural features like lakes and peaks in Ladakh, including those across the disputed Line of Actual Control (LAC) in Aksai Chin.

The move marks the first time India has assigned official names to geographical features in Aksai Chin, which has been under Chinese control since the 1950s. Many of the new names have Tibetan linguistic roots, while several historical place names linked to the erst-

while Kashgar region, now part of China's Xinjiang, have been retained.

A Ministry of External Affairs publication titled Chinese Aggression, released in 1963, carried maps showing the loss of Aksai Chin. "China in 1957, surreptitiously cleared a motor road across the uninhabited Aksai Chin area of Ladakh," the document states.

Aksai Chin forms the north-eastern edge of the Union Territory of Ladakh. The 832-km LAC in eastern Ladakh remains disputed, with overlapping territorial claims by India and China. The Union

First such move; several labels have Tibetan roots

Ministry of Home Affairs recently released a list of 28 newly designated names and appended a high-resolution map of Ladakh. The ministry said the "standard place and feature names" have been incorporated into official Survey of India maps.

"Identifying them formally on the Survey of India map is aimed at facilitating their accurate recognition and better awareness among the public at large," the ministry said.

Among the newly named features is Guru Rinpoche Lake, located east of China's G219 highway. A location along the same highway has been designated Kumarayana Point. The G219 highway, which connects Tibet and Xinjiang and runs through the cold desert of Aksai Chin, is a key military artery for the People's Liberation Army (PLA).

Other additions to the Survey of India maps include Dehra Compass, near Cho La. Two peaks in the Lingzi Tang mountain range, which cuts across the Aksai Chin plateau, have been named

Atisha Gir Peak and Sakyasri Peak, while another peak farther east has been designated Rinchen Zangpo Peak.

A mountain range west of the G219 highway has been named Drak Karpo. Another high mountain located across the LAC near the Dipsang Plains has been designated Mahesvara Ri, with "Ri" meaning peak in Tibetan. East of the Karakoram Pass, which marks the boundary between India and China, New Delhi has named a location Brangsa, situated across the LAC and close to the Ladakh-Xinjiang boundary.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8

CM Saini goes incognito, calls up residents flagging civic issues on X

Puts in place parallel monitoring system to check compliance in Gurugram

SUMEDHA SHARMA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

GURUGRAM, OCTOBER 2 Refusing to leave Gurugram’s infrastructure to officials alone, CM Nayab Singh Saini has started his own parallel monitoring system to check compliance, sources said.

The CM has been calling up residents who post civic complaints on X and verifying their accounts with officials, the sources said. The disclosure came at a review meeting with senior officials on Friday. Saini does not reveal his identity on these calls. He asks what the problem is and whether it has been resolved. Later, he counter-checks the response with the officials concerned. Many residents have received such calls and presume they are from CM Win-



CM Nayab Saini addresses a meeting in Gurugram on Friday.

dow, sources said.

Saini told officials that he could no longer depend on official feedback. Despite repeated assurances that all was well, people were turning to social media with basic issues that could be resolved

within hours. It had also been brought to his notice that officials were misleading him with action taken reports while residents suffered on the ground.

The CM has trusted persons who analyse the on-

ground situation and submit reports to him.

Sources close to him said he has drawn inspiration from ‘Chanakyaniti’, which stresses direct monitoring in governance. The message to the bureaucracy is clear: action taken reports will be tested against what residents say.

At the meeting, he made it plain there would be “no compromise” on infrastructure, sanitation and civic quality. He asked officials to chalk out clear deliverables with fixed timelines. A vague “we will do it” won’t work.

Industries Minister Rao Narbir Singh, Chief Principal Secretary to CM Rajesh Khullar, Principal Adviser (Urban Development) DS Dhesi, GMDA CEO PC Meena, and MCG Commis-

sioner Pradeep Dahiya were among those present.

The city has barely emerged from waterlogging, and winter brings a fresh test: air pollution. Saini wants it tackled head-on. He also called construction and demolition (C&D) waste a serious challenge and asked that officials’ accountability be linked to their ACRs. Vehicles bringing waste from Delhi into Gurugram are to be impounded and fined heavily.

“Gurugram is the face of Haryana. While the instructions are for the entire state, the government will have zero tolerance for civic lapses in the city. We will attach deadlines to the deliverables, executable plans have to be drawn up, and they have to be carried out,” the CM said.

₹55 cr dues pending, millers refuse to take up CMR work

SHIV KUMAR SHARMA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

YAMUNANAGAR, OCTOBER 2 Rice millers in Yamunanagar have decided not to undertake custom-milled rice (CMR) work this season, citing pending payments of about Rs 55 crore from government procurement agencies and other unresolved demands.

According to the District Rice Millers Association, around 140 of the district’s 175 rice mills have neither registered nor entered into an agreement with the government for CMR milling.

The decision was taken at a meeting of the association held in Vyaspur town on Thursday. The millers said payments for CMR work had remained pending, causing financial difficulties for rice mill owners. They expressed disappointment that despite assurances from the government and district administra-

tion authorities, their outstanding dues had not been cleared. “The procurement agencies owe about Rs 55 crore to rice millers in Yamunanagar for CMR services for 2025-26. In such circumstances, rice millers in the district will not be able to undertake CMR milling,” said Manish Bansal, district president of the association. He said the millers had demanded a sufficient monthly quota of railway rakes for lifting CMR, but the district had been allotted only one goods train under the October quota.

Bansal also demanded that the permissible moisture content of paddy for procurement be raised from 17 per cent to 20 per cent, citing difficulties faced by farmers.

“After raising the moisture limit, the government should reduce the CMR recovery requirement from 67 per cent to 62 per cent per quintal to

fulfil the demand of rice millers,” he said.

The millers said they were also facing an additional financial burden as they were not being adequately compensated for transporting rice to destinations outside the district or state. They said they had repeatedly raised the issues with the authorities but had not received a satisfactory response. The association said rice millers played an important role in the procurement and processing system and their concerns needed to be addressed to ensure the smooth functioning of paddy milling operations.

“Government should address all grievances, including the pending payments of millers. A timely decision is necessary to restore confidence among mill owners and enable them to continue operations without further financial losses,” Bansal said.

₹645-crore bank scam: Jewellers got ₹96 cr from shell entities, says ED

BHARTESH SINGH THAKUR/
AANAVI SINGH ARYA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 2 Jewellers in Chandigarh, Mohali and Panchkula received Rs 95.81 crore from shell entities, floated by the accused, in the Rs 645-crore IDFC First Bank-AU Small Finance Bank scam, said the Directorate of Enforcement (ED), Chandigarh.

The ED had conducted search operations at 14 premises belonging to jewellers and their associates across Chandigarh, Mohali, and Panchkula on September 29, resulting in the recovery and seizure of Rs 4.30 crore in cash and freezing of bank bal-

ances of about Rs 22 crore, said the ED. Incriminating documents and digital evidence were also seized.

The public funds embezzled in the scam belonged to eight Haryana Government departments and two of the Chandigarh Administration.

The ED investigation was initiated on the basis of an FIR registered by the State Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau, Haryana, in February concerning discrepancies in the balances of accounts of the Development and Panchayat Department, Haryana. Later, other departments also reported siphoning off the funds.

The ED said Malik Jew-

ellers, KLG Group (KLG Jewels, KLG Infra and KLG & Co.), M.B. Gold Traders, M/s Sham Jewellers and M/s Sunder Jewellers allegedly received about Rs 58 crore, Rs 26 crore, Rs 5 crore, Rs 3.66 crore and Rs 3.15 crore, respectively, from intermediate shell entities purportedly floated by Ribhav Rishi, the mastermind in the scam. It amounted to Rs 95.81 crore.

From jewellers, the proceeds of crime reached accused IAS officers and other government servants involved in the scam, said the ED. Earlier, the ED had arrested four persons and attached, seized and froze assets worth about Rs 211 crore. It also filed a prosecution

complaint against 14 people.

The CBI, which is also investigating the case, filed a third chargesheet before the CBI Special Court in Panchkula in the first week of September, naming six Haryana cadre IAS officers.

As per the modus operandi, employees at IDFC First Bank and AU Small Finance Bank allegedly colluded with IAS officers and other officials to open accounts at specific branches. The public funds from departmental accounts were then transferred to shell entities, floated by accused bankers. Subsequently, funds from the shell entities were transferred to jewellers and real estate businesses.

Overseas push, state firm ships 24 MT of frozen food to Canada

SURYA S PILLAI
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Marking a fresh push to connect Indian farmer groups with overseas markets, s state firm has shipped 24 metric tonnes of frozen food products to Canada.

The consignment, flagged off by the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA), was sent from Sonapat by Aterna Foods Producer Company Ltd. It comprises 2,295 boxes of frozen food products valued at 35,140 Canadian dollars (CAD).

The shipment includes green peas, mixed vegetables, peas and carrots, sweet corn



A truck loaded with food products in Sonapat.

and samosas, among other products, according to APEDA. The export unit was supported by APEDA under its Financial Assistance Scheme. The shipment is being positioned as an example of how

Farmer Producer Organisations (FPO)-led processing and export models can help farmer groups move beyond the sale of raw agricultural produce and participate in international value chains.

“The export creates new market opportunities for Indian farmers and food producers while strengthening linkages between FPOs, exporters and global buyers,” APEDA Chairman Abhishek Dev said.

The authority has been facilitating linkages between FPOs/farmer producer companies and exporters to strengthen market access and help farmer groups participate in export-orientated value chains.

₹5-cr extortion threat to Karnal sarpanch

KARNAL, OCTOBER 2

Manjeet Kumar, sarpanch of Manglora village in the district, has allegedly received a Rs 5-crore extortion call, followed by firing at a welcome gate of the village bearing his photograph.

The sarpanch has filed a complaint with the police that he received a call from a foreign number on September 20. The caller, speaking in Punjabi, reportedly introduced himself as a member of Lawrence Bishnoi group and demanded Rs 5 crore from him. The caller also threatened Manjeet’s son, warning that he would not return home if the demand was ignored.

After Manjeet did not respond, unidentified persons opened fire at the gate near the village bus stand on Thursday night.

Archer Kirti puts Jind village on Asiad map with gold medal

DEEPENDER DESWAL
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

JIND, OCTOBER 2 The narrow, unpaved street leading to Kirti Sharma’s house in Ritauli village in Jind was suddenly filled with people, with neighbours streaming in to congratulate the family of the girl who had just put her village on the Asian Games map with a gold medal in an event which hardly local peo-



Villagers celebrate at the residence of Kirti Sharma in Ritauli village in Jind district. TRIBUNE PHOTO

ple know about -- recurve archery.

Kirti won the gold medal in the women’s recurve team event comprising her, Ankita Bhakat and Kumkum Mohod by beating the team from South Korea.

The modest house that requires a coat of paint has a room in which hang the medals that Kirti has won till now. “This will now have the coveted Asian Games gold medal on the top,” says her father, Vijay Sharma, a farmer owning three acres.

He said that for them, the

gold medal was not just the reward for years of practice. “It is also a reminder of a decision we took when there was no guarantee that the investment will ever bring a return,” he said.

Vijay Sharma recalled that when his daughter first took up archery at a school in Pilukhera, the nearby town, her family thought it would cost just around Rs 5,000 to purchase the equipment and that would be enough. They soon discovered that the sport demanded far more than they had imagined.

As Kirti progressed and was selected for training at the Sports Authority of India, she needed better equipment. The cost of the equipment was around Rs 60,000. Her father borrowed money from arhtiyas to buy it. “I took a loan from arhtiyas to buy the equipment. I decided to fulfil all her demands because I wanted to see my daughter happy and successful,” he said, adding that he returned the loan in instalments later on. “I am happy that my daughter’s efforts have paid off,” she said.

Kirti’s mother, Guddi Devi, said that Kirti called her on the phone after the gold medal win.

Shahabad’s heart beats to a golden rhythm

NITISH SHARMA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

KURUKSHETRA, OCTOBER 2 Celebrations erupted at the house of senior India forward Navneet Kaur in Shahabad, Kurukshetra, after the Indian women’s hockey team won gold at the Asian Games and secured direct qualification for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

After the match, Navneet’s father, Buta Singh, had a brief conversation with her as the team was preparing to attend the medal ceremony. The family is now planning a rousing welcome for the hockey star.

Speaking to *The Tribune*, Buta Singh, an agriculturist, said, “I had a brief talk with her as they were about to go for the medal ceremony. We will have a detailed discussion later. She was very happy. We were excited throughout the match and confident that the team would win gold today. We

are happy with the performance of the girls. It is a double celebration for us as the team has also secured direct qualification for the 2028 Olympics. We are confident that the girls will bring gold from the Olympics as well.”

Relatives and friends of the family began arriving at their house to share their joy. Family members celebrated the victory by bursting firecrackers.

Navneet, who started playing hockey at the age of seven, made her senior India debut in 2014.

“Navneet had a very good tournament. She scored 10 goals besides helping the team defend penalty corners during the tournament. She is a forward, but she also showed her defensive skills during the match and helped stop penalty corners. She will return on October 4, and we will plan a rousing welcome for her,” Buta Singh said.

Four Sonapat girls won gold on my birthday, beams coach

MUKESH TANDON
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

SONEPAT, OCTOBER 2 The Indian women’s hockey team, which clinched the gold medal by defeating reigning Asian champions China at the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, has four players from Sonapat.

The four players — Neha Goyal, Sakshi Rana, Shilpi Dabas and Jyoti — are students at former Indian team captain and Commonwealth Games gold medallist Pritam Siwach’s academy in the Industrial area of Sonapat city and had started playing hockey at the early age of 10-11 years.

“Today is my birthday. When the four players were heading out to the field, they asked: ‘Madam, what should we bring for you?’ I simply told them to bring back a gold medal. Today, they have gifted me an Asian gold medal on

my birthday,” said Pritam, who celebrated the team’s victory and her birthday on the academy ground.

While Jyoti and Shilpi Dabas played as defenders, Neha and Sakshi Rana played as midfielders in the Indian team.

“We have been training the players from their childhood and turned them into quality members in the Indian team,” said Pritam Siwach, excited over the team’s performance at the Asian Games.

“It is a matter of pride that four girls — Jyoti, Shilpi, Neha and Sakshi — are from Sonapat academy. They brought laurels to the academy as well as the district, state and country by clinching gold at the Asiad, which was a big dream of the country for the past 44 years,” Pritam said.

1996-born Neha Goyal is an experienced player and belongs to a very poor family.

Neha has risen to success from a “toxic” atmosphere at her home during her childhood. Pritam Siwach spotted her at the age of nine years and gave her training.

The financial condition of Sakshi Rana and Jyoti was not good, but they are dedicated towards their game, said Pritam. Sakshi Rana’s parents were running a canteen near Tika Ram Girls’ College and made huge efforts to make their daughter an international-level player, she said.

Jyoti’s father died at her early age, and last year, her mother also died, but Jyoti continued her hard work and is now playing at the international level, Pritam added.

Shilpi Dabas inherited hockey talent as her father, Anil Dabas, is also a hockey player. She joined the academy at the age of 10-11 years, Pritam said.



A woman offers sweets to Parveen’s mother Neelam in Rurkee village of Rohtak district on Friday. TRIBUNE PHOTO

was particularly significant. Her father, Lakhpat Hooda, has been battling cancer for the past four years and is also a heart patient. The family owns a small piece of land, while her

mother, Neelam, is a homemaker who also sells milk.

“It is a proud moment not only for the family but for the entire village, as a daughter of the village has won a gold

medal for the country at an international tournament like the Asian Games. It is the result of Parveen’s hard work and dedication towards the sport,” Neelam said.

She said Parveen had started boxing at the village ground when she was 11-12 years old.

“It was a tough time for the family when Parveen’s father developed heart problems in 2004 and underwent an operation. He has been fighting cancer for the last four years. But the situation changed when Parveen was selected in the ITBP after which she began taking care of the family,” Neelam said.



PUBLIC NOTICE

For kind attention of general public, allottees and stakeholders of the real estate project "One Global" situated at sector - 73 Village Begampur Khatola Dist. Gurugram being developed by promoter namely M/s Capital Heights Pvt Ltd.

1. This is to inform the general public, allottees, stakeholders, and concerned authorities that the promoter of the project Namely "ONE GLOBAL" has applied for change of the bank accounts.

2. The above-mentioned project is registered with the HARERA Gurugram: vide registration no. 30 of 2023 dated 02.02.2023 and the registration is valid up to 30.09.2026.

3. Existing Bank Account and New Bank Account Details are as follow:

Particulars	Account No.	Bank Name	Branch Address	IFSC
Master Account	1548953896	Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.	S-214, Ground Floor, Panchsheel Park, New Delhi - 110017	KKBK0004611
RERA Account	1548953919	Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.	S-214, Ground Floor, Panchsheel Park, New Delhi - 110017	KKBK0004611
Free Account	1548879561	Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.	G-1 & G-2, ATM -1, Vipul Plaza, Sun City, Sector - 54, Gurgaon, Haryana - 122002	KKBK0004265

4. The promoter has submitted a request for change of the designated bank accounts before the Authority, which is presently under consideration.

5. This notice is being issued for information purposes only to the general public, allottees, and stakeholders in respect of the above-mentioned project.

Sd/-
Secretary
For Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram

Dated: 03.10.2026

More Newspapers and Magazines join telegram <https://t.me/NewsTG8> (@NewsTG8)

CM seeks urgent clearance of stocks ahead of paddy arrivals

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 2 Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann has urged the Centre to urgently clear foodgrain stocks from the state before the peak arrival of paddy, stressing that adequate storage space must be ensured for smooth procurement and to prevent difficulties for farmers in mandis.

In a letter to Union Minister for Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution Pralhad Joshi, Mann sought immediate movement of 6 lakh metric tonnes (LMT) of rice by October 10 and 15 LMT of wheat during October. He said nearly 40 LMT of wheat stocks were occupying space at rice mills and mandi yards.

Mann said the stocks must be cleared to create adequate space for incoming paddy and ensure that farmers can bring their produce to mandis without facing storage-related hurdles.

The CM said Punjab had requested the movement of 15 LMT of rice and 10-12 LMT of wheat during September 2026 to complete the delivery of rice from the kharif marketing season (KMS) 2025-26 and clear wheat stocks lying in rice



CM Bhagwant Singh Mann chairs a review meeting on Friday.

STORAGE SPACE CRUNCH

- Mann seeks movement of 6 LMT rice by October 10 and 15 LMT wheat during the month
- Nearly 40 LMT wheat stocks are occupying space at rice mills and mandi yards

mills and mandi yards before the start of KMS 2026-27.

“However, only 8.3 LMT of rice and 4.3 LMT of wheat have been moved out of the state from September 1 to 29, 2026,” Mann said.

He said due to a persistent shortage of storage space with the Food Corporation of India (FCI), only 99.50 LMT (94%) of custom-milled rice from KMS 2025-26 had been delivered by the end of September against the due quantity of 105.64 LMT, leaving nearly 6 LMT to be delivered.

“With the next kharif marketing season having commenced and peak arrivals

expected around October 10, delivery of all pending rice to the FCI by then is of paramount importance so as to avoid carry-over of balance paddy stocks in the next kharif season and also to prevent complications in stock accounting and recycling of paddy/rice,” he said.

Mann also said the delay in milling was already causing unrest among millers. He said if rice delivery went beyond mid-October, millers might not come forward for storage and milling of paddy, which could result in unrest among other stakeholders, especially farmers.

Aam Aadmi Clinic staff threaten protest on Nov 12

BATHINDA, OCTOBER 2

The employees of Ayushman Arogya Kendras (formerly Aam Aadmi Clinics), under the banner of the Aam Aadmi Clinic Sanjha Front, on Friday threatened to stage a protest in Sangrur on November 12.

They said they could suspend services indefinitely if their demands for job security, higher remuneration and benefits on a par with regular government employees were not met.

Paramjit Singh, president of the Aam Aadmi Clinic Pharmacist Union, Punjab, said employees at around 1,090 clinics functioning in the state, including doctors, pharmacists, clinical assistants and other staff, were apprehensive about their jobs with the Assembly elections approaching.

They are seeking an increase in incentives, payment for 365 days a year, leave on Sundays and gazetted holidays, and health and life insurance. — TNS

PSPCL drops plan to raise ₹10,000 cr through bonds

RUCHIKA M KHANNA

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

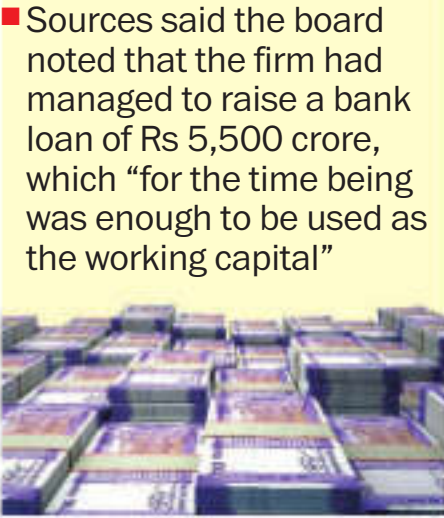
CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 2

Punjab State Power Corporation Limited (PSPCL) has decided not to proceed with its earlier plan to raise a Rs 10,000-crore loan from the debt market through bonds and non-convertible debentures. The decision was taken at a meeting of the PSPCL board of directors held on Wednesday. Highly placed government sources told The Tribune that the board noted that the state power company had managed to raise a bank loan of Rs 5,500 crore, which “for the time being was enough to be used as the working capital”.

The move comes amid criticism of the proposal to raise the loan through a merchant banker by paying an arranger fee of Rs 150 crore

‘HAVE ENOUGH WORKING CAPITAL’

- The decision was taken at a meeting of the Punjab State Power Corporation Limited board of directors held on Wednesday
- Sources said the board noted that the firm had managed to raise a bank loan of Rs 5,500 crore, which “for the time being was enough to be used as the working capital”



to Rs 177 crore. The proposal had earlier been ratified at a PSPCL board of directors’ meeting in August this year.

It was then decided that the money would be raised

through a merchant banker without a state government guarantee on the loan. The rationale given was that the loan was needed to address the liquidity crunch in the power company caused by delayed subsidy payments and unpaid power bills.

Official sources told The Tribune that board members were informed on Wednesday that banks were willing to extend a loan to the power company without seeking any arranger fee. The bid to raise the loan through a merchant banker had, therefore, become unnecessary.

The decision comes at a time when a similar unsecured loan proposed to be raised by the Greater Mohali Area Development Authority (GMADA) is already under scrutiny by the Punjab and

Haryana High Court.

The tender for raising the loan through merchant bankers was floated on June 15, and the technical bids were opened on July 30. The funds were to be raised in two tranches of Rs 5,000 crore each.

Three entities — AK Capital Services Limited, Trust Investment Advisers Private Limited and Real Growth Securities Private Limited — had bid to be appointed as merchant bankers. All three are SEBI-registered Category I merchant bankers.

The lowest bid was submitted by AK Capital, which sought an arranger fee of 1.5 per cent of the total fund mobilisation. The other two bidders sought arranger fees of 1.73 per cent and 1.77 per cent of the funds to be raised.

Two Pak intruders shot dead by BSF

ANIRUDH GUPTA

FEROZEPUR, OCTOBER 2

Two Pakistani intruders were gunned down by Border Security Force (BSF) troops near the Rajokey border outpost along the India-Pakistan border in the Ferozepur sector on Friday.

Around 11.40 am, the BSF troops belonging to the 142 battalion spotted three Pakistani intruders entering the Indian territory ahead of barbed wire fencing. The troops challenged and warned them.

They, however, continued to move inside Indian territory, following which the BSF troops opened fire on them. Two intruders were killed on the spot, while their third accomplice managed to slip back into the Pakistani area.

The incident took place 120 m ahead of the International Border and 40 m from the border fencing. Their identity could not be ascertained. Nothing suspicious was found in their possession.

Bhikhiwind DSP Atul Soni said the incident took place in the area under the Khalra police station in Tarn Taran district. BSF authorities could not be contacted for comments.

Firm finalised for 1,604-m Ravi bridge

Gurdaspur: After an agonising wait of several decades, 6,000 residents of nine villages located across the Ravi near the India-Pakistan border have something to cheer about as the PWD has cleared the name of an Amritsar-based firm to build a 1,604-m concrete high-level bridge. Currently, residents are unable to access health care and education facilities during monsoons. TNS

PUBLIC NOTICE

Subject: Transfer of ownership in respect of SCO No. 85, Mahila Ashram, Karnal consequent upon the death of co-owner Sh. Virender Kamboj S/o Sh. Sher Singh Kamboj. Sh. Virender Kamboj S/o Sh. Sher Singh Kamboj & Davinder Kamboj S/o Sh. Sher Singh Kamboj were the co-owner of the subject cited property as per allotment/reallocation memo no. 8113 dated 15-08-2005. Sh. Virender Kamboj has expired on 31-08-2025. There are four legal heirs- 1. Smt. Kanta Choudhary (Mother), 2. Smt. Parul Choudhary (Wife) 3. Naysha Kamboj (Daughter) & 4. Adwika Kamboj (Minor) (Daughter) has applied in the HSPV Office, Karnal that share of property of Late Sh. Virender Kamboj should be transferred in the name of Parul Choudhary W/o Late Sh. Virender Kamboj, Naysha Kamboj & Adwika Kamboj (Minor, U/G Parul Choudhary) Ds/o Late Sh. Virender Kamboj R/o 2-48, 2nd Floor, BCD Block, Vigul Model, Sector-48, South City-E, Gurgaon. Therefore, through this information, it is reported that if any person is having any objection against the transfer of this SCO, he/she can submit objections in writing to the Estate Officer, HSPV, Karnal, alongwith supporting documents within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice, otherwise the Estate Officer may accord permission for transfer of the said property as per HSPV policy and may not entertain subsequent claim, if any.

Legal Heirs, On behalf of Estate Officer

Two cross-border smuggling modules busted; four held

PAWAN K JAISWAR

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

AMRITSAR, OCTOBER 2

The Amritsar (Rural) police have busted two cross-border trafficking modules linked to Middle East-based handlers and Pakistan-based operators, leading to the arrest of four persons and resulting in the seizure of 10 kg of heroin along with 10 sophisticated pistols.

DGP Gaurav Yadav claimed the operation dismantled two networks using drone drops to smuggle contraband and weapons into Punjab. Five Glock and five PX-5 pistols were among the seized weapons.

IG (Border Range) Gurpreet Singh Bhullar said Rajanpreet of Galluwal village and Vijay of Rajatal Colony, Gharinda, were among those arrested. Vijay was previously arrested in March 2023 with 475 gm of heroin. After securing bail, he allegedly resumed his activities and began recruiting new members in the network. Vijay used to retrieve the consignments and then handed them to Rajanpreet for distribution.

The IG said another important catch was Paras-

10 kg heroin, 10 pistols seized by Amritsar police

deep, alias Billa, of Mahal village under the Kamboh police station. He said Parasdeep worked as a distributor for gangster Kishan Jandiala. He has now been operating from a Middle Eastern country. Parasdeep was responsible for collecting consignments after drone drops.

Parasdeep had engaged Gurmukh Bodhi of Attari to retrieve the heroin packages. The seized narcotics and weapons were then moved using motorcycles and varying disguises to avoid detection. Investigators revealed that the module had successfully cleared 10-12 consignments earlier, with deliveries made in the Tarn Taran and Sarai Amanat Khan areas, etc.

In their early twenties, Rajan Preet works as a mason, while Vijay is a plumber. Parasdeep was a daily wageer.

The IG said the financial trail of the module and its linkages were being probed and more arrests and seizures were likely in the coming days.

808 MBBS, BDS seats still vacant

BALWANT GARG

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

FARIDKOT, OCTOBER 2

A total of 808 MBBS and BDS seats remain vacant in Punjab after the second round of counselling, according to the revised seat matrices released by Baba Farid University of Health Sciences (BFUHS) on Tuesday. With NRI-quota seats making up 389 of them

Seven private colleges have 209 vacancies, while five government colleges have 98 vacant seats. This is roughly 17 per cent of the state’s 1,800 MBBS seats in 12 colleges.

Of the 389 vacant NRI quota seats, 175 are for the MBBS course. Guru Gobind Singh Medical College, Faridkot, has the highest number of

NRI quota seats account for nearly half of vacancies

vacant MBBS seats at 51 (38 under the NRI quota). Among government colleges, Government Medical College, Amritsar, has 16 vacant seats, Government Medical College, Patiala, has 20, and Dr BR Ambedkar State Institute of Medical Sciences, Mohali, has 11 vacancies.

In the private sector, the Adesh Institute of Medical Sciences and Research, Bathinda, has 46 vacant seats, Sri Guru Ram Das Institute of Medical Sciences and Research, Amritsar, has 43, and Punjab Institute of Medical Sciences, Jalandhar, has 35.

The scenario about BDS seats is similar. There are 501 vacant seats in 17 dental colleges, including 214 NRI seats (about 43 per cent) out of a total of 1,350 seats. RIMT Dental College, Mandi Gobindgarh, has the most vacancies (46), followed by Sri Sukhmani Dental College, Dera Bassi (45), Desh Bhagat Dental College, Mandi Gobindgarh (43), and Guru Nanak Dev Dental College, Sunam, and Genesis Institute of Dental Sciences, Ferozepur (42 each). Dasmesh Institute of Research and Dental Sciences, Faridkot, has 25 vacant seats, including 14 NRI seats.

The BFUHS willingness list for the third round shows 1,629 candidates.

Was there link between unrest at Chitkara & LPU, HC asks state

SAURABH MALIK

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 2

The Punjab and Haryana High Court has asked the state if there was a possible connection between alleged false information circulated on social media about Chitkara University and Lovely Professional University (LPU) and whether there was a deliberate attempt to create unrest in these institutions.

Taking up a petition filed in public interest seeking a probe by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) into the recent “violence, arson and vandalism” at the LPU, the Division Bench comprising Chief Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra and Justice Rohit Kapoor sought a status report

from the Punjab Government on the possible connection, among other things.

“The affidavit will also clarify as to whether a false information on social media was disseminated in respect of another private University, i.e. Chitkara University, a day before. Whether there is any connection between the two events and a deliberate attempt to create unrest in these institutions, shall also be specifically addressed,” the Bench directed in its detailed order.

The direction came after the petitioner, an LPU student, said, “Only a night earlier, similar claims that two girl students had gone missing or had died by suicide set off violence at Chitkara University, Rajpu-

ra, where the university and the police stated that no such incident had occurred. Such incidents of violence hurt the students of the university more than anyone else and moreover created environment of terrorism in the university.”

The state has also been asked to specify: “Whether such an incident took place or not. In the event such an incident has occurred, what action has been taken. It should also be clarified that if such an incident has not occurred, what action was taken for social media post, to be deleted by the intermediary concerned. What followed thereafter, would also be clarified in the status report to be filed by the Commissioner of Police concerned.”

From doubt to pride, family recalls golden girl Baljeet’s journey

AAKANKSHA N BHARDWAJ

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

JALANDHAR, OCTOBER 2

“Gold hi chahiye tha, silver nahi (We were gunning for gold, not the silver),” Indian women’s hockey team forward Baljeet Kaur told *The Tribune* shortly after the side had ended the country’s 44-year wait for the Asian Games trophy in Nagoya, Japan.

The 25-year-old from Kaka Kandiala village in Tarn Taran was the only member of the squad from Punjab. She, like her teammates, had her eyes on the prize right from the start. Even before the tournament had begun, she had asked her elder brother, Dalsar Singh, a taxi driver, to keep dhols ready to welcome her home with the medal.

Given her modest roots, the journey has not always been easy for Baljeet. Even following her coach’s nutritional advice was a challenge. “Our coach would emphasise on a balanced diet. He would ask us to get chana and badaam every day,” she recalled, adding, “When I did not have enough, I would ask other players to share.”

Her father, Lakhwinder Singh, worked as a labourer. Despite the hardships, he never asked his daughter to give up on her passion. “My father never asked me to quit. Rather, he always encouraged and motivated me to keep going,” she said.

“It would always have to muster the courage to ask my father for money for my hockey. I knew it was difficult for him to arrange it,” she said.

Her mother, Rajwant Kaur,



Indian forward Baljeet Kaur

remembers how Lakhwinder would somehow manage resources for Baljeet. “If necessary, he would borrow from others so she could continue playing,” she said.

For Baljeet, however, hockey had begun almost instinctively. She was inspired by a cousin who played the sport. “I would see her putting on her shoes and leaving in the morning to play. That was my calling,” she said.

Her elder brother admits that he once questioned why their father was spending so much money on a sport that did not bring immediate returns. Today, those doubts have turned into pride. “Today, when those travelling in my taxi ask me about Baljit, I am filled with immense pride.”

Baljeet’s next ask is simple: a sports ground for her village. “I want the ground in my village to have proper facilities so that youngsters can take up sports and bring laurels back,” she said with her lustrious gold medal in her hands.

Girl shifted to rehab after video in ‘zombie-like’ state goes viral

ARCHIT WATTS

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

BATHINDA, OCTOBER 2

A video purportedly showing a young girl in a suspected drug-induced state at the grain market in Bathinda has gone viral on social media, prompting the police to admit her to a government-run de-addiction centre.

The 18-second video shows the girl standing unsteadily, unable to control her movements before falling. Her movements and expression prompted social media users to describe her condition as “zombie-like”.

Kotwali police station house officer Yadwinder Singh said the girl hailed Jaito in Faridkot district and was admitted to a government-run de-addiction cen-

tre on Thursday.

DSP Karamjit Singh Sandhawalia said the police were

verifying the facts and looking into the reason that the girl was in Bathinda.

The Tribune

ESTABLISHED IN 1881

SIR fallout

Need to streamline teachers' duties

THE Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls continues to be under sharp scrutiny for administrative and political reasons. Accused of disenfranchising crores of eligible citizens, the Election Commission of India (ECI) has directed its state poll officials to launch a special drive to include “left-out” and new voters in areas where the roll revision is complete. The sheer scale of the SIR, whose third phase is in progress, has led to a separate problem: many of the Booth Level Officers (BLOs) are teachers in government schools, and their workload is increasingly taking its toll on classroom teaching.

In Karnataka, students of government and aided schools cut a sorry figure in the mid-term examinations as their teachers had been on SIR duty for the last three months and classes remained suspended. The disruptions are also illustrated by reports from Maharashtra, Punjab, Haryana and Delhi. Teachers are spending substantial portions of their days on voter verification, meetings and data compilation. One school in Mumbai had 24 of its 34 teachers performing BLO duties.

The revision of electoral rolls is undoubtedly important to ensure that no genuine voter is excluded. The question is whether such an exercise can be conducted without affecting several months of children’s education. Section 27 of the Right to Education Act imposes restrictions on the deployment of teachers for non-educational work, while allowing specified exceptions, including election-related duties. The Delhi High Court has stressed that SIR assignments should not become an unbearable burden for teachers or impair their teaching responsibilities. Course correction should be an immediate priority. Schools could consider a fresh assessment after these teachers start taking classes regularly, while ensuring that examination results do not unfairly penalise children. Electoral integrity and uninterrupted education are both public responsibilities. India should not have to choose between a reliable voter list and a functioning classroom.

Mismatch mess

Genuine paddy farmers must not suffer

THE Haryana paddy procurement problem exposes a larger weakness in the way technology is being used to deliver government support. The Meri Fasal Mera Byora (MFMB) portal was meant to make procurement more transparent and prevent bogus claims. But with procurement under way, nearly 59% of the crop area flagged as mismatched is still awaiting verification. Of the 22.35 lakh acres marked as mismatched, only 9.14 lakh acres had been verified by September 28, leaving the rest pending. In Yamunanagar, farmers have protested that discrepancies between registered and verified acreage are holding up paddy purchases. For farmers who have harvested their crop, a database discrepancy is not a minor technical problem. It can mean waiting with their produce while prices and payment remain uncertain.

The government has a legitimate reason for tightening verification. There have been concerns over inflated acreage, misreporting of basmati as non-basmati paddy and irregular procurement. The Centre has also sought stronger safeguards against bogus purchases. Ensuring that public money is spent only on eligible produce is essential. But verification cannot become a barrier to the very procurement system it is meant to protect. A digital system is useful only when it works at the speed required by agriculture. Paddy cannot wait indefinitely for a portal to reconcile records.

The priority should be to clear the backlog through time-bound physical verification and dedicated district-level teams. Where a farmer disputes a mismatch, there should be a quick appeal mechanism, with genuine cases cleared without forcing farmers to run from one office to another. The government should also publish district-wise data on pending and resolved cases. The state must guard against bogus procurement without making genuine farmers pay the price for its own verification backlog.

ON THIS DAY...100 YEARS AGO

The Tribune.

LAHORE, SUNDAY, OCTOBER 3, 1926

The elections

IT is with a sense of great relief that the country learns from a telegram from Mussoorie that Pandit Motilal Nehru's condition does not necessitate any serious anxiety. But the same telegram makes it clear that Nehru is still suffering from malaria, that he has been advised complete rest in the hills for a fortnight and that he will not be able to attend to any business for one week. No one can grudge him complete rest for a week or even a fortnight, and if that rest is essential for his health, it is good both for himself and for the cause he represents that he should have it. But the fact cannot be overlooked that he is the one leader of outstanding ability and influence who can carry on the electioneering fight in Upper India on behalf of the Swaraj Party. There are lesser men, but they will obviously be no match for the combined strength of Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya and Lala Lajpat Rai. There are some men of striking ability in the party both in Madras and Bengal, though none as able as Nehru, but they labour under the great disadvantage of not knowing the vernaculars of Punjab and the United Provinces and will not be able to address audiences in these provinces in their own language, which is essential for electioneering success, especially in rural areas. This, as we have said already, is a matter for sincere regret not merely from the point of view of the Swaraj Party, but from the point of view of that political education of the electorate to which we attach the greatest possible importance.

OPINION

The tough race to the finish line

What do all the cliches really mean when women athletes pit themselves against huge odds and win



THE GREAT GAME
JYOTI MALHOTRA

WHEN you watch your under-rated athletes accelerate past the best runners on the track, like Vithya Ramraj from Coimbatore did in the 4x400m final in the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games this week, first against the Chinese and then the Bahraini girl, you wonder what it means to be the best. Vithya took the baton from Prachi Choudhary, from Saharanpur in Uttar Pradesh, who ran the third leg; MR Poovamma, from Coorg in Karnataka, who ran the second leg, took the stick from Kiran Pahal, the girl from Gumad village in Haryana's Sonapat district, who ran first, against the sound of the gunshot.

The cliches trickle into your brain, as you watch pure magic unfold in front of you. Muscle and sinew and years of training and a constant ache that pushes you to be the best—all merging into one run, by four women, hailing from unfancied parts of the country.

India's daughters. Our golden girls. Unity in diversity. North meets South and the differences disappear.

But what do these cliches really mean when these women athletes pit themselves — against their malnourished youth, societal pressures, the desperate struggle against poverty, ever-present sexual harassment and the overweening chaos of their everyday lives in the cesspool of small village-small town India — against their dreams, and win?

As these girls were running for their lives in Aichi-Nagoya earlier this week, other daughters of India were protesting on the streets of Delhi against a gang-rape in a park. For those of us old enough to remember the 'Nirbhaya' sexual assault in the winter of 2012, it's as if the years col-



GOLDEN GIRLS: The Indian quartet — (from left) Kiran, Prachi, Poovamma and Vithya — won the gold medal in the women's 4x400m relay at the 2026 Asian Games. PTI

lapsed and we wondered — have things really changed?

To be fair to PM Modi, he's tried the slogans, from 'Beti bachao, beti padhao' to putting money into women's bank accounts and tweaking government schemes, like Ujjwala gas cylinders, that ensure that women are a priority. Even if many of these schemes are aimed at creating a political constituency of women — at least he hasn't stopped trying.

So why do women continue to feel as if they don't matter? Probably because the motive behind these political moves aren't as pure as they should be. The aim to give 33 per cent reservation to women in Parliament and assemblies is accompanied by so many caveats — the most problematic being the expansion in the number of seats in Parliament and assemblies before the quota is given.

Savita Punia, the women's hockey goalkeeper who fought off a penalty stroke in the final against China to help win the gold, 1-0, is from Sirsa in Haryana, which in May 2026 recorded an abysmal sex ratio at birth of 883 girls per 1,000 boys — the government recently suspended four medical officers, allegedly for allowing the illegal termination of pregnancies. It's common knowledge in Haryana

As these girls were running for their lives in Aichi-Nagoya, other daughters of India were protesting on the streets of Delhi against a gang-rape in a park.

that pregnant women travel next-door to Rajasthan to get rid of their female foetuses. (The worst-offending Haryana districts are Gurugram and Jind, at 863 and 872 girls per 1,000 boys.)

Lahremsiami Hmarzote, from Kolasib in Mizoram, scored the winning goal in the women's hockey final in the 10th minute. Salima Tete, from Badkichapar in Jharkhand's Simdega district, belongs to a family of Kharia tribals, and captained her team to a stirring finish — Tete says she looks up to former women's hockey captain Asunta Lakra, who in July charged Hockey India Secretary General Bhola Nath Singh with “sexual harassment and institutional intimidation.” Salima's golden girls have struck gold, for the first time in

44 years, earning themselves a spot in the 2028 Olympics.

Perhaps the hardest questions are still not being asked of those who don't want to share power — why don't you? What is it about women that makes you so afraid?

It is widely known that the southern states, led by Kerala, have the highest sex ratios (Kerala has 1,084 females per 1,000 males at birth), compared to states like Haryana and Punjab (at 898 and 924 females per 1,000 males, respectively), although all three states have approximately the same population, 3 crore.

Here's an interesting factoid : Kerala has fewer women MLAs, 11 out of 140, in its current Assembly, than Punjab and Haryana, which each have 13 (out of 117 and 90 seats, respectively). And although Kerala has had women MLAs since its first elections in 1957, when the first Communist government in the world was elected under EMS Namboodiripad, its female representation has never crossed 10 per cent.

Meanwhile, a different kind of race is being played out these days in Punjab, in the run-up to Assembly elections in February. The Congress party has a new state chief, Pargat Singh, a former hockey Olympian, hours

after former chief Amrinder Singh Raja Warring was chopped off at the knees by the Congress high command in a smooth, bloodless manoeuvre.

Warring will now go on holiday to London, clearly a destination more charming than Muktsar, his home-town. The rest of the Congress has already moved on, both in gratitude and anticipation — two sentiments that have infiltrated this past week, both across politics and sports.

Home Minister Amit Shah expelled out the latter sentiment, after he paid obeisance at the ancient Devi Talab Mandir in Jalandhar. With anticipation writ large on his face, he told a rally on Thursday that while he hadn't come to Punjab to talk politics, he promised that the BJP would rid the state of the scourge of drugs “if you vote us to power, once.”

The sparse rally roared back in appreciation, but the powerful BJP leader couldn't have been happy with the low turnout, especially compared to his Moga rally in March. Some said he arrived about half an hour early and the crowds were still getting there. Punjab BJP leaders privately admit that the several anti-drugs yatras mounted by the party across the state in recent weeks, all of which converged in Jalandhar, hadn't received the kind of interest they had hoped — in some yatras stops, as my colleague Neha Saini reported from Amritsar, only the 25-30 drugs-afflicted families brought by BJP leaders headlining the rally were present.

All those keenly watching Amit Shah's speech would have noticed a third thing. He attacked the ruling AAP government in Punjab, and he attacked the Congress party — still the BJP's chief rival and antagonist across the country, never mind it likes to occasionally cut the ground under its own feet — but he never once attacked the Shiromani Akali Dal.

So what happens now? Which party will first cross the finishing line? The truth is that tiny Punjab is important in the larger political picture because of how it will treat the BJP juggernaut. All eyes now on how it will.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Never underestimate the power of your dreams. — Neeraj Chopra

The heavy bundle of wheat

GOVARDHAN GABBI

FOR two weeks now, I have been staying in my village. Our old house is being rebuilt. After a very long time, I have had an opportunity to stay in my *pinad* for so many days at a stretch.

The other day, a lens slipped out of my spectacles. I got into my car and set off for the nearby town to get it repaired. As I drove past a village, my eyes fell on the fields. Suddenly, it felt as though a door had opened before me — a door leading back almost half a century.

I remembered my first day of labour. I had worked in our own fields before that. I had ploughed the land, removed weeds and harvested wheat. I worked for as long as I wished, and whenever I grew tired, I would sit down. Even my parents' scolding did not bother me.

But working in someone else's fields is an altogether different experience. There, no one looks at your age or build. They look at your hands.

I was about 13 years old at that time. My father had bought five acres of land, which was at the mercy of the rain gods. That year, there was not much work to be done in our own fields, and for the first time, I had to go and work as a labourer elsewhere.

Some of my paternal cousins and a few other boys from the village were with me. They were older than me and accustomed to hard work. Perhaps they wondered whether I would earn a bundle of wheat, just like them.

I was made to work far beyond what my age could bear. I kept harvesting wheat all day. The sun climbed higher and higher overhead, while my body grew more and more tired. My arms began to ache. My hands and feet were scraped raw.

Many times, I felt like sitting down, but I could not. And in the evening, a sheaf of wheat was given to me as my share. I placed it on my head and began walking home. My village was three or four kilometres away. The weight of that bundle seemed heavier upon my heart than upon my head. When I reached home and dropped it to the ground, all the courage I had been holding inside me seemed to collapse at once. I burst into tears. My mother said nothing, but there was so much in her silence.

My skin, scorched and darkened that day, still carries that colour. The dark patch at the back of my neck has never quite gone away. It bears the memory of that sweltering summer day. The bundle of wheat, which had rested upon my head, lies somewhere within me today.

The writer is an educationist and actor

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Military training has to evolve

Refer to 'Military academies must raise the bar'; warfare has undergone a paradigm shift, and our military academies must evolve accordingly. Future-ready training should place greater emphasis on technology, electronic warfare, jointness, artificial intelligence, simulators and decision-making under realistic battlefield conditions. Equally, it is time to discard the informal “beg, borrow or steal” culture and eliminate ragging masquerading as toughness. Military academies should produce officers who are physically robust, technologically proficient and, above all, morally upright. Tomorrow's battles cannot be won with the training methods of yesterday.

COL SS CHAUHAN (RETD), ZIRAKPUR

Periodic reviews necessary

Apropos of 'Military academies must raise the bar'; training is not merely about physical fitness. It is meant to develop character, emotional maturity, leadership qualities and the ability to take responsible decisions under pressure. The selection process should, therefore, assess these qualities more effectively instead of depending excessively on conventional physical or academic parameters. The authorities should periodically review the selection criteria, training curriculum and methods of instruction. At the same time, genuine grievances of cadets should have a credible mechanism for redressal. We need officers who are not only physically fit and professionally competent but also humane, balanced and morally sound.

BIR DEVINDER SINGH BEDI, SANGRUR

No voter should be left behind

Apropos of 'ECI row does a disservice to the right to vote'; why can't the old practice of 'no voter is left behind' be allowed to continue? Genuine voters whose names have been removed from the voters' list are a worried lot. Nothing is being done to address their concerns. The ECI needs to clarify each and every issue at the earliest in a transparent manner. The Election Commission owes a moral responsibility to the nation to come clean on various issues.

RAJ KUMAR GOYAL, PATIALA

Protect strategic technology

Refer to 'Reusable rocket pact plugs a vital tech gap'; the government's decision to provide Rs 200 crore to a private company, Agnikul Cosmos, to develop a reusable rocket can reduce launch and manufacturing costs. However, making such a rocket is a formidable task as it must control its descent, restart its engine and land safely. The US, China and Japan are already working on this technology, while India has been developing its own RLV through ISRO since 2012. India must learn from a government-supported vaccine company that was later taken over by a multinational. Public money must be protected through strict safeguards, close oversight and technological security.

CHANCHAL S MANN, UNA

Want real progress, not freebies

With reference to 'Rs 1,262 cr transferred into bank accounts of 36.87L women: CM'; this step just before the elections is an attempt to lure women voters. If Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann is serious about women's empowerment, why are anganwadi workers, ASHA workers and government employees still protesting for their dues? Paying Rs 1,000-1,500 each per month to beneficiaries under the Punjab Mukh Mantri Mawan Dheeyan Satkar Yojana cannot compensate for the lack of safety, employment and education for women. Punjab needs real development, not freebies.

SNEHA SINGH, KHARAR

Build on archery success

India's superb show in archery at the 2026 Asian Games has enhanced the country's reputation in the global sporting arena. Success in archery demands exceptional concentration, accuracy and consistency. The achievement highlights the efforts of players, coaches and support teams who work continuously to improve performance and prepare athletes for major competitions. Strengthening grassroots programmes, upgrading training facilities and ensuring access to modern equipment can help discover and develop talent from different parts of the country.

RUKMA SHARMA, JALANDHAR

Letters to the Editor, typed in double space, should not exceed the 200-word limit. These should be cogently written and can be sent by e-mail to: Letters@tribunemail.com

INDIA bloc & Oppn disunity



RADHIKA RAMASESHAN
SENIOR JOURNALIST

WHEN the ruling establishment, ensconced at the Centre for a little over 12 years, manages to even partially stave off challenges with optics, rhetoric and institutional ballast, the Opposition's pushback gets inversely weakened. The BJP-led NDA coalition faced its first major trial from a nascent, non-political entity, and not an Opposition party — it found itself at sixes and sevens because an emerging demography outside the circumference of the constituents it had cultivated threw endless dares.

The BJP had no choice but to open its dated toolkit to answer the provocations. Delhi hosted the BRICS summit and the presence of Xi Jinping and Vladimir Putin took care of the ocular; the 7.8% GDP growth rate for the first quarter of 2026 was celebrated, although there was scepticism over the data. Even the victory of the ABVP, the RSS' student arm, in the Delhi University student elections was hailed as a "fitting" endorsement of the Union government by GenZ and a rejection of the "subversive" politics advocated by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP). Until the recent exposé revealed the differences in the Election Commission over the CECs allegedly questionable conduct of the SIR exercise and the resulting disenfranchisement of millions of voters, it looked like the Modi government had put its crises behind.

However, the real story lies in the Opposition and whether it is fit and fine to work around the problems bedevilling the party in power. If the CJP is demanding of the government, it does not afford relief to the Congress and its satellites and outliers. It is a weight on the Opposition, which is apprehensive of the ingenuity and resources summoned by GenZ leaders to create a new demography. Their inventiveness was demonstrated by the roaches who occupied the headspace and intuitively understood the political proclivities of the burgeoning new voters. A generation separates Abhijit Dipke, 30-year-old CJP founder, and Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, 56, who, like PM Narendra Modi, tries hard to engage with GenZ and fares only marginally better. Conventionally, it was taken for granted that even past 70, a politician could aspire to occupy top posts, but the CJP has triggered an irreversible churn.

The INDIA bloc met on September 30 in Delhi to think of plans to confront the Union government on the EC's alleged mendacity, and try and restore a modicum of order to the electoral procedures before the next slew of elections. The objective's significance could not be disputed: for the non-BJP parties, West Bengal



NOT TOGETHER : The INDIA bloc held a meeting to think of plans to confront the Centre. PTI

As the CJP is capable of stealing the Oppn's thunder, Rahul Gandhi will have to ensure that the INDIA bloc does not work at cross purposes.

was an eye-opener in as much for the EC's arbitrary deletion of over 22 lakh voters as the targeted disenfranchisement of the minorities and other groupings deemed to be "loyal" to the TMC. If this state of affairs continued, the Opposition's fear was that the coming polls in UP and Punjab were as good as lost to the BJP which is being held culpable for manipulating and gerrymandering the demography.

The only outcome from the discussions was to stage a "Save Democracy" march in all districts and it is expected to culminate in a demonstration outside the ECI office. Such symbolic gestures are the staple of any Opposition's playbook, be it the BJP or Congress. However, the Opposition's response carries a message that could eventually take away from the government's accountability in "sponsoring" the EC's actions. It is unlikely that CEC Gyanesh Kumar would have acted unilaterally. By attacking him, the Opposition has given an alibi to the government to shield itself from censure, a point the CJP has seized upon. Dipke's allegation is that the buck does not stop with the CEC, decried as a "puppet of the government".

TMC leader Mamata Banerjee, whose party's name and symbol stand frozen by the EC, displayed her desperation to stay afloat in INDIA. After blowing cold towards the Congress and the Left Front in the years she ruled, she tried to ingratiate herself with the Congress, proposing that the main Opposition party could have the PM's post after bringing its allies on board.

Mamata was stopped in her tracks by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, who reminded her that the gathering was not called to debate the PM's post but to "save democracy".

In the motley group that met this week, Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav was absent as he was preoccupied with the SP's Rajya Sabha nominations, which yielded a surprise after Dhanraj Nathwani, scion of Reliance Industries executive Parimal Nathwani, was named as a second candidate. Nathwani senior was elected to the Upper House as an NDA-backed candidate from Jharkhand earlier this year, but the cross-party affiliations of father and son did not bother Akhilesh.

The move was evidence of the individual strategies working in the INDIA bloc. Akhilesh is keen to refurbish the SP's pro-corporate credentials, which got lost in his hang-up over the "Backward caste, Dalit and minorities" compact. Tamil Nadu's Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, a Congress partner, did not show up. The CM, C Joseph Vijay, walked cautiously on the CEC's removal demand. The Congress' erstwhile ally, the DMK, is more forthright, but it is estranged from the INDIA. The Aam Aadmi Party stayed away, in keeping with its position to distance itself from the Congress.

Mamata's suggestion to rope in "non-aligned" forces like the BJD, YSRCP and the BRS found no takers. These parties have a history of colluding with the BJP since 2014 and would not wish to throw away their famed "neutrality" to make common cause with an Opposition formation whose trajectory remains unclear.

The Opposition, and more so, the Congress, will have to work out the fundamentals. How will it engage with the CJP if it seems that the roaches will emerge as a more credible and voluble proponent of the "Save Democracy" cause than the legacy parties? As the CJP is capable of stealing the Opposition's thunder, Rahul Gandhi and his associates will have to muster all skills at their command to ensure that INDIA hangs together and does not work at cross purposes.

Punjab's drug mission remained unfinished



CAPT AMARINDER SINGH
FORMER CHIEF MINISTER, PUNJAB

BEFORE the 2017 Assembly election, I made a strong public commitment: to break the backbone of the drug menace. I knew what that promise meant to the people of Punjab. We acted immediately. At the first Cabinet meeting after assuming office in March 2017, my government initiated a crackdown on the drug trade. We constituted a Special Task Force and Additional Director General of Police Harpreet Singh Sidhu headed it.

The STF was made answerable to the Chief Minister. The purpose was clear: create a specialised force with the authority to pursue drug networks. My direction was equally clear: no witch-hunt, but no protection either. Follow the evidence. That principle mattered. A campaign against drugs could not become an instrument for settling political scores. Equally, political influence, official position, police uniform or personal connections could not provide immunity.

In June 2017, the STF arrested inspector Inderjit Singh in a drug-trafficking case. By July 2019, data showed that 66 drug-related cases had been registered against police officials and 88 personnel had been named as accused. The then DGP described the policy as one of zero tolerance, while also stressing the need for evidence and the avoidance of a witch-hunt. But enforcement was only one part of the problem. Punjab had inherited a drug economy. It involved organised trafficking, cross-border movement, local distribution networks, pharmaceutical misuse and, just as importantly, a substantial population suffering from opioid dependence. Arresting traffickers could not, by itself, treat addiction, prevent a young person from entering the cycle or rehabilitate someone trying to leave it.

Our response developed around three interconnected pillars: enforcement, de-addiction and prevention. Together, they formed the basis of the Government's Comprehensive Action against Drug Abuse (CADA). By 2021, Punjab had 202 Outpatient Opioid Assisted Treatment centres, including 11 in prisons, besides 54 government and 224 private de-addiction and rehabilitation centres. Official

figures reported more than seven lakh cumulative patient registrations across treatment facilities.

Under the Buddy programme, 9.51 lakh groups were formed and more than 43.5 lakh students enrolled. The Drug Abuse Prevention Officer initiative registered about 6.28 lakh volunteers, who had reached more than 11.33 lakh people. By 2021, property worth more than Rs 212 crore, linked by the authorities to drug trafficking, had been frozen under the law. By September 2021, official figures placed the number of arrests in drug-related cases during our tenure at 62,744. These numbers did not prove that the drug problem had been defeated.

Where, then, did the effort fall short? That question deserves a candid answer: The STF began in the right direction, but the institutional system did not sustain its original momentum consistently. Its command structure changed. In March 2018, the STF chief was placed under the DGP rather than reporting directly to the CM. Sidhu was moved out of the STF in September 2018 and brought back in July 2019. Contemporary reporting had recorded friction within the police establishment.

A specialised anti-drug force cannot succeed in isolation. It needs the district police, intelligence agencies, prosecution, prisons, health services, financial investigators, border agencies and civil administration to function as one institutional chain. Rivalries, departmental silos and competing chains of command can gradually blunt even a force created with a clear mandate. The Covid-19 pandemic also disrupted the implementation of CADA initiatives.

As CM, I cannot place responsibility for those weaknesses elsewhere. It was my government. Ensuring that its different arms worked together was also my responsibility. Looking back, the STF needed stronger institutional continuity, greater insulation from internal rivalries and a more durable mechanism for inter-departmental coordination.

Arrests alone are an inadequate measure of success. The street peddler is only the visible end of a longer chain. The real objective must be to identify the supplier; organiser; financier and protector; trace the money; secure convictions; disrupt supply; prevent new addiction; treat those already dependent; and rehabilitate them into society.

My commitment in 2017 was genuine. The mission remained unfinished. Even though during my second government, from 2017 to 2021, we caught many drug smugglers/suppliers, I would rather acknowledge that than rewrite history.

Allowing the Word to reach libraries and homes



SHELLEY WALIA
FORMER PROFESSOR & FELLOW,
ENGLISH & CULTURAL STUDIES, PU

THERE are few acts of reverence in Sikh life more familiar, or more moving, than the sight of *Guru Granth Sahib* being carried on the head. The *Saroop* is opened with ceremony, placed with care and carried with a reverence that has become part of the lived grammar of Sikh faith. *Beadbi* is therefore not an abstract offence. To treat *Guru Granth Sahib* with contempt, to damage it deliberately or to violate the practices through which its sanctity is preserved is to wound something deeply ingrained in the community.

Punjab's new legislation against sacrilege has arisen from this powerful and under-

standable sentiment. So, what are we protecting when we protect *Guru Granth Sahib*?

The physical *Saroop* (Body) deserves the reverence with which it is treated. What makes it sacred is the *Bani* or the Word, the teaching, the thought that has travelled through generations and continues to speak to minds far beyond the place where the *Granth* itself rests. The distinction matters because a scripture can be honoured in two ways. One, by guarding its physical form, and two, by allowing its words to be read, understood, translated and carried into lives that may not have access to the original language. The translation liberates the Word buried in the text through the liberation and its re-creation.

While the Body is a matter of reverence, the Word remains a matter of veneration and intellectual life. Indeed, the extraordinary respect accorded to the *Saroop* should not make us forget the extraordinary mobility of the Word. The Guru's teaching was never meant to remain enclosed within one space, one institution or one language. Sikhism grew through the mobility of ideas, through conversation, poetry, music, interpretation and the meeting of different linguistic and

Guru Granth Sahib deserves readers across the globe, who understand and grapple with their own understanding of it. That is how a tradition grows and remains alive.

cultural worlds. The *Bani* carries traces of Punjabi, Persian, Sanskrit, etc. Its strength lies partly in its capacity to cross boundaries.

This is why translation deserves to be separated from sacrilege. A person carrying *Guru Granth Sahib* on his head or the one carrying its words into another language are both performing service of reverence.

Let us examine the lesson apparent in the history of Christianity in 16th-century England. Once a scripture could be printed in the vernacular and reproduced in huge num-

bers, the *Bible* began to move beyond the precincts of the Church and into the hands of readers. Latin did not disappear, nor the institutional authority of the Church. But the ordinary reader could now encounter the text directly, in a language he could understand, and could begin to ask what it meant. The *Koran* is read in many languages. The *Gita* and the *Ramayana* have travelled beyond Sanskrit origins through translations and retellings. Translation has enabled them to become part of many more lives and traditions.

Guru Granth Sahib has its history of such intellectual openness. Manmohan Singh and Gopal Singh produced English renderings and Gurbachan Singh Talib's English translation was published by Punjabi University. Such work was not an act of *beadbi*. It was scholarship attempting to make the *Bani* accessible to those who could not encounter it in its original language. That is why the question should not be whether the *Saroop* is being protected.

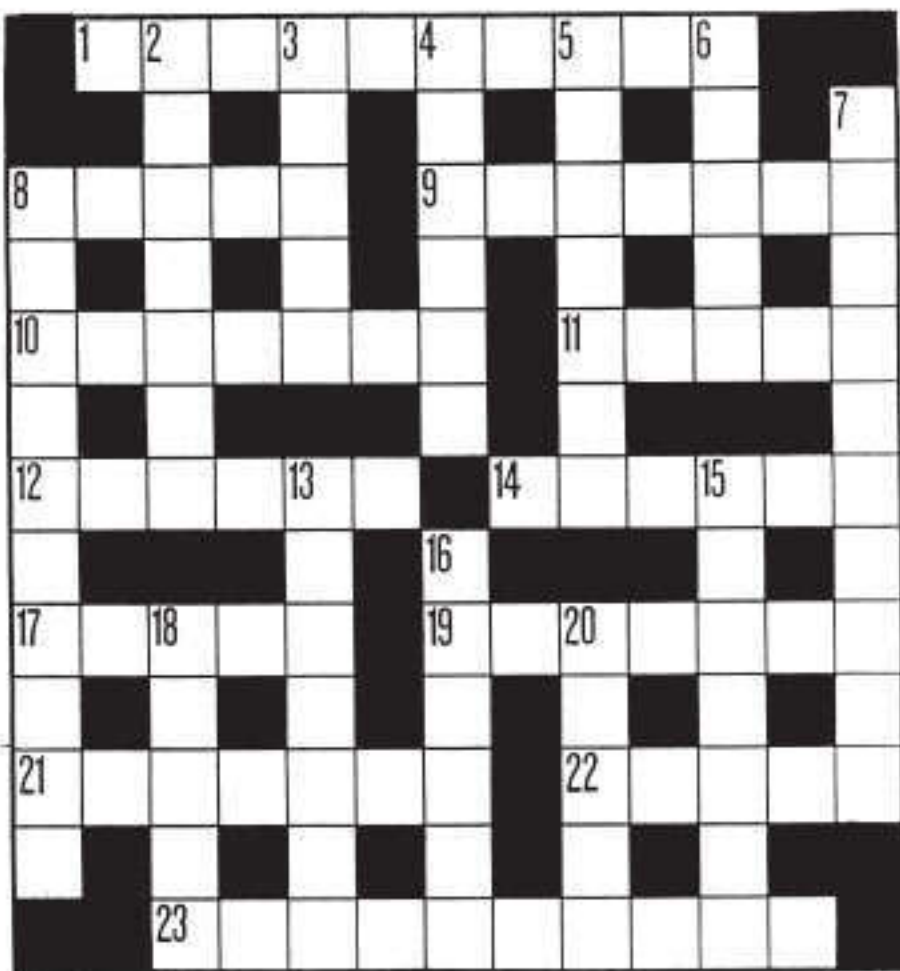
It should also be whether the Word is being allowed to travel. If *Guru Granth Sahib* is to speak to the world, its words must travel to universities and libraries and homes, to

readers in Britain, Canada, America, Australia and elsewhere.

There is no reason why this wider circulation should diminish its sanctity. Gurdwaras could maintain regulated bookshops where authorised editions, translations and works of Sikh scholarship are available. A translated or scholarly edition of *Guru Granth Sahib* could be kept respectfully in a room in a home or a university library or in the study of a scholar. Its sanctity does not disappear because a reader encounters its teaching in another language.

This is not an argument against *maryada*, nor a licence for carelessness towards the physical *Saroop*, which will and must remain protected by the practices that have honoured it for centuries. My concern is wider circulation of the *Bani* for it to travel across borders and languages so that people may gain from its universal humanism. While sacrilege is an act against the physical body of the scripture, any policing of words becomes an act against thought, interpretation and belief. *Guru Granth Sahib* deserves readers across the globe, who understand and grapple with their own understanding of it. That is how a tradition grows and remains alive.

QUICK CROSSWORD



ACROSS

- 1 A stop included in itinerary (4,2,4)
- 8 Audible warning device (5)
- 9 Philosopher (7)
- 10 Fleet commander (7)
- 11 An extra benefit (5)
- 12 Insanity (6)
- 14 Kindly (6)
- 17 Factory (5)
- 19 Caught (7)
- 21 Bravery (7)
- 22 Magnificence (5)
- 23 Rebuke (4,2,4)

Yesterday's Solution

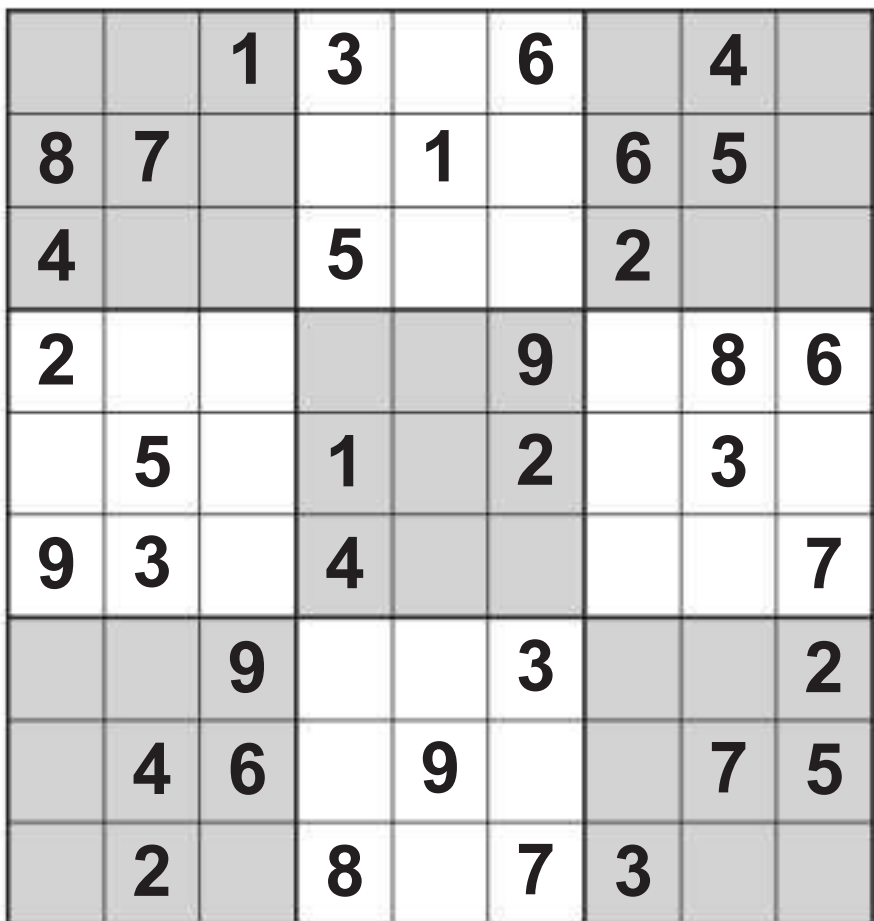
Across: 1 Recede, 4 Stable, 9 Playful, 10 Tract, 11 Sit-in, 12 Typhoon, 13 Get even with, 18 Triumph, 20 Undue, 22 Peril, 23 Lodging, 24 Dampen, 25 Mettle.

Down: 1 Repast, 2 Coast, 3 Defence, 5 Tot up, 6 Bear out, 7 Extent, 8 All the while, 14 Epigram, 15 Would-be, 16 Stupid, 17 Meagre, 19 Melee, 21 Drift.

DOWN

- 2 Rower (7)
- 3 Purport (5)
- 4 Useless (6)
- 5 Congenial (7)
- 6 Compare (5)
- 7 Contemporary (7-3)
- 8 Very slow speed (6,4)
- 13 Retrench (3,4)
- 15 Profane (7)
- 16 Taking some optimistic view (2,4)
- 18 Fully mature (5)
- 20 Feeling of insecurity (5)

SU DO KU



V. EASY

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SU DO KU

YESTERDAY'S SOLUTION												
5	6	8	4	9	3	2	1	7				
7	4	9	5	2	1	6	3	8				
3	2	1	8	6	7	4	5	9				
6	9	7	1	3	8	5	4	2				
8	1	2	9	4	5	7	6	3				
4	3	5	2	7	6	8	9	1				
1	7	4	6	8	9	3	2	5				
9	8	6	3	5	2	1	7	4				
2	5	3	7	1	4	9	8	6				

CALENDAR

OCTOBER 3, 2026, SATURDAY												
■ Shaka Samvat	1948											
■ Ashwin Shaka	11											
■ Ashwin Parvishite	17											
■ Hijari	1448											
■ Krishna Paksha Tithi 7, up to 8:00 am												
■ Krishna Paksha Tithi 8, up to 3:52 am												
■ Vairyan Yoga up to 3:22 pm												
■ Aardra Nakshatra up to 1:30 am												
■ Moon in Gemini sign												

FORECAST

SUNSET:	SATURDAY	18:06 HRS
SUNRISE:	SUNDAY	06:18 HRS
CITY	MAX	MIN
Chandigarh	35	24
New Delhi	34	23
Amritsar	33	22
Bathinda	34	21
Jalandhar	33	21
Ludhiana	35	23
Bhiwani	34	23
Hisar	36	23
Sirsa	35	23
Dharamsala	30	17
Manali	26	12
Shimla	26	16
Srinagar	30	11
Jammu	33	20
Kargil	22	05
Leh	20	04
Dehradun	33	20
Mussoorie	20	14

TEMPERATURE IN °C

12% NABARD projects completed in J&K, ₹461.67 crore unutilised: CAG

ARJUN SHARMA

JAMMU, OCTOBER 2
A performance audit by the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) has revealed significant delays and under-utilisation of funds in NABARD-funded rural infrastructure projects in Jammu and Kashmir, with only 32 of 263 projects due for completion having been completed by March 2023.

The audit found that against a loan assistance of Rs 3,900 crore consented by the Centre under the Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF), Jammu and Kashmir availed Rs 2,316.37 crore. Of the Rs 844.17 crore released during 2018-23, Rs 461.67 crore remained unutilised.

The audit on the execution of works under NABARD-RIDF by the Public Works and Jal Shakti Departments covered the period from April 2018 to March 2023 and

ONLY 32 OF 263 PROJECTS SEE LIGHT OF DAY	
■ Only 32 of 263 NABARD-funded projects due by March 2023 were completed, CAG audit found	■ Weak planning, missing clearances and defective DPRs contributed to stalled and abandoned projects
■ Of ₹844.17 crore released, ₹461.67 crore remained unutilised during 2018-23	■ CAG recommended stronger planning, financial discipline and technical scrutiny

examined whether project selection and implementation processes were adequate and effective.

According to the report, National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD) disbursements ranged between 28 per cent and 84 per cent of sanctioned loans across different tranches, mainly due to slow progress of works. In several cases, sanctioned loans lapsed because prescribed timelines were not adhered to.

The audit also pointed to lapses by the Finance Department in managing mobilisation advances, including delays in release

to implementing departments, non-release in some cases and excess disbursement in others. Instances of non-utilisation of mobilisation advances by executing agencies were also reported.

“These deficiencies adversely affected cash flow and the timely execution of projects,” the report noted.

The CAG observed weaknesses in project planning and prioritisation across departments. Baseline data and State/UT-level planning frameworks envisaged under NABARD guidelines were either absent or not effectively utilised. Mandatory requirements, includ-

ing availability of encumbrance-free land, forest and statutory clearances, viable water sources and technically sound DPRs, were often not ensured before project sanction or execution, leading to stalled, abandoned or foreclosed works.

The report further highlighted systemic deficiencies in project execution, including delays in fund release, non-commencement of works, diversion and misutilisation of funds, execution without technical sanction, defective DPRs, improper site selection and inadequate contract management.

Monitoring and inspection mechanisms were found to be weak, with periodic field inspections either not conducted or inadequately documented. As a result, only 32 projects, accounting for nearly 12 per cent of the 263 projects due for completion by

March 2023, were completed, while the remaining 231 were either incomplete or yet to commence.

The audit noted that against the total release of Rs 844.17 crore during the audit period, expenditure stood at only Rs 382.50 crore, leaving 55 per cent of the funds unutilised. The yearly unspent amount ranged from 4 per cent to 72 per cent.

The CAG concluded that the intended objectives of irrigation and flood management, safe drinking water supply and improved rural road connectivity were not achieved within the envisaged timelines. It recommended strengthening institutional planning, financial discipline, inter-departmental coordination, technical scrutiny and monitoring mechanisms to ensure effective utilisation of NABARD assistance and timely delivery of benefits.



The Vande Bharat achieved the speed milestone by crossing the Chenab and Anji bridges at 100 kmph. FILE

In key milestone, Vande Bharat hits 100 kmph on 2 vital bridges

OUR CORRESPONDENT

JAMMU, OCTOBER 2
Indian Railways on Friday achieved a major milestone as a Vande Bharat Express crossed the world's highest railway bridge over the Chenab and India's first cable-stayed railway bridge at Anji at a speed of 100 kmph.

The feat came after Railways increased the maximum permissible speed on the 111-km Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra-Banihal section of the Udhampur-Srinagar-Baramulla Rail Link (USBRL) project from 75 kmph to 100 kmph.

In an official statement, Railways said the enhanced speed was successfully tested on Friday.

Senior Divisional Commercial Manager Uchit Singhal said Vande Bharat Express trains (26401/26404) created a new record by crossing both the Chenab and Anji bridges at 100 kmph.

“The enhancement will make train operations on the USBRL project smoother, reduce travel time and provide passengers with a faster, safer and more comfortable journey,” he said.

The 111-km Katra-Banihal section is one of the most challenging stretches of the USBRL project, which aims to provide seamless rail connectivity between the Kashmir Valley and the rest of the country.

Sharing a video of the trial run, Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw posted on X:

“100 km/h over India's engineering pride!”

The Railway Ministry approved the increase in permissible speed after all prescribed safety conditions were fulfilled by August this year.

Earlier, trains were permitted to run at a maximum speed of 85 kmph on the Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra-Sangaldan section and 75 kmph on the Sangaldan-Banihal stretch.

Railway officials said the speed enhancement is expected to reduce travel time and improve operational efficiency while offering passengers faster and more comfortable connectivity.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi had flagged off the Katra-Srinagar Vande Bharat Express in June last year.



Pahalgam MLA Altaf Ahmad

Pahalgam MLA, NC leader booked for ‘assaulting’ PSO

SRINAGAR, OCTOBER 2
The Jammu and Kashmir Police have booked National Conference MLA Altaf Ahmad and party spokesperson Umesh Bhat after a personal security officer of the legislator alleged that they assaulted him while he was performing his official duties, officials said on Friday.

They said an FIR has been registered under Sections 121 and 351 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) at the Sadar Anantnag police station.

According to a complaint filed by Ahmad's Personal Security Officer (PSO), he was allegedly beaten up by the Pahalgam MLA and the NC spokesperson following an altercation. The PSO alleged that he sustained injuries in the assault, officials said.

Speaking to reporters, Ahmad rejected the allegation as baseless. The Pahalgam legislator said he had raised a complaint with the SSP (Security) after the PSO remained absent from duty for three days. “He (PSO) asked me why I reported it to the SSP. I told him, ‘Let the SSP look into it and verify the facts,’” Ahmad said, adding that, however, the PSO “grabbed my neck in front of my cook and other PSOs, and was very violent”. The MLA said he would file a counter-FIR against the PSO. — PTI

Key accused held in Srinagar drug bust posed as scribe, flaunted political links

ADIL AKHZER

SRINAGAR, OCTOBER 2
A day after Srinagar Police claimed to have unearthed a structured inter-state narcotics network, it has emerged that one of the key accused in the case was associated with a purported news portal and had posted photographs on social media with senior politicians and police officers.

On Thursday, Srinagar Police said it had arrested eight persons after uncovering a network allegedly involved in the procurement, transportation, storage, distribution and financing of banned pharmaceutical drugs, with links extending beyond Jammu and Kashmir.

Among those arrested was Haris Hameed Malla, a Srinagar resident whom police believe to be a key accused in the network allegedly headed

by Waseem Ahmad Zargar.

Sources said Malla allegedly used his association with journalism to establish contacts and would claim to have access to “powerful people” in the system.

On his social media profile, Malla described himself as the Editor-in-Chief of ‘Indian News Panel’, besides identifying himself as a public speaker, social activist and “community journalist” based in J&K.

His Instagram account features photographs with Union Ministers Nitin Gadkari and Chirag Paswan, and Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge.

The account also carries photographs with several police officers in the Kashmir Valley. In a video uploaded last year, Malla is seen accompanying a senior officer during his visit to an area in Srinagar.

Sources alleged that Malla

used his professional identity to establish contacts and obtain photographs with politicians and government officials. They said several officers stopped entertaining him after learning of his alleged involvement in illegal activities.

“Apparently, his main idea behind posting the pictures was to create an impression that he knew powerful people,” sources said.

Malla had also posted on X a letter purportedly written by J&K Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha in connection with the Union Territory's efforts to combat drug abuse. The letter, addressed to the “Editor-in-Chief” of “Indian News Panel”, requested engagement in disseminating information about the dangers of substance abuse, treatment services and the importance of early intervention.

“A drug-free Jammu &

Kashmir is a collective promise to our children, our families, and to our Union Territory. Let us honour that promise together,” the letter stated.

Sources said Malla left the Valley after allegedly receiving information that police were looking for him. Police subsequently traced him to Bengaluru, Karnataka, through technical surveillance, they said.

According to police, the arrests led to the recovery of Rs 85.75 lakh in cash, more than two lakh pharmaceutical drug tablets and capsules, 40 grams of a heroin-like substance, 108 gold coins, gold biscuits and other gold ornaments and articles worth crores of rupees, besides a pistol.

Police had said on Thursday that two other accused were absconding in connection with the case.

2 limestone blocks auctioned in J&K

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2
The Centre on Friday said the two mineral blocks in Jammu and Kashmir have been successfully auctioned, marking the beginning of organised mineral development in the region.

The government of Jammu & Kashmir (UT) had entrusted the auction of mineral blocks to the mines ministry.

Koot-Kapran limestone block has an estimated limestone resources of 4.75 million tonnes. The block has been explored up to the G-4 stage, providing scope for further detailed exploration and development, the mines ministry said in a statement.

G-4 stage mining refers to the reconnaissance survey phase, which is the earliest regional exploration stage used to identify areas with enhanced mineral potential.

The Wantrag limestone block has an estimated resources of 10.853 million tonnes. The block has been explored up to the G-3 stage, including 159 metres of drilling, providing an important geological basis for further exploration and development.

A G-3 stage in mining refers to the prospecting or preliminary exploration phase.

The successful completion of the auction reflects the use of a transparent and competitive mineral auction process for the systematic development of mineral resources, the statement added.

The sale of the two limestone blocks is likely to catalyse new investment and economic activity in the Union Territory. As mining and associated activities develop, they are expected to generate a large number of direct and indirect employment opportunities and create avenues for local businesses, entrepreneurs, service providers and allied industries. — PTI

FROM PAGE 1

Congbanks on 3-time MLA Pargat...

a police officer and later a politician. He joined the Congress in December 2016, shortly before the 2017 Assembly elections, along with former cricketer-turned-politician Navjot Singh Sidhu.

Sachin Pilot, Congress general secretary for Punjab, had recently told The Tribune that Warring's replacement was likely and also that having many CM aspirants was a strength, not a weakness.

Earlier today, Warring met Rahul and formally tendered his resignation, a day after changing his X bio to describe himself as a “former

Punjab Congress president”. Warring told Rahul he would serve the party in whatever capacity he was asked to.

“I met Rahul and formally submitted my resignation as the Punjab Congress president. He gave me a lot of love,” Warring said.

He said Rahul reviewed the Punjab situation and sought a feedback on ground realities in the state, including what was happening with the AAP government and what should be done going forward.

“I shared with him my four-and-a-half years of experience as the Punjab Congress

president, the challenges we have, how we have to fight those challenges and where our strengths lie. This was the focus of the discussion,” said Warring, who was called to Delhi yesterday.

The Ludhiana MP said he thanked Rahul for giving him the opportunity to lead the state Congress under difficult circumstances. “I assured him that I am ready to serve the party whenever it requires me,” Warring said. Warring had taken charge as the state chief in April 2022 after the party's worst-ever showing in the Assembly elections.

Juvenile among 9 held in LPU case; 2 nabbed over Chitkara varsity unrest

victim of which had not yet been identified. CCTV footage was being scanned and staff members, students, hostellers and wardens were being questioned, he added.

Responding to queries about whether a conspiracy or pre-planned strategy was behind the protests, the DIG said the probe was being conducted from all angles and that no one would be spared. The accused have been arrested under Sections 109 (attempt to murder),

132 (assault), 221 (voluntary obstruction of a public servant), 326(b) (mischief causing damage to a public road or bridge), 326(g) (mischief by fire or explosive substance), 324(4) (damage to property) and 309(4) (robbery) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), along with Section 4 of the Punjab Prevention of Damage to Public and Private Property Act, 2014.

Meanwhile, in the Chitkara University case, the Patiala

police identified the arrested accused as Himanshu from Nangal and Aryan from Ambala. During the investigation, the police said it emerged that the duo had instigated students by circulating misleading messages on social media groups, contributing to the escalation of the situation on the university campus.

Following the unrest, an FIR was registered at the Banur police station and a large-scale investigation was

launched. The Police examined social media activity and fake messages circulated by students and other notorious persons. Police teams have been dispatched to various locations to apprehend the remaining 10 accused.

“The investigation is in progress to identify more persons involved in spreading misinformation, instigating students and damaging public property,” Patiala SSP Harmandeep Singh Hans said.

Ladakh launches pilot saffron cultivation project

SRINAGAR, OCTOBER 2
The Ladakh administration has launched an ambitious pilot project to cultivate saffron in the high-altitude cold desert, seeking to assess the crop's suitability to the region's climatic conditions and explore its economic potential.

The experiment is being undertaken at Spituk Park in Leh, where nearly 800 kg of premium Iranian saffron corms — about 90,000 in number — have been planted across nearly 4,000 square metres of land that was barren until recently. According to the administration, the land has been restored and rejuvenated as part of a broader effort to convert degraded areas into productive agricultural assets. — OC

Couldn't let anyone die, flydubai pilot tells PM Modi

his mother had imbued him with the values of the Shrimad Bhagavad Gita.

Earlier in his interaction with the PM, Machchhar said although he lived abroad, he had instilled Indian values in his children. The conversation was emotional at times.

“I was surprised to see Geeta Ben (Smit's mother) speak with such composure. I had not thought she could hold her nerve despite such a shocking development,” PM Modi told the recovering pilot, adding that India was waiting to welcome him.

Machchhar's first

remark to the Prime Minister was: “I never thought I would get to speak to you. You are my ideal.”

The government is closely monitoring Machchhar's health, with India's Ambassador to the UAE having met him in hospital on Thursday.

The Indian Embassy in Abu Dhabi and the Consulate in Dubai are in close touch with local authorities regarding his condition. As first reported by *The Tribune*, the government is considering recommending Machchhar for the Ashok Chakra, India's highest peacetime gallantry award.

4-gold haul by...

Parveen had also qualified for the Paris Olympics but missed the Games after being suspended by the World Anti-Doping Agency over three whereabouts failures.

Another gold followed through 21-year-old boxer Ankush Panghal of Bheria village in Hisar district. He defeated South Korea's Kim Minseong 4-0 in the 80 kg final to claim the Asian Games title. Ankush, who had also won the gold at the 2026 Commonwealth Games, became the first Indian male boxer since Amit Panghal in 2018 to win an Asian Games gold.

The fourth gold was delivered by wrestler Sujeet Kalkal, who completed Haryana's golden haul of the day with a dramatic victory in the 65 kg freestyle

category. The Imlota village resident from Charkhi Dadri district, who has been training in Sonapat, fought back from a 2-9 deficit against Tajikistan's Abdulmazhid Kudiev to win 10-9, producing one of the most dramatic comebacks of the Games. Sujeet's father and coach, Dayanand Kalkal, who is associated with the Sports Authority of India in Sonapat, expressed pride in his son's achievement. “Sujeet has done something remarkable. He has won not just our hearts but those of the entire country,” he said. For Haryana, the four gold medals in a single day came across disciplines ranging from recurve archery, a relatively lesser-known sport, to the state's traditional strongholds of boxing and wrestling.

Women hockey gold...

unleashed a strike that sent the ball into the net. As the goal celebrations died down, India realised they still had a huge task in front of them. They had to keep the world No. 4 China, who had won the silver medal at the 2024 Olympics, from scoring with more than three quarters remaining.

A year ago, that task would have seemed impossible. With the team stuck in a downward spiral after failing to qualify for the 2024 Olympics, India was hammered 4-1 by China in the final of the Asia Cup. A lot has changed since last September though, with Hockey India reappointing Marijne as the team's coach in January. The return of the Dutchman, who had guided the team to a fourth-place finish in the 2021 Tokyo Olympics, brought back belief among a

set of players deflated by an unending string of losses.

India's revival was built on team unity. Just like he did in his previous stint, Marijne transformed the team into a close-knit unit working hard on defence. That defensive resilience helped India finish fifth at the recent World Cup.

On Friday, the team proved its World Cup performance was not a fluke. As China came at India with all their might, the Salima Tete-led side refused to relent, fulfilling their goal of conquering Asia and returning to the Olympics. “I think one of the biggest changes has been discipline, and secondly, working for each other. I always say that if you focus on the team goal, you will achieve your individual goal,” Marijne said.

India officially names keysites in China-held Aksai Chin

Notably, several historical names associated with the old Ladakh-Kashgar trade route have been retained. These include Khatai Dewan, Haji Langar, Qizil Jilga and Qazil Dewan, all located in Aksai Chin.

In her 1999 book *Trans-Himalayan Caravans: Merchant Princes and Peasant Traders in Ladakh*, historian Janet Rizvi notes that trade caravans between Ladakh and Kashgar operated regularly until 1937 and were dominated by Punjabi merchants from Hoshiarpur.

India and China have both previously issued separate lists of renamed places in Arunachal Pradesh.

Brides Wanted

JAT SIKH

Smart, handsome, teetotaler, 1994 born, 5'-8", turbaned boy B.Tech (Biomedical), working MNC Chandigarh, Hometown- Hisar. PR 98134-93979. (CL26048377)

Hi-status Jatt Sikh, 2003/ 6', Computer Science Engineering Graduate, 100 acres agricultural land in Malwa/ residential properties in Chandigarh, Amritsar, Shimla/ two gas stations, bureau excuse. 98144-36399. (CL26051338)

Canadian born Jatt Sikh, never married, 39, 6'-2", healthcare professional, pleasant and family oriented. Seeking and educated, pleasant, well mannered girl from a respectable Sikh family with good values. Family only matrimonial agencies not invited. Contact: 95929-00329. (CL26051389)

Suitable alliance invited from well settled Jatt Sikh family for Canadian PR handsome boy 1995/ 5'-11", Graduated from India Masters from Reputed Canadian University interested ones. Contact- 97815-00015. (CL26051513)

Professionally qualified US citizen/ PR/ H1B match for Jatt Sikh Boy, March 95, 6', handsome, B.Tech, M S Comp Sc (USA), Sr Machine Learning Eng in reputed company New York, (H1B, GC being processed) well educated family settled in Gurugram. 98107-91652, 98685-01530. (CL26050760)

Wanted a highly qualified Jatt Sikh/Rajput bride for 1997 born, 5'-10", Jatt Sikh boy (clean shaven), B.Tech. (aerospace), MBA (IIM Mumbai), CFA, Working in MNC (KPMG), Father retired GM, mother Group A officer (GOI), sister child specialist (Engaged), preferred M.Tech/ B.Tech, MBA/ Doctor girl Contact 94635-42748. (CL26050861)

35, 5'-10", Jatt Sikh (Brar), Lawyer, well-settled, Agriculture & Commercial Property, from Bathinda. Seeking an educated, family-oriented girl from the Malwa belt/Tricity. 98728-06016. (CL26050979)

Jat Sikh, 32/ 5'-7", Canada PR, handsome boy. Studied B.Tech in Electronics and Communications from India and SCM in Canada. Boy has a job and business in Canada. Seeks educated, beautiful girl from good family. Prefer girl who is living in Canada. E-Mail: sukhparr2025@gmail.com. Please whatsapp +1 64750-17304 for any more details. (CL26051035)

Jat Sikh tall, handsome boy 27/ 6'-2", M.A., B.Ed financially well settled, belongs to reputed educated family. Seeking tall beautiful educated girl. 94171-18116. (CL26051186)

Jatt Sikh boy, 6'-0", 1994, Canadian PR, looking for well educated girl. +91-94637-41306. (CL26051428)

Compatible educated match for Jatt Sikh, 6'-11", 1989, Regional Manager settled MNC, 22 LPA. Father Retd. Gazetted Officer; brother abroad. Send biodata 98551-12029, 96466-40104. (CL26051475)

Jat Sikh PR match from Vancouver/ Surry for Canadian Citizen Chauhan boy 1998/ 5'-8", Working Electronic design engineer, Vancouver. Mother Sarao, Father retired (Indian Navy). Rural urban properties. Patiala, Sangrur preferred. Bureau excuse. 94638-68730. (CL26051685)

Jat Sikh boy June 1989/ 5'-10", Practicing lawyer. Shortly divorced, no issue. Wanted Educated girl Patiala. WhatsApp 98687-69879. (CL26051768)

Well educated match for Jatt Sikh 39 years, 6' tall, well settled in US High school St John's Chandigarh Educated as an Engineer from US Has green card status Mutually divorced issueless Educated family with agricultural and urban property in Punjab and The Tricity of Chandigarh Match from US / Canada preferred Indians with valid visa can contact Kindly contact WhatsApp 98290-50474, Bureau excuse. (CL26051843)

Jat Sikh alliance invited for well settled boy, 31 years, 5'-8", U.S. citizen, employed with reputed multinational company. Belongs to respected business family with strong family values. Seeking well educated, professionally qualified Jatt Sikh girl, preferably residing in the USA or Canada. Interested families may send recent photograph and biodata to pamnadeep@gmail.com. (CL26043000)

Jatt Sikh boy 27/ 5'-7" educated, running Sanitary business in Patiala. Please contact 98889-01144, 89685-31144. (CL26051631)

Reputed family amridhhari boy 30 yro on work permit in Canada seeking PR girl, mob 98157-01926. (CL26051452)

Suitable match for handsome Jat Sikh boy, 31, 5'-9" from educated, respectable family. Working in IT division of financial services company. 78372-88982. (CL26047320)

PQM4 Jatt Sikh Canadian handsome, non-smoker, non-drinker, family oriented Canadian citizen raised in Canada, 36/ 5'-9", Advance Diploma in Elec. Eng & Diploma in Inf. Tech with a lot of certifications currently working with Federal Government in GTA, only child, Father Retd. Senior Officer, India, Mother working in Federal Corporation. Own property in Canada, Punjab & Delhi. No bureaus. Contact WhatsApp: 14164007895. (CL26049211)

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Suitable match for very handsome Jat Sikh boy 1999, 6'-1", (Canada PR). Father mother Govt. employee, residing in Mohali, elder sister married and settled in USA. Contact: 97800-36212. (CL26051563)

Match for Jat Sikh teetotaler Mohali based boy, 1994/5'-8", B.Arch., working as Architect in Mohali, New Zealand PR. Rural urban property. Father rettd. Class-I Officer. 9876409605 (CL26051593)

Looking for a suitable match for Jatt Sikh Sidhu boy (only child), 2001 born/ height 5'-9", Australian PR, good rural and urban properties. Contact: 95019-59391. (CL26051619)

SM for Doctor of Pharmacy Jat Sikh Aulakh boy, 30/ 6'-4", living Sacramento, California USA citizen. Seeking beautiful, tall, educated work, study visa and PR girl. +1(510)6403166, +98155-65975. (CL26051658)

Jat Sikh turbaned boy, vegetarian1997 born, 6'-2", convent educated, Civil Engineering from Australia, working as Project Engineer in Melbourne & Citizen. Seeking suitable match for their son. Preference girl living in Australia. 78885-41589. (CL26051661)

SM for Doctor of Pharmacy Jat Sikh Aulakh boy 30/ 6'-4", living Sacramento, California USA citizen. Seeking beautiful, tall, educated work, study visa and PR girl. +1(510)640-3166, +98155-65975. (CL26051675)

Canadian Citizen Jat Sikh, 34, 5'-11", LLB, Parts Advisor, Mazda (Toronto), having commercial property. 98155-93953. (CL26051686)

Canada citizen boy born 97/ 6'-2", seeks educated girl with moral values (Mohali) 82402-21561. (CL26050763)

Suitable match for 28, 6', turbaned Jatsikh boy, working as AI Engineer in Swiss Company. Double Graduation from USA. Preference to Professionally qualified USA settled match. Marriage bureau excuse. 98880-70460. (CL26051713)

Suitable match Australian citizen Jat Sikh Pannu boy 33/ 6'-3", own business boy in India, marriage bureau excuse. 94641-92382. (CL26051785)

Suitable match for Jat Sikh boy (born 2001, 6' tall, Advocate) from Fatehgarh Sahib Contact: 98553-98000. (CL26051822)

Jatt Sikh boy Doctor (MBBS), 30/ 5'-10", vegetarian family, seeking Doctor (MBBS) girl. 99149-52950. (CL26051899)

Match for Canadian PR Jat Sikh boy, 9.12.1994, 5'-8", M.Sc., 2 acre land. Require B.Sc. Nursing/ Equally qualified girl. Preferred Distt. Ludhiana/Fatehgarh Sahib, Ropar, Mohali. 76580-40031. (CL26051900)

Suitable match for Jatt Sikh boy 29, 6', MBBS doing private job trying for MD. Land 18 acre +9 shops, younger brother Canada, father & mother Govt. Teacher. 94630-60461. (CL26051901)

Compatible match for tall, handsome, late September 1994, cleanshaven, B.Tech. & very talented, family educated & well. WhatsApp: 99880-85941. (CL26051916)

SIKH

Jatt Sikh boy from Yamunanagar (Haryana) 1995/ 5'-7", Central Govt job in CISF. Marriage bureau excuse. WhatsApp 63961-81686. (CL26051063)

Canadian citizen boy, 6', 27, pursuing Doctor of Optometry, vegetarian, seeks suitable alliance, caste no bar. 97795-90923. (CL26051098)

Canada Citizen, Sikh, Tonk-Kashthiya, 1997 born, Graduate boy 5'-10", own house in Winnipeg. 98146-94635. (CL26051127)

Khanuja Sikh boy, 28 yrs/ 5'-9", IT/Inf, working as Quant Researcher at Gurugram. Seeking suitable match from respectable family. Contact: 9874-61533, 94133-43232. (CL26051295)

Match for Ramdasia Sikh boy 33/6'-2" Radhaswami, Chandigarh. Well-settled, Runs Travel consultancy + Job, Earning good, Owns flat in Chandigarh & Kothi Kanar in Kharar. Contact: 9958155664. (CL26051301)

Match for simple, non drinker, Sikh Kashyap, Rajput boy, 1989/ 5'-6", Postgraduate, Working in Govt. Deptt, on Outsource Basis at Chandigarh. Seeking educated, cultured girl. Caste no bar. Send details at WhatsApp: 94178-78556. (CL26051336)

Well educated alliance for our son, 5'-10"/ 1983 born, B.Tech., MBA, Ramdasia Sikh, working in Multinational Company in Sr position. Caste no bar. WhatsApp 94170-02515. (CL26051403)

Wanted well qualified beautiful match for Canadian PR handsome Tonk Kashatri boy, 1993 born, 5'-6", very well settled in 3D Animation field. Elder sister also Canadian PR. Father rettd. Punjab Govt. employee. Contact: 9872669734. Email: ba t t u s g 7 3 4 @ g m a i l . c o m (CL26050532)

Beautiful and well educated match for handsome Kamboj Sikh boy, 5'-10", 1994, Post Graduate from Canada, well established business in Punjab, urban residence, urban and rural property, Income 4-5 Lakh per month. Prefer Indian girls only. Contact: 93566-43224. Marriage bureau and NRI excuse. (CL26051163)

Tonk Kshatri boy, 89, 5'-11", BCA, MBA, settled in Mohali. Caste no bar. 94170-84854. (CL26051399)

Match for Sikh Rajput boy 1997, 5'-8", working in Punjab Govt as JE. Seeks Govt. job girl. Contact: 94633-67107. (CL26051495)

Suitable match for PR New Zealand handsome Sikh boy, 5'-5",1992 born, MBA (Hotel Management) Working Hotel Manager. Family well settled in Chandigarh. 99157-15455, 82880-35846. (CL26051525)

Match for Sikh Lobana boy 1997, 5'-8", citizen in New Zealand and employed in reputed firm as Area Manager there. Two sisters- both married and settled in Abroad. Father retired from Central Govt. Seeking educated, well mannered Sikh girl from respectable family. 94667-19503, 70824-36722. (CL26051640)

Architect Sikh boy, March 1993, 5'-8", running own business. Seeks well-educated girl. Caste no bar. 98553-05934. (CL26051847)

SIKH KHATRI

Suitable match for handsome boy, 1999, 5'-9"-4, based in Chandigarh. Master's and Bachelor's from top Global Universities. Leads his own healthcare technology firm and manages investments. Well-established family. Contact: +91-98788-25567. (CL26051097)

Seeking a suitable Sikh Khatri match for our son, born in 1996, 5'-7½", working with a top MNC in Chandigarh,. Belongs to a well educated high status family. Father serving as a Senior Officer. Seeking a well educated, cultural girl from a well reputed family. Phone: 98143-33985. (CL26051851)

Compatible match for well educated Doctor (Dentist), 1986 born, height 5'-6", smart boy. Belonging to well settled and reputable family. Family (Medical) Professionals and Agriculturist) owns Urban and Rural property. Contact 98885-25044 (CL26051626)

Seeking educated, cultured girl from Tricity for Mohali based handsome Sikh Khatri boy. 1994 December born 5'-8" MBA, well established real estate business. Contact: 99149-06266, 98551-36266. (CL26051363)

Suitable match for Sikh Khatri MBA boy height 6'-4", 1990 born, (Businessman), preferred Immigration Consultant/ Advocate/ Real Estate Consultant. 88378-57109. (CL26051792)

Suitable match for a Sikh Khatri (Walia) boy 5'-9", born in 1991, MCA currently working in Chandigarh, no dowry demand. 95929-91553. (CL26051477)

Govt job, handsome Sikh Khatri boy, 1993/ 6', convent educated, B.Tech., MBA. 9779585588. (CL26051153)

Khatri Sikh boy 1991, 5'-8", B.Tech., job Gurgaon, good package, non vegetarian, required educated girl. 98159-70049. (CL26051862)

Smart 1990 born, 6'-2", Hotel Management, Graduate, own event management business. Well settled. 98142-83100. (CL26051866)

Suitable educated match for Khukhrain Khatri Gursikh boy 1990, 5'-10", B.Tech., Cloth Merchants, income 50000/- per month. 98722-32585. (CL26051898)

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SIKH LOBANA

Lubana Gursikh boy 30/ 5'-10", company job, package 39 lakh, preferred Gursikh girl. 86991-86338. (CL26051553)

SIKH ARORA

Sikh Arora, 51, 5'-11", divorced, issueless, Delhi, seeks match. Caste/religion no bar. Email: matrimonial.profile2026@outlook.co.m (CL26051487)

Alliance invited for smart Sikh Arora boy, 1995/ 5'-11", B.Tech, working in MNC. Teetotaler. Seeking educated, cultured Sikh girl. 98964-46610. (CL26051690)

Mohali based family seeks suitable alliance for Gursikh (NT/ND) Arora boy, June 1995, 5'-7", working in MNC. Marriage Bureau excuse. Contact: 9501244221. (CL26051904)

Sikh Arora 29, 5'- 9", Veterinary officer (Group-A) in Punjab Govt. Govt. job/ doctor girl preferred. 9814529072 (CL26050590)

1990 born, well-settled, professionally employed male, working in Infosys, based in Mohali, seeks a suitable bride from a respectable family. Contact: 90412-15667. (CL26051372)

5'-7", 1989 born, unmarried Arora Sikh from Phagwara, working in Pvt. Bank Looking for educated bride. 90417-30879. (CL26051481)

Compatible match for Arora Sikh boy Oct. 1997 born, 5'-8", Canada PR, non trimmer, non drinker, marriage bureau excuse. 98765-88088. (CL26051501)

Suitable Sikh match preferably Medico required for Sikh Arora boy 31, 5'-10", teetotaler, doing Dr NB in Nephrology. 82848-51789. (CL26051514)

Arora Sikh boy, Feb. 1991 born, 5'-11", Hotel Management course after Graduation, running own restaurant. Contact: 9463230938. (CL26051803)

Arora Sikh boy 29/ 5'-8", B.Tech., working in MNC Punjab, beautiful girl IT company preferred. 62838-52164. (CL26051865)

Arora Sikh 99/ 5'-6", Govt. job, 60,000/- pm, rental income 30,000/- pm. Govt. house Chandigarh. 98144-34346. (CL26051873)

Working/non-working match for Sikh Khatri boy 1991, 5'-9", turbaned, trimmer. MBBS, PCMS. (No bar. 99151-99732, 98728-99931. (CL26051149)

Ludhiana based Sikh boy 1993, 5'-10", clean shave, B.Com, Post Graduate (Business Management). Actor and running own restaurant. educated affluent family. seeks educated girl, bureau excuse. 92178-16120, 97805-55646. (CL26051550)

Khatri boy age 28, 5'-10", B.Tech, NIT, non drinker/non trimmer, no dowry Jalandhar based Rich family. 98142-30123. (CL26051709)

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RAMGARHIA/DHIMAN

Match for Ramgarhia Sikh boy, June 1994, 5'-7", B.Tech (CS), IT Job. 94631-24280. (CL26051045)

CA Turban boy 26.08.95, EY GDS Gurugram working 5'-6", caste no bar 99502-57786. (CL26051201)

Suitable match for Sikh Ramgarhia 6', 1986, MBA, Admin Officer in Private Company. 94177-90635. (CL26051356)

Rangharia Sikh 1995 born turbaned young man 5'-8". Settled in Mohali. Working in a reputed bank. Caste no bar. Marriage bureau excuse. 98880-76911. (CL26051376)

Canada PR Ramgarhia turbaned Sikh, 1992, 5'-9"/ software Engineer Reputed MNC/ Toronto well settled, looking qualified girl, Marriage Bureaus excuse. 98967-07072. (CL26051419)

Ramgarhia Manglik boy, 1996, 5'-10" job in IT Company + own business, required educated girl. 98886-20545. (CL26051812)

Beautiful, educated match for Hindu Dhiman 1991 born, 6' height, Engineer, good package. Contact 98146-94647. (CL26051875)

Teetotaler non manglik Hindu Dhiman (Daryail/ Jagdev) boy, 6'-0", 03.09.1992, Pinjore, B.Tech., MBA in UK. 2 lac per month. Caste no bar. No demand. Contact: 94163-94779. (CL26051020)

Canada PR Sikh Ramgarhia Dentist boy 1998, 5'-9", required Doctor girl Hoshiarpur. 98770-88422. (CL26051362)

Suitable match for Sikh Ramgharia boy, 7.12.88, 6'-1", Bank Service for Graduate girl. 82838-22646. (CL26051614)

Match for IIT professional Dhiman boy 43/ 5'-4", Job at Gurgaon handsome package. Other casts welcome. Mob. 84276-56635 (CL26051621)

Match for Canadian PR Ramgarhia (Kalsi- Mathuro) handsome vegetarian boy 6.9.1994/ 6'-1", B.Tech., PG Diploma in quality Engineering and Management from Lambton College Toronto. Preference only vegetarian. 85568-90079. (CL26051660)

Suitable match for Ramgarhia Sikh boy, June 1995, 6', B.Tech, own well settled business. Required Graduate girl. Contact: 98155-33345. (CL26051227)

Suitable match for Ramgarhia Sikh boy 27/ 5'-11", Software Engineer, working in US firm, athletic personality good fearing family, one sister, (boy and father coming in December). Contact: 86998-94872. Jat Sikh and Khatri caste welcome. (CL26051813)

IAS / ALLIED SERVICES

Elite Sandhu Sardar family, Patiala: 1991, 6'-2", M.A., LLB, affluent landlord & established Petrol pump/ real estate business family. Seeks elegant, well settled IAS/ PCS officer girl only. M: 80174-00001. (CL26051722)

AGGARWAL

Singla boy, 08 Jun 1993, 10:52 am, Patiala, teetotaler, own business. Contact 98149-03696. (CL26044898)

Suitable match Mittal boy 29, 5'-09", B.Com., MBA, Big4 Noida. Sister Canada PR. Mobile 99142-41711. (CL26050764)

Suitable match for May 97 born 5'-8", fair complexion LLB boy. Girl employed in Tricity preferred, boy employed at Ziraipur Private Bank. 62398-36199. (CL26050791)

Professionally qualified match for Mittal divorcee boy, Nov. 89, IIT B.Tech., M.Tech., Govt. Officer, Chandigarh (82797-19015).

Agarwal boy, 29, 5'-11", wheatish, Roorkee, MD Radiodiagnosis, Radiologist at reputed private hospital, 242 LPA. Seeks Agarwal doctor bride, 26-30 years, minimum 5'-2", Fair, Preferred specialties: Radiodiagnosis, General Medicine, Pediatr. Contact: 98971-57042. (CL26050981)

Bansal boy Dec 91 born, 5'-11", B.Tech., qualified doing business near Bathinda. 97810-09374. (CL26051012)

Match for unmarried Garg boy, 45/ 5'-10", BDS, Govt job PCMS. 85287-40307. (CL26051039)

28 years, B.Com, LL.B, Post Graduate boy from Ludhiana. Seeks a well educated match. M: 62396-01577. (CL26051046)

SM4 M.Com., Mittal, 17 Sep 1994, Businessman, 7:10 pm, 5'-8", good income, no demand, Rest Ziraikpur. Caste no bar. 94170-85285. (CL26051066)

Singla boy B.Tech CS working in (MNC) Mohali (Pb), 14.11.92, 5'-11", (08.05 PM) 99143-03123. (CL26051166)

Beautiful cultured educated bride for Goel boy 08 Jan 1989, 5:32 am, 5'-7" businessman Patiala. Mobile 98143-23194. (CL26051219)

Seeking suitable match for Mohali born Nov 90, handsome, Chartered Accountant. Hometown Ludhiana, Professionally established across Tricity & Ludhiana. 94636-79200. (CL26051330)

Match for Slim, Handsome Garg Boy H1B Visa USA 1998/ 5'-9". Preferred highly qualified girl from north. Marriage Bureau excuse. 90563-53636. (CL26051353)

Match for Aggarwal Australian citizens, Manglik boy (Melbourne) 11.02.1994/ 5'-7", B.Tech (Jalandhar) 95017-18295, 76967-09768. (CL26051375)

Suitable Match for Mittal smart 5'-10", 17.09.1992, 8:56 am, Bank Manager Sangrur. 94657-29839. (CL26051566)

Suitable match for handsome single boy 26, 5'-10", well settled in Canada with P.R. Phone. 98154-78150 (CL26051599)

Garg Manglik boy, 23.07.2000, 09:47 am (Barnala), 5'-11", MBA, own two shop, good property, 79867-46189. (CL26051623)

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SAINI

Australian citizen, Saini Sikh, born July 1980/ 5'-7", B.Tech, MBA, Working as Assistant Director in Australian Government. Please send girl's biodata with recent photos at bluegum755@gmail.com/ WhatsApp +91 84270-38729. (CL26048940)

Suitable match for Saini boy 21.06.1992, 2:15 am, Height: 6 ft, Pathankot, Punjab, M.Tech from Punjab University Chandigarh, Working in Delhi Metro as Junior Engineer. Brother settled in Canada. Parents both Govt. job. Contact: 94176-80948. (CL26050750)

Saini Sikh, boy 34/ 5'-9", doing private job in PRTC, needs homely girl. 97809-39396. (CL26051315)

Sikh Saini- Not-turban 94/6', (B.Tech, NIT), Working MNC Gurgaon handsome package. Bureaus excise. 87577-31287 Caste no bar. (CL26051407)

Alliance invited for turbaned Saini Sikh boy, October, 1993, 5'-11", well settled as Senior Manager, B.Com.(Hons), CMA (Inter) in Chandigarh. Good rental income from urban and rural properties. Looking for a educated, beautiful and family oriented Sikh girl. Contact: 94173-85564, 62837-31374. (CL26050933)

Saini Sikh boy, 14.5.1996, 6', B.Tech in Marine Engineering, works as a Second Engineer in Japanese NYK shipping company. Salary 36 LPA. Father mother retired Government Teachers, Jalandhar. Two elder sisters married. Gotra Daula/Dhoor. Contact: 9417597862, 9417029826. (CL26051497)

Saini Sikh boy 26.10.1989, 6'-0", MA, working Deputy Manager HDFC Bank, required educated working girl, Tricity preferred. 98140-62509. (CL26051572)

Match for Hindu Saini boy 1996/ 5'-6", practicing High Court Mohali settled. Caste no bar. 94171-96013. (CL26051718)

RAJPUT

Verma handsome boy, Oct. 1991, 5'-9", Govt. employee Chandigarh, Salary 60,000+ Father Retd. Class-I Officer, Patiala. 96460-02833. (CL26051672)

Canadian citizen, working Toronto Doaba Rajput biradri, ex St John B.Tech, MBA Chandigarh, 1981/ 5'-8". Short 1 year (2015) marriage Divorced, no liability. Toronto match preferred. 98760-97441 (CL26050857)

PQM for handsome CA/MBA, 6'-2", 2000, Radhasoami Rajput boy, Officer in NTPC. Preference working Radhasoami/Vegetarian girl. Contact 96460-02460. (CL26051421)

Suitable match for handsome Convent educated Rajput goldsmith boy, 5'-11", 02.06.1994, working Punjab Govt. (Contract), Chd. Mohali well settled family. Caste No bar. Contact: 82838-19698. (CL26050609)

Goldsmith boy, 5'-11", 1993, Govt. Job at Mohali, need a qualified and working girl. Caste no bar. WhatsApp biodata 94659-95112. (CL26051492)

Employed match for Himachali Rajput boy, B.Tech, MBA, Oct. 1994, 5'-9", SBI clerk at Hoshiarpur, family well settled. 94177-56955. (CL26050864)

SM4 Kashyap Rajput Mehra boy, 10.08.1995, PoB Ludhiana, Senior Auditor in Central Govt, Posted at Patiala. 94175-41671. (CL26050866)

Suitable match for Hindu Rajput boy 17 May 1988, 11:44 pm, Hamirpur (Himachal), 5'-8", Graduate, diploma in Material Management, MBA, SCM correspondence, working Medanta hospital (Noida) Contact/WhatsApp: 9888139412. (CL26051189)

Employed match for Mair Rajput divorcee boy 42 years, income 2 Lac/month. Caste no bar. 98155-90052. (CL26051476)

Sikh Maid Rajput boy 1991/ 6', MBA, wholesale Gold Jewellery business, highly property income required educated, beautiful girl. Amritsar. 98156-92664. (CL26051567)

Suitable match for Ph.D. Physics, NET qualified, 1991 born, Dadhwal boy (Rajput) professor in PU. Preferred NET qualified in Science stream. Mobile No. 94635-70726, 70189-96019. (CL26051622)

AHLUWALIA

Match for non turbaned Ahluwalia boy, 5'-4", April 1995, B.Tech. Civil, MA, well settled business, Patiala. 98761-37186. (CL26051478)

JAT

Jat Sikh Canadian Citizen, 1989, 5'-10", MBA from Canadian University, Financial Analysts with B.C. Govt, Vegetarian and teetotaler. Seeks Canadian PR/ Citizen match. Contact 81465-99777. (CL26050767)

Jatt Sikh Pannu family seeking suitable match for their son, 1992 born, 6'-2" tall, non-drinker, vegetarian, USA Green Card holder, trucking business owner. Jatt Sikh girl only & no marriage bureau please. WhatsApp biodata @ (559) 523-0153. (CL26050808)

TONK-KASHATRIYA

Tonkshatriya Sikh turbaned boy, 1990/ 5'-6", M.Tech, Lecturer. Caste no bar. 94631-54887 Hoshiarpur. (CL26051361)

Tonkashtry PR Canada boy, 1995, 5'-7", B.Tech. Mechanical BP. ER, required well educated girl. 98882-19058. (CL26051515)

Tonk Kashtriya Sikh handsome boy, 09.12.1999/ 5'-9", Gotra: Tathgir/ Jassal. Canada PR, office job in Canada. Father Govt. Teacher & mother Govt. Lecturer. Seeking a suitable, well-educated girl. Contact: 94172-70666. (CL26051797)

KAMBOJ

Kamboj Sikh handsome boy 29, 5'-8", B.Tech., MS (Computer Science) working as Software Professional in USA. Well Educated well settled family in USA. WhatsApp. +12016759093. (CL26051088)

Suitable match for well settled Kamboj Sikh Jammu boy, 27, 5'-11", own business and Farming land, Patiala based. 98727-28109. (CL26050797)

Canada PR Kamboj Sikh non-drinker boy 28, 6'-0", Govt. job Canadian Police. Seeks Canadian PR/work permit girl. 9872292777. (CL26051105)

Suitable match for Sikh Kamboj boy, 1989 born, 6'-4", MBA, own business, rural/urban property. Need well educated, beautiful, tall girl from respectable family. 9915400028. (CL26051529)

Kamboj boy 1994 born, 5'-11", BBA, well settled, heading a Logistics Co. in Mohali, 6 figure salary, owns 9.5 acres of land, seeking a suitable, educated, family oriented match from a respectable family. Jalandhar/ Kapurthala preferred. Marriage bureau/ agents please excuse. 84279-60355. (CL26051625)

DEFENCE

Punjabi Khatri Hindu Army Major Permanent Commissioned Aug 1995/ 5'-10", B.Tech., fair NM NV seek slim fair qualified match prefer WFH/ Remote Wk contact Father Retd. Col 99688-53015. (CL26051741)

DOCTORS/ENGINEERS

PQM for Bansal, 1994/ 5'-6", MD Doctor in Airforce belongs to Doctor family based in Ludhiana. Caste no bar. Phone 98150-08300. (CL26051459)

Compatible Medico/ Non Medico match for Sikh Saini, clean shaven, teetotaler, MD Radiodiagnosis consultant Radiologist, working NCR, 6'-1"/ 90 born, Hoshiarpur district based, willing to relocate, only sister Psychiatrist married, mother retired Associate Professor, father practicing doctor. 98146-55386. (CL26050822)

Alliance invited for a Doctor(PCMS Class 1) MBBS from a respectable, well-cultured Punjabi Sikh family. Seeking a well-educated, graceful, caring and family-oriented bride. (SC 1992/6'-3", veg lifestyle, value Guru Granth Sahib teachings). Professionally qualified girl preferred. Caste no bar. Contact with biodata. 98881-57571. (CL26050978)

Match for Saini Sikh (pure veg) 29/ 6'-2" MBBS (pursuing MD/ MS) Ortho required MD/ MS/ MDS or doing (or in civil class one job) belongs to Saini Sikh or Jatt Sikh family. Contact 8360815955 residence city Gurdaspur. (CL26051058)

Aggarwal divorcee boy 1990/ 5'-6', MBBS DNB Orthopedic. Running own Orthopedic Hospital Morinda (Chandigarh). Required divorcee doctor Aggarwal girl. 95012-79359. (CL26051143)

5'-11" MD, MBBS, DM own hospital 83199-62815. (CL26051329)

Sikh boy, 1992 Born Tonk Kashatriya Doctor, (MBBS Sonography), own hospital. Required a Doctor girl. 98150-24009. (CL26051358)

Suitable match for Jat Sikh boy, 28 years, height 5'-7", MS (Ophthalmology), parents running own eye hospital. Mobile: 98720-29170, 98557-29170. (CL26051384)

Affluent Doctors Family 1996/ 5'-10", MD Pediatrics, DM, PGI Chandigarh- 73892-62013. (CL26051457)

Suitable match for BAMS and Master in Palliative Care Dr. Bhagat Boy, April 1996, 5'-4", working as Medical Officer at charitable hospital, Amritsar, own clinic. Looking for BAMS, medical line or any Govt. Job girl. Caste no bar. 95010-33698. (CL26051512)

29, 5'-10", MBBS, MD, Medicine pursuing DM Dr. family own hospital 82698-39838, 89625-45203. (CL26051549)

29 year old, 5'-11", Jatt Sikh, male, pursuing MCh Urology, from a well educated, respectable family. Seeking a suitably qualified match. Contact: 73407-60064 (WhatsApp only). (CL26050485)

Gursikh Arora family seeks MD girl for their son, 1998/ 5'-10", MD Pulmonary Medicine, working with multi specialty hospital at Mohali, well settled, educated family. Contact 98960-30753 (CL26050951)

Suitable match for 26 year Ramdasia Sikh 5'-10" vegetarian, teetotaler well settled Mohali based Businessman, Financially strong Real Estate and Builder. Preferably Architect/Interior Designer/Engineer/MBA/Asst. Prof./ Doctor well educated and beautiful girl. Caste/class no bar (Ph: 99888-07121, 96460-19125). (CL26051760)

Suitable match for Balmiki handsome boy 30/ 6', Constable Punjab Police. Contact: 94637-50969. (CL26051665)

Hindu Valmik 1994, 5'-7" boy, B.Sc, B.Ed, PSTET (passed), Teacher, seeks same qualified match. 94643-73664. (CL26051557)

Suitable qualified match for Ramdasia Sikh boy 1997, 5'-10", M.Tech (Computer Science), working as Software Engineer, Ldh settled family. 80546-99800. (CL26050399)

Elegant Canada PR Mahzib Sikh boy Sep, 1998, 5'-11", belongs to well settled educated & high status family. Girl from Australia/ USA also consider. Caste no bar. 98725-29729. (CL26051801)

SM4 Bhagat boy, 20.07.1994, 11:00 pm, 5'-5", Working AM, Maruti Suzuki, Manesar. 79868-15549, 78370-64666. (CL26051828)

Well cultured Hindu Ramdasia handsome boy, 5'-7", 1995 born, MS (General Surgery) SR, Govt Hospital. Family well settled in Zirakpur. MD/MS girl preferred. Contact: 76968-77519. (CL26051146)

Never Married boy, vegetarian Hindu Nai (NP) family, June 1981/ 5'-7", MCA, working as Project Officer IT in Chd, Upper Class no bar, 98784-11431. (CL26051317)

Handsome 29, 5'-10", MD (Radio), pursuing DM, reputed family. Required suitable match. 62687-72926. (CL26051343)

Suitable match for 28 years old 5'-10", Arora MBBS PCMS boy, working as Medical Officer in Civil Hospital, MBBS/ government job girl preferred. 98726-53001. (CL26051507)

Wanted Jatt Sikh MD/ MS match for MBBS, MS General Surgery (ongoing) boy, 5'-11", 1996 born. 98724-87016 (bureau excuse). (CL26051527)

Jat Sikh MS, General Surgery boy, 5'-8", 1996, seeks doctor girl. Send the biodata on WhatsApp: 83606-07737 (CL26051691)

Match for Doctor Garg boy, MD Medicine Bathinda, 18.01.1997, height 5'-10". 94173-09222. (CL26051894)

SCHEDULED CASTES

Suitable match for a Punjabi Ravidasia boy, born in 1995, 5'-8" tall. He holds a BBA degree and operates a successful business in New Delhi, generating a seven-figure monthly income. Contact No.: 76784-99942. Marriage bureau do not contact. (CL26050774)

Seeking a beautiful, well-educated girl from respectable family for Majbhi Sikh boy, 1996, 5'-11", B.Tech./MS, smart, well educated & well settled, working with a leading MNC with an attractive package. Belongs to highly respected, educated & well established family. Father ret'd. Class-I Officer. Mother Class-I Officer. Bureau please excuse. Contact: 9815956379/WhatsApp (CL26051095)

Turbaned Ravidasia boy, 32', B.Sc, Clerk Punjab Govt. From Sangrur. Seeks Govt. Job/Well educated girl. 99882-93413. (CL26050770)

Ravidasia boy, Oct. 1994, 5'-6", B.A., Real Estate Consultant & Builder. Settled family, Panchkula. 97797-59196. (CL26051073)

Ravidasia boy, 1995, 5'-11", BA (Hons), MA (English), LL.B, LL.M. Seeks for well educated beautiful girl. 91151-00952. (CL26051701)

Ad-dharmi, 41, 6', B.Tech/MBA, divorcee issueless, Engineer MNC. Seeks employed girl. Simple marriage. 9463029303. (CL26050732)

Ad-dharmi boy, September 1980, B.Tech, Ph.D., Government job (Class-I), Chandigarh, divorcee, America visitor. Prefer homely working/non-working. 8360792929. (CL26050734)

SM for SC Chamar boy, 5'-10", Sept. 1997, B.Tech. from PEC, Chandigarh in CSE, Post Graduate in Computer application, working at Pune in International Bank as Senior Analyst, Rs 25 + LPA. Father retired, Mother Govt job, sister unmarried. Family settled at Chandigarh. Preference working girl at Pune. Caste no bar. Marriage bureau excuse please. Contact Please 94649-54241. (CL26050846)

Non-Drinker, Non-smoker Ravidasia boy, June 1994, 5'-8", B.Tech., MBA, Own IT Company. Parents Govt. employees. Family settled Chandigarh. 80540-05264, 98885-05264. (CL26051135)

Valmiki handsome boy, 1990/ 5'-7", B.Tech. (Mechanical), own business, residence Patiala. Contact: 70874-14484. (CL26051346)

Required working girl for B.Tech. Ravidasia boy, 5'-5", own business, 16 Oct. 1992, residence Chandigarh & Derabassi GBP Society, Caste no bar. 94657-02119, 98881-34592. (CL26051435)

Addharmi boy 1995, 6'-0", B.Tech. Computer (CSE), working multinational company Engineer, seeks equally qualified B.Tech. (CSE) girl Hoshiarpur. 94171-50900. (CL26051491)

Match for Ramdasia boy 31/ 5'-10", B.Tech service Govt Bank Met with accident left hand foot weak get recovering. Parents Retired, Brother Executive Engineer central Govt residence Amritsar. Mobile 94637 26690. (CL26051582)

Kabir panthi (Juhaba) 95 born, 5'-8", M.Tech, handsome businessman boy from an educated family. Need well qualified, beautiful SC girl from Tricity, Punjab, HP. Contact- 84278-16164. (CL26051589)

Ramdasia boy 5'-11", 40, LL.B, LL.M, Senior Legal Associate in private company, Mohali. 99883-36433. (CL26051638)

Handsome Mazbhi Sikh boy MA, 09.09.1999, 6'-1", (Kirtan sangeet), pursuing B.Ed. 99156-80055. (CL26051719)

1995 born, 5'-9", Ravidasiya Sikh male (BAMS) who runs his own Hospital. Preference for a girl with equivalent qualifications. Marriage bureaus please excuse. 94174-04181. (CL26051793)

Suitable match for 26 year Ramdasia Sikh 5'-10" vegetarian, teetotaler well settled Mohali based Businessman, Financially strong Real Estate and Builder. Preferably Architect/Interior Designer/Engineer/MBA/Asst. Prof./ Doctor well educated and beautiful girl. Caste/class no bar (Ph: 99888-07121, 96460-19125). (CL26051760)

Suitable match for Balmiki handsome boy 30/ 6', Constable Punjab Police. Contact: 94637-50969. (CL26051665)

Hindu Valmik 1994, 5'-7" boy, B.Sc, B.Ed, PSTET (passed), Teacher, seeks same qualified match. 94643-73664. (CL26051557)

Suitable qualified match for Ramdasia Sikh boy 1997, 5'-10", M.Tech (Computer Science), working as Software Engineer, Ldh settled family. 80546-99800. (CL26050399)

Elegant Canada PR Mahzib Sikh boy Sep, 1998, 5'-11", belongs to well settled educated & high status family. Girl from Australia/ USA also consider. Caste no bar. 98725-29729. (CL26051801)

SM4 Bhagat boy, 20.07.1994, 11:00 pm, 5'-5", Working AM, Maruti Suzuki, Manesar. 79868-15549, 78370-64666. (CL26051828)

MBA/PROFESSIONAL

IIT Kharagpur & Warwick (UK) alumnus, 45/5'-8", Khatra legally divorced, issueless, well settled SVP/ Head leading private bank, CTC 1 Cr+. Cultured Delhi family, Mumbai based, open to India/ Gulf. Seeks educated, genuine family oriented, professionally settled lady, 35-40, issueless, open to parenthood, relocation. Never married/ divorced/ annulled/ widowed welcome, caste no bar, biodata/ recent photos to happy.marriage81@gmail.com, WhatsApp: +91-73037-77568. (CL26045282)

MISC.

Suitable match for Amritdhar Sikh Parajapat boy born 1989, 5'-7", qualification MBA, Ph.D living in Manila, marriage bureau excuse. 98153-92028. (CL26051486)

DIVORCEE

Professionally educated, Beautiful match for 53/ 6', Jat Sikh, BE, MBA, USA returned IT professional, only son, well travelled, now self-employed, tricity based, blessed with son born, living in USA, large rural, urban, residential, commercial, rental properties, well-educated family. WhatsApp 96460-01688. (CL26050910)

Arora, 37/ 5'-8", Divorced, HR Director, Mohali based. Seeking an educated match. WhatsApp: 98889-25323. (CL26050944)

Divorcee Jatt Sikh Mann 1983/ 5'-11" Netherlands, Good Income, wants partner, send detail +13630467414. (CL26050980)

Government writer of Magistrat grade- II, 44, (1,00,000), (Verma), short marriage (88722-72227 WhatsApp) (issueless) 62842-70119. (CL26051427)

Match for Gurugram working 1993/5'-10" B.Tech Mechanical Khatri issueless divorcee boy 94173-88068. (CL26051710)

Match for Aggarwal Divorcee issueless boy, May 1988, 5'-8½", B.Tech., Manager, MNC. Required near Patiala. Contact: 62845-27787. (CL26050891)

Khatri short term divorcee boy, 18.10.1986, 6', Officer in Govt. Bank (Gurgaon) Bank employee will be preferred. Caste no bar. 99883-52382. (CL26051359)

Suitable match for Sikh divorced boy 42 years, well settled business, Ludhiana. Required 28 to 35 years girl, without child. Caste no bar. Cont only WhatsApp 99153-10000. (CL26051564)

NRI

Suitable match for Rajput boy USA Green card, Dec. 92, 6'-1" girls working/Studying in USA/ having USA visa preferred. Contact 95967-89901. (CL26050927)

Canadian Sikh Ramgharia boy, 29, 5'-10", handsome, well-mannered and well-educated, Canadian Citizen, settled in Toronto., M.Tech Western University, Working as Environmental Engineer in provincial Municipal body (Ontario). Seeking a beautiful, well-educated, professionally qualified and well-mannered Sikh girl, preferably settled in Canada, belonging to a respectable and well-established family. Cast no Bar. WhatsApp only 98158-34075. Marriage bureau excuse. (CL26051319)

PQM Single Mair Rajput boy, 1981, 5'-4", MS, USA citizen. 99159-49434, mtrymny@gmail.com. (CL26051905)

Saini Sikh Canadian PR Boy, November 1996/ 5'-9", B.Tech (Mechanical Engineering) from Punjab University, postgraduate from Canada; employed in Canada. Family settled in Mohali. 9988876454. (CL26050514)

SM for 33/168 cms Kori, marketing Executive, settled in Canada, looking for well qualified employed girl in Canada/ India. Caste no bar. Reply on grvema@gmail.com. (CL26050774)

Canadian Citizen Sikh Tonk-Kashatriya boy 1992, 5'-11", Passport Officer with Government of Canada, Seeking Canadian Citizen/PR girl. Caste no bar. WhatsApp 95011-01369. (CL26050807)

PQM4 Jat Sikh, well settled, software professional, Canadian citizen, 1990 born, teetotaler. WhatsApp +14375180990, +91 94179-43195. (CL26050813)

PR Canada Nai Boy, 1998/6' Required Well educated girl India/Canada. 94170-38231, 70091-89801. (CL26050934)

Aggarwal boy, USA, Data Analyst, 7.9.2001 born/ 5'-10", HIB visa. Required USA citizen/ PR girl. Caste no bar. 94171-95844. (CL26050947)

Alliance invited for professionally settled handsome Sikh Khatri boy 35 yrs, 5'-9", Specialist with Alberta Health Services Canada. We are seeking cultured, professionally qualified, family oriented, preferably Medico girl from respectable family. Contact: 90416-99810, gurmeet@hotmail.com (CL26051056)

Ravidasiya SC boy 27/5'-6", B.Tech, Chandigarh Uni. next Canada University (Toronto) now in India. Seeking girl Australia, Canada, New-Zealand. 94636-96327. (CL26051102)

Sikh Saini well settled smart boy 6', 1992, short term divorce, Software Developer, own house in Calgary, Background in Mohali. +91-98766-23406. (CL26051221)

Canada permanent resident Tonk-kashatriya, Non-Turban Sikh, B.Tech, 1993 / 5'-9", father retired engineer. Caste no bar. 84370-41212. (CL26051255)

Sikh (Arora) boy, 1997/ 5'-10", Canada citizen, Government job, vegetarian. Seeking a Sikh girl. 90412-20249. (CL26051369)

Compatible match for an Australia citizen Software Engineer working in a Financial Sector as a Senior Software Developer (good package) Jain handsome boy, only son, Dec.1992 born, 5'-9" from a well known family of Jalandhar (Punjab). Girl to settle in Sydney. Caste no bar. Call 95016-22100. (CL26051546)

Hindu boy 90, 5'-8", Engineer, MBA, 7 year work Canada, now India. Seeking PR/ Divorced girl, caste no bar. 98886-99105 (CL26051617)

paper trader, 2005/3555 Match for Khatri Dhir vegetarian boy, 03.10.1991, 03:47 pm, Hoshiarpur, 5'-7", Master in International Accounting. Job in Adelaide as Accounting Manager. (CL26051355)

PUBLIC NOTICES

I. Bandna Jindal w/o Naveen Jindal r/o # 43-A, Gian Colony, Sant Nagar Patiala (Punjab) have changed my name to Bandna. (CL26051241)

I. Neelam Kumari W/o Ajit Kumar R/o Village Harsour, Distt. Hamirpur, HP- 174305, have changed my name to Tara Devi. All concerned please note. (CL26051292)

I. Gurdeep Singh s/o Jaswinder Singh r/o H. No. 218, St. No. 7, Virk Colony, Patiala, have changed my minor son's name from Jashan Kabir Singh to Jashanveer Singh. (CL26051451)

I. Raj Kopra S/o Shri Salig Ram Kopra R/o White House, Village Shanan, P.O. Sanjauli, District Shimla, H.P. declare that my name is recorded as Raj K. Kopra in Aadhar Card and in School Certificates as Raj Kumar. My correct name is Raj Kopra which may be corrected in my all documents. (CL26051594)

I. Jyoti W/o Rajiv Singh Resident Safiabad Road, Pana Udyan, Narela, Delhi- 110040, have changed my minor son's name from Tanveer to Tanveer Singh. (CL26051820)

TENDER NOTICE

YADAVINDRA PUBLIC SCHOOL
Stadium Road, Patiala (Pb) affiliated to ICSE
0175-2217631, Web Site: www.ypspatiala.in

PURCHASE OF HORSES

School intends to purchase two Gelding Horses (show jumpers)

Sealed quotations are invited. Last date for submission is 15. Oct 2026

Details can be downloaded from school website-

www.ypspatiala.in

CL26051844

COURT NOTICES

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Dr. Prabhjot Kaur
Civil Judge (Jr. Divn.)
Mukerian

Ram Lal s/o Amar Singh r/o Village Kalu Chang, Tehsil Mukerian, District Hoshiarpur Vs.

Nand Kishor s/o Ram Kishan r/o Village Kalu Chang, Tehsil Mukerian, District Hoshiarpur and others

CNR No. PBHOC0-000980-2023
Next Date: 04.11.2026

Suit for declaration
Publication issued to:
2B. Gurdev Singh s/o Joginder Singh, 3A. Satpal Singh s/o Ajit Singh, 3C. Guralp Singh s/o Ajit Singh all residents of Village Muradpur Awana, Tehsil Mukerian, Distt. Hoshiarpur

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 04.11.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=hoshiarpur

Sd/- Civil Judge (Jr. Division)
CL26039234 Mukerian

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of Amit Malhan
Principal Judge, Family Court
Amritsar

Ravjot Kaur Vs.
Amanpreet Singh
CNR No.:

PBAS01-008109-2026
Next Date: 30.11.2026

Publication issued to:
Amanpreet Singh
Father:- S/o Jagmohan Singh, R/o H.No. ET169/1, New Railway Road, Mohalla Inderprast, Jalandhar, at present R/o 67, Murphy Avenue, Moncton, New Brunckwic, Canada E1A4N7

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 30.11.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?trs=district_notice&district=amritsar

Sd/- Principal Judge, Family Court,
CL26051068 Amritsar

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COURT NOTICES

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Hasan Deep Singh Bajwa
Additional Civil Judge
(Senior Division), Kharar

Manjit Kaur D/o Late Balwant Singh W/o Shamsher Singh Saini, R/o United State of America through POA Yashpal S/o Late Baba Ram R/o VPO Kotla Kharan, near Bal Baba Mandir, Tehsil and District Una (HP).

Versus
1. Rajinderpal Singh, 2. Satwinder Singh both S/o Late Kashmiria Singh R/o Vill. Kharar, Badala Road, Tehsil Kharar, Distt. SAS Nagar. 3. Balwinder Singh S/o Late Balwant Singh R/o Badala Road, Kharar, Distt. SAS Nagar, Mohali.

CNR No. PBSAA0-000745-2023
Next Date: 22.12.2026
CS/508/2023

Publication issued to: 1. Rajinderpal Singh, 2. Satwinder Singh both S/o Late Kashmiria Singh R/o Vill. Kharar, Badala Road, Tehsil Kharar, Distt. SAS Nagar. 3. Balwinder Singh S/o Late Balwant Singh R/o Badala Road, Kharar, Distt. SAS Nagar, Mohali.

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s) respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 22.12.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=mohali

Sd/- Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Kharar.
CL26051069

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Ms. Rana Kanwardeep Kaur
Chahal

Principal Judge, Family Court
Kapurthala
Shruti Vs.

Kunal Puri
CNR No.:

PBKP01-001966-2025
Next Date: 29.10.2026

Publication issued to:
Kunal Puri son of Pawan Kumar Puri R/o Near Govt. Girls School Mohalla Nayian Sultanpur Lodhi Kapurthala at present R/o 18 Rue Lucien Cotton Dungy 93440 Lisbon France

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 29.10.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=kapurthala

Sd/- Principal Judge, Family Court,
CL26051148 Kapurthala.

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(Under Guardian and Wards Act)
In the Court of
Ms. Rana Kanwardeep Kaur
Chahal

Principal Judge, Family Court
Kapurthala
Kulwinder Singh Vs.

General Public
Manjinder Kaur
CNR No.:

PBKP01-001179-2025
Next Date: 17.11.2026

Notice to:
General Public
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 17.11.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=kapurthala

Sd/- Principal Judge, Family Court,
CL26051151 Kapurthala.

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(Under Guardian and Wards Act)
In the Court of
Ms. Rana Kanwardeep Kaur
Chahal

Principal Judge, Family Court
Kapurthala
Kanwarpreet Singh Vs.

General Public
CNR No.:

PBK01-004620-2026
Next Date: 12.11.2026

Notice to:
General Public
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 12.11.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=kapurthala

Sd/- Principal Judge, Family Court,
CL26051155 Kapurthala.

COURT NOTICES

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(Under Guardian and Wards Act)
In the Court of
Ms. Rana Kanwardeep Kaur
Chahal

Principal Judge, Family Court
Kapurthala
Harpreet Kaur Vs.

Harmmeet Singh
General Public
CNR No.:

PBKP01-001569-2026
Next Date: 17.11.2026

Notice to:
General Public
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 17.11.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=kapurthala

Sd/- Principal Judge, Family Court,
CL26051156 Kapurthala.

In the High Court of
Himachal Pradesh at
Shimla- 171001
Case No. FAO (MV) 34/3036
Preeto Devi & Ors.

...Appellant...
Versus
Shobhit Saini & Ors.

...Respondent...
(Proclamation under order 5 urle 20 of the code of Civil Procedure)
Notice to:

R-2 Ramit Mehta s/o Sh. Rajan Mehta, r/o House No. 41, 3rd floor, Block-CPKT-4, Sector 15, Opp. CSC Market, Rohini, New Delhi- 110085.

Whereas in the above noted case, it has been proved to the satisfaction of this Court the above named respondent can not be served in an ordinary way.

Therefore, this proclamation Under Order 5 Rule 20 of the code of Civil Procedure is hereby issued against him that he should appear in this Court either personally or through some duly authorized agent on 06th November, 2026 (06.11.2026) T.H. at 10:00 am) failing which exparte proceedings will be taken against him.

Given under my hand and seal of the Court this 29th day of September, 2026

By order
Section Officer, (Judicial)
High Court of HP,
CL26051169 Shimla.

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Sh. Tejpartap Singh Randhawa
Additional District and Sessions Judge-5, Mohali
Shiv Kumar Vs.

Inderjeet Singh (deceased) through LR Pushpinder Kaur
CNR No. PBSA01-006792-2024
Next Date: 13.11.2026

Condonation of Delay of 1031 days in Filing Appeal against Judgment Dt. 01.10.2021 in CS/443/2019

Publication issued to:
1. Inderjeet Singh (deceased) S/o Jeon Singh through LR B Harjinder Singh S/o Late Sh. Inderjeet Singh R/o H.No. 512, Sector 36, Chandigarh. 2. Jagmel Singh (deceased) S/o Gurdyal Singh R/o H.No. 512, Sector 36, Chandigarh through LR B) Mrs. Kamal Sewak W/o Surinder Sewak (address not known as she is settled in America since 1984 and not linked with family).

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 13.11.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=mohali

Sd/- Additional District and Sessions Judge-5, Mohali.
CL26051209

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Ms. Simran Chhalana
Civil Judge (Junior Division), SBS Nagar
Canara Bank Vs.

Kamaljeet Sharda
CS/186/2025
CNR No. PBSB02-000282-2025
Next Date:- 03.11.2026

Publication issued to: 1. Kamaljeet Sharda S/o Ram Lubhaya C/o Sharda Garments, Ghai Market, Main Road Banga, Tehsil Banga, District SBS Nagar. 2. Ashwani Kumar S/o Mulakh Raj, Medical Shop Near Sharda Cloth House, Ghai Market, Main Road Banga, Tehsil Banga, District SBS Nagar. 3. Rohit Sharda S/o Chander Mohan Sharda R/o H.No. 21/3, Gandhi Nagar, Banga, Tehsil Banga, Distt. SBS Nagar.

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 03.11.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=sbsnagar

Sd/- Civil Judge (Junior Division), SBS Nagar
CL26051218

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Ms. Simran Chhalana
Civil Judge (Junior Division), SBS Nagar
Canara Bank Vs.

Kamaljeet Sharda
CS/186/2025
CNR No. PBSB02-000282-2025
Next Date:- 03.11.2026

Publication issued to: 1. Kamaljeet Sharda S/o Ram Lubhaya C/o Sharda Garments, Ghai Market, Main Road Banga, Tehsil Banga, District SBS Nagar. 2. Ashwani Kumar S/o Mulakh Raj, Medical Shop Near Sharda Cloth House, Ghai Market, Main Road Banga, Tehsil Banga, District SBS Nagar. 3. Rohit Sharda S/o Chander Mohan Sharda R/o H.No. 21/3, Gandhi Nagar, Banga, Tehsil Banga, Distt. SBS Nagar.

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 03.11.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=sbsnagar

Sd/- Civil Judge (Junior Division), SBS Nagar
CL26051218

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Ms. Simran Chhalana
Civil Judge (Junior Division), SBS Nagar
Canara Bank Vs.

Kamaljeet Sharda
CS/186/2025
CNR No. PBSB02-000282-2025
Next Date:- 03.11.2026

Publication issued to: 1. Kamaljeet Sharda S/o Ram Lubhaya C/o Sharda Garments, Ghai Market, Main Road Banga, Tehsil Banga, District SBS Nagar. 2. Ashwani Kumar S/o Mulakh Raj, Medical Shop Near Sharda Cloth House, Ghai Market, Main Road Banga, Tehsil Banga, District SBS Nagar. 3. Rohit Sharda S/o Chander Mohan Sharda R/o H.No. 21/3, Gandhi Nagar, Banga, Tehsil Banga, Distt. SBS Nagar.

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 03.11.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=sbsnagar

Sd/- Civil Judge (Junior Division), SBS Nagar
CL26051218

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Ms. Simran Chhalana
Civil Judge (Junior Division), SBS Nagar
Canara Bank Vs.

Kamaljeet Sharda
CS/186/2025
CNR No. PBSB02-000282-2025
Next Date:- 03.11.2026

Publication issued to: 1. Kamaljeet Sharda S/o Ram Lubhaya C/o Sharda Garments, Ghai Market, Main Road Banga, Tehsil Banga, District SBS Nagar. 2. Ashwani Kumar S/o Mulakh Raj, Medical Shop Near Sharda Cloth House, Ghai Market, Main Road Banga, Tehsil Banga, District SBS Nagar. 3. Rohit Sharda S/o Chander Mohan Sharda R/o H.No. 21/3, Gandhi Nagar, Banga, Tehsil Banga, Distt. SBS Nagar.

COURT NOTICES

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of Sh. Ajay
Civil Judge (Junior Division), Bathinda

Union of India, Secretary Ministry of Defence through Defence Estates Officer Bathinda Circle, Bathinda Versus

Balwant Singh son of Bishan Singh through his Lrs 1. Manjit Singh son of Balwant Singh, 2. Mohinder Kaur d/o Balwant Singh, 3. Gurcharan Singh son of Balwant Singh and Surinder Kaur d/o Balwant Singh now deceased through LRs A) Choti (Nikko Kaur) d/o Surinder Kaur, B) Jyoti d/o Surinder Kaur

CS-1157-2025
CNR No.: PBBT02-001794-2025
Next Date: 22.10.2026

Publication issued to: Balwant Singh (deceased) through his Lrs 1. Manjit Singh son of Balwant Singh, resident of Gali No. 11, Dhibana Road, Bathinda. 2. Mohinder Kaur d/o Balwant Singh r/o 193, Urban Estates Phase-1, Patiala, Surinder Kaur d/o Balwant Singh (now deceased through LRs), A) Choti (Nikko Kaur) d/o Surinder Kaur resident of Village Tallewala, near Pakho Panchiya, Tehsil and District Barnala, B) Jyoti d/o Surinder Kaur resident of Village Tallewala near Pakho Panchiya, Tehsil and District Barnala.

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s) respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 22.10.2026 at 10.00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=bathinda

Sd/- Civil Judge (Junior Division), Bathinda
CL26051448

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Mrs. Harmmeet Kaur Puri, PCS,
Civil Judge (Junior Division), Amlloh (P)

Next Date, purpose of case, Orders and judgments as well as other case information is available on <http://ecourts.gov.in>

Manpreet Kaur
Versus
General Public
CS/46/2026
CNR No.

PBFGA0-000061-2026
Next Date: 22.10.2026

Suit for declaration that the plaintiff has voluntarily and consciously converted her religion for Sikhism to Islam on 24.10.2025.

Publication issued to:
General Public
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 22.10.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=fatehgarhsahib

Sd/- Harmmeet Kaur Puri, PCS
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
CL26051455 Amlloh (P).

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Hasan Deep Singh Bajwa
Sub Divisional Judicial Magistrate,
Kharar
Punjab Pollution Control Board Vs.

M/s GBM Developers and Promoters Pvt. Ltd.
CNR No. PBSAA1-002326-2020
Next Date:- 02.11.2026

Publication issued to: 1. M/s GBM Developers and Promoters Pvt. Ltd. (Project: GBM Apartments) Registered Office at SCO No. 348-349, 2nd Floor Sector 34-A Chandigarh for its Project: GBM Apartments at Village Khanpur, Kurali Road, Kharar, District SAS Nagar through its Managing Director

2. Sh. Subhash Bansal S/o Birbhan Bansal, Managing Director of M/s GBM Developers and Promoters Pvt. Ltd. R/o H.No. 3017, Sector 21-D, Chandigarh. 3. Sh. Sumehak Bansal S/o Sh. Subhash Bansal, Director of M/s GBM Developers and Promoters Pvt. Ltd. R/o H.No. 3017, Sector 21-D Chandigarh.

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 02.11.2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to:
https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?trs=district_notice&district=s.a.s.nagar

Sd/- Sub Divisional Judicial Magistrate
Kharar
CL26051468

Proclamation Requiring
attendance of Defendant
(Order 5, Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure)

In the Court of
Dr. Nupur Gupta,
Senior Civil Judge Rent
Controller, Dwarka, New Delhi.

CS SCJ 703/2026
Date of Order: 31.08.2026
Date of Issue: 09.09.2026
Next Date of Hearing: 30.10.2026

Punjab National Bank
...Plaintiff
Versus

...Defendant/Respondent
To, Pawan S/o Sh. Ashok Verma R/o House No. 1156, Gali No. 11, Gandhi Nagar, Karnal, Haryana-132001, Mob: 72068-68701, Email: pv103594@gmail.com

Whereas you are intentionally evading service of summons it is hereby notified that if you shall not defend the case on the 30th October 2026 at 10:00 am the day fixed for the final disposal, it will be heard and determined ex-parte.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Court, this day of 09.09.2026.

Sd/- Senior Civil Judge/ Rent Controller, Dwarka,
CL26051536 Dwarka

(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
In the Court of
Sh. Vinod Yadav
District Judge (Comm. Court-02), Dwarka Courts, New Delhi
(Order 5, Rule 20 of the CPC)
CS (Comm) No. 361/2026
Punjab National Bank
...Plaintiff
Vs.
Inderjeet
...Defendant

To:
Inderjeet s/o Sh. Subash Chand residing at 92/7, Ram Nagar, Karnal, Haryana - 132001, Mob. 90500-77453.

Whereas plaintiff has instituted that above Suit for recovery against the defendants. You are hereby summoned to appear in this Court in person or by a pleader on the 06th day of November, 2026 at 10:00 O' Clock, to answer the same, failing which the suit will be disposed of ex-parte.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Court, this 29th September 2026 to be published in English Newspaper "The Tribune".

Note: Defendant is informed to file WS within a period of 30 days from the date of receipt of summons with advanced copy to the plaintiff and filing of WS in commercial suit in 120 days period is mandatory and no extension can be granted.

Sd/- District Judge-02, (Commercial Court), South-West District, Dwarka, New Delhi.
CL26051543

COURT NOTICES

In the High Court of Delhi
at New Delhi
(Ordinary Original Civil Jurisdiction) Publication U/O V
Rule 20 CPC

In the matter of: CS(OS) No. 636/2019 & I.A. 3053/2026, IA No. 10722/26, IA. 3095-96/2022, & 17207/19 Vinod Kumar Kad & Otrs.

...Plaintiffs
Versus
Girish Kumar Kad & Otrs

...Defendants
To, Defendant No. 1 Girish Kumar Kad S/o Late Ram Narain Kad R/o House No. 1277/9, Gali Kadan Wali, Near Keshar Dhaba, Amritsar, Punjab-143001.

Whereas the above named plaintiff has instituted a suit for declaration and permanent and mandatory injunction against you the above named defendant.

And whereas it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Court that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way, therefore, this summons/ notice in suit and I.A. 3053/2026, IA No. 10722/26, I.A. 3095-96/2022, & 17207/19 are given by publication directing you to make appearance before learned joint registrar (Judicial) of this Court on 29.10.2026 at 11:00 am.

Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day above mentioned, the suit and I.As. will be heard and determined in your absence.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Court, in terms of orders dated 11.08.2026 & 04.02.2026.

Sd/- Assistant Registrar (Orgl.) for Registrar General.
CL26051574

In the Court of
Additional Principal Judge 1,
Family Court Solan,
District Solan (H.P)

In rf
HMA No. 69-S/3 of 2025/24
Fixed for 15.12.2026

1. Smt Sutapa Roy w/o Sh Nila Jyoti Biswas r/o Village Dhar-Ki-Ber (763), P.O. Dharampur Tehsil Kasauli District Solan H.P.

... Petitioners
Versus

VINAYAK PADMADEO

RESULTS from the track and field competitions at the Asian Games have once again brought the spotlight on the Indian athletics team. On one hand, there were several encouraging results, none more so than the 4x400 women's relay gold medal; on the other, there were several disappointing results that put a question mark on India's global standing.

Were there any miscalculations on the part of the Athletics Federation of India (AFI)? Yes. The AFI knew that at least four of the medal contenders — triple jumper Praveen Chithravel, hurdler Jyothi Yarraji, high jumper Sarvesh Kushare and 400m hurdler Yashas P — were injured before the start of competition. Yet after consultation with the coaching staff and doctors, they were cleared to take part. Of them, only Sarvesh showed up for competition, picking up a creditable silver. Sarvesh, who cleared 2.25 metres, settled for second place to Chinese Taipei's Chao-hsuan Fu on count back.

The rest did not recover in time to compete. If not for the last-day heroics by the Indian quartet of Kiran Pahal, Prachi Chaudhary, MR Poovamma and Vithya Ramraj where they relegated China and Bahrain to win the 4x400m gold medal, the knives would be out.

FEDERATION ORDERS PROBE

The AFI has ordered an inquiry into the matter, seeking explanations from private coaches after the trio withdrew from competition. AFI's chairman of selection committee and spokesperson Adille Sumariwalla defended the selections, saying they were assured by the coaching and

Mixed bag in athletics

Track and field stars hold their own amid injuries and a dip in medal count



Clockwise from above: The gold-winning 4x400 women's relay team, high jumper Sarvesh Kushare won a silver medal, pole vaulter Baranica Elangovan bagged a bronze, and Sawan Barwal won a silver medal in men's marathon. PHOTOS: PTI, ANI

medical staff of the athletes' recoveries. "There are two ways to look at this. One, they are not 100 per cent fit so don't take them at all or force them to compete to prove fitness. The other way was to look at the report filed by the doctors that cleared them to compete and showed confidence about their availability. Some of them failed but we

got one medal (Sarvesh)," Sumariwalla said. "Selection jobs are not easy. We dropped Shahnawaz Khan (long jumper) as he was unfit but others were cleared. A computer can also select a team but we have to look at performances and potential. One jump of 17m from Chithravel could have landed us another medal. We have ordered an

inquiry and we will get to the bottom of this," he added.

SECOND-PLACE HANDSHAKES

Apart from questionable selections, there is also the small matter of winning a solitary gold medal at the 2026 edition. At the 2022 Asian Games, Indian athletes won a total of

29 medals, including 6 gold, 14 silver and 9 bronze medals. At the Aichi-Nagoya Games, that tally is 1 gold, 9 silver and 14 bronze medals for a total of 24 medals.

A former Asian Games medallist said the Indian teams have to recalibrate as to how they approach the games. "Look at the Thailand sprinter (Puripol Boonsan). He did the sprint double here. It is not as if our standards have dropped drastically in Aichi-Nagoya. It could be that the rest of the Asian countries have moved ahead of us. We seriously have to have a major rethink about how we go about our training and competition schedules moving forward," he said, on condition of anonymity.

Disappointments apart, there were some very encouraging results from track and field. Sawan Barwal, who won the silver medal in the men's marathon, ended a 44-year medal drought in the Asian Games. He also broke the national record with a timing of 2:11:37, 21 seconds faster than his own mark of 2:11:58 in Rotterdam in April.

Similarly, Vithya broke the 42-year-old national record held by now Indian Olympic Association (IOA) president PT Usha by clocking 54.75s to win the bronze medal in the 400m hurdles. Sumariwalla said he would rather think of the improving performances than lose sleep over medals.

"We should stop looking at medals only. Sure we are down on the gold winning count but on performances, I think it is encouraging. We are on the upward trajectory looking at the pole vault results. Yes we are not world-beaters but both Dev Meena, who broke the national record, and Baranica Elangovan (bronze medal) gave it all. Such results should be celebrated," he said.

How new FD rules affect big depositors

ADITYA RANGROO

THE Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has changed the regulations related to interest rates on bulk fixed deposits (FDs) with effect from October 1, bringing clarity on how banks reveal rates for substantial deposits. The changes are not likely to impact most individual retail investors since these pertain to bulk deposits, which for scheduled commercial banks typically begin at Rs 3 crore.

The revised framework seeks to enhance transparency in bulk FD pricing and provide significant depositors with better insights regarding the interest rates relevant to their deposits. According to the RBI guidelines, banks must display the interest rates for bulk fixed deposits on their websites each business day.

REGULAR ANNOUNCEMENT

The rates need to be made public by 10 am, allowing a 10-minute period for information updates. Banks must also pay interest on qualified bulk deposits according to the rate revealed beforehand.

This provides significant depositors with a publicly accessible benchmark to verify the relevant rate prior to depositing their funds with a bank. For scheduled commercial banks, a bulk deposit typically means a single term deposit of Rs 3 crore or above. The

Changes apply to bulk deposits of Rs 3 cr or more, while smaller FDs will largely remain unaffected

threshold, nevertheless, varies for specific categories of banks.

Consequently, investors holding standard retail FDs beneath the relevant bulk-deposit limit will typically remain unaffected. The revised regulations mainly pertain to individuals, businesses, trusts, and other depositors investing substantial amounts in bank term deposits.

WHO WILL BE IMPACTED

The changes mainly concern a single fixed or term deposit of Rs 3 crore or higher with a scheduled commercial bank. These hold greater significance for high-net-worth individuals, corporations, trusts, institutions, and other major depositors.

For regular retail customers with FDs under Rs 3 crore, the regulations do not significantly change interest rates. The interest on a standard FD will still rely on the bank's current deposit rate schedule, duration, customer type, and other conditions.

CURRENT FDs WILL NOT VARY

Customers who already have a fixed deposit should not expect their interest rate to vary starting October 1. Deposits that have

already been made will proceed according to the conditions that were in effect when these were established.

The revised regulations also do not automatically adjust the interest rate on an active FD. Customers looking to renew a deposit of Rs 3 crore or greater should verify the bank's website for the listed rate.

Banks may provide varied rates on large deposits within the Liquidity Coverage Ratio (LCR) framework. The RBI has added a new clause concerning domestic rupee deposits that pertain to the applicable run-off rates within the LCR framework. It indicates that a bank is allowed to provide a varied interest rate on large deposits by taking into account the different run-off rate relevant to deposits or unsecured wholesale funding within the LCR framework, outlined in the RBI's guidelines on asset-liability management.

WHAT INDUSTRY EXPERTS SAY

Experts indicate that the revised regulations ought to simplify the process for substantial depositors to review and contrast the rates provided by various banks. This may reduce information disparities between banks and clients during negotiations or when making substantial deposits.

The display of applicable bulk-deposit interest rates on websites by 10 am is expected to enhance clarity and uniformity in deposit pricing.

J&K statehood demand gets shriller

ADIL AKHZER

A MAJOR controversy erupted this week over the long-pending demand for the restoration of statehood to Jammu and Kashmir. Chief Minister Omar Abdullah disclosed in the Legislative Assembly that the secretary of the Law Department, a portfolio held by Omar, had sent an opinion to the Assembly on the statehood resolution without his knowledge.

A few days earlier, Omar had tabled a resolution calling upon the Centre to immediately restore statehood. He told the Speaker that perhaps the Chief Secretary had also written to him objecting to the resolution moved by the ruling government.

As the issue drew criticism from legislators, barring those from the Bharatiya Janata Party, who said bureaucrats could not dictate to the Assembly, it added to Omar's growing concerns over the functioning of the elected government.

"Can you imagine that the Chief Minister moves a resolution and the Law Secretary gives an opinion against it? This can happen only in a Union Territory. And this kind of thing happens everyday," Omar said.

Political parties have been demanding restoration of statehood since the erstwhile state was bifurcated into the UTs of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh following the abrogation of Article 370 in August 2019. The Centre, however, has maintained that statehood would be restored at an "appropriate" time.

The ruling National Conference (NC), which came to power in 2024, has been under pressure, including from within its own ranks, with leaders arguing that the existing dual governance structure is preventing the elected government from taking major policy decisions.

WAITING GAME CONTINUES

At present, the Lieutenant Governor has control over law and order in Jammu and Kashmir. Beyond that, the top bureaucracy,



Feeling tied down by the UT's governance structure, CM ups the ante with a House resolution that mentions autonomy

including IAS officers, is also under the LG's control in areas covered by the existing rules, leaving limited room for the elected government to act.

Even as Omar has been kept waiting over the statehood demand, a number of issues continue to remain unaddressed, including the Transaction of Business Rules. The government has said there is a need for clarity over who controls what. The NC says that even though the rules provide for the Lok Bhavan to exercise control over law and order, the situation on the ground is different.

"Even the J&K Academy of Art, Culture and Languages is not under the control of the elected government. Now tell me, what is the relationship between the Cultural Academy and law and order?" Omar said in the Assembly.

NC leaders stress that with the elected government having no direct control over the bureaucracy, officers are not even taking its requests seriously. Another pending issue is the appointment of the Advocate General. Omar said the UT has been functioning without one for nearly two years despite the government formally proposing a name.

The Chief Minister has also pointed to a committee formed by the elected govern-

ment to examine the regularisation of daily-wage workers. Although it was constituted in March 2025, Omar said its report had not yet been completed. "If we were a state, do you think it would take more than a year to prepare such a report?" he questioned.

Another pending issue is a review of the reservation policy. The NC government says the file is pending with the LG's office.

UPROAR OVER RESOLUTION

The Legislative Assembly recently passed a resolution calling upon the Centre to immediately restore full statehood to J&K, amid strong protests by BJP legislators.

"In addition to the resolutions passed by this House on June 26, 2000, and November 6, 2024, this House calls upon the Government of India for the immediate and urgent restoration of full statehood to Jammu and Kashmir and resolves that this resolution be forwarded to the Government of India," the resolution stated.

The NC-led government had passed a resolution in 2024, too, asking the Centre to initiate a dialogue with the elected representatives for restoration of J&K's special status and constitutional guarantees.

With the 2024 resolution yet to elicit a response from New Delhi, the NC appears to have taken a tougher stand by referring to the Assembly's earlier position on autonomy.

The resolution referred to a J&K Assembly resolution passed on June 26, 2000, which had endorsed the recommendations of the State Autonomy Committee, including restoration of J&K's pre-1953 autonomous status.

BJP leader and Leader of Opposition in the Assembly Sunil Sharma accused the NC of attempting to revive the 2000 autonomy resolution under the cover of the statehood demand. Sharma said the move could affect relations between the NC government and the Centre and that Union Home Minister Amit Shah had expressed reservations over references in the resolution.

Why tiger poaching concerns are growing

18 years on, very few states have raised the special protection force despite a designated programme

AKSHEEV THAKUR

IT'S been 18 years since the Centre allocated Rs 50 crore to the National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA) to nudge the states to form the Special Tiger Protection Force (STPF). The idea was to curb poaching with increased intelligence and to bring down man-animal conflict. Two decades later, very few states have constituted the force and the result is heightened poaching and unnatural deaths of tigers. In the past three years, more than 100 tigers have been killed in multiple tiger reserves.

THE 2008 CONSERVATION PITCH

In the 2008 Budget, the then UPA government announced the formation of STPF and gave NTCA Rs 50 crore to exhort states to set up the force in the tiger reserves. It was to be run under Project Tiger with 60:40 Centre-state funding. In the Northeast and Himalayan states, the expenditure ratio was fixed at 90:10.

Eighteen years after the announcement, the STPF has been made operational in Karnataka (Bandipur), Maharashtra (Pench, Tadoba-Andhari, Nawegaon-Nagzira, Melghat), Rajasthan (Ranthambore), Odisha (Similipal) and Assam (Kaziranga).

Wildlife activist Gaurav Bhardwaj told *The Tribune*, "The job of the STPF was to stop poaching, electrocution and forest crime through robust intelligence and combing. Two options were given to the states: put police on deputation or the forest staff for the force. Most of the states chose forest staff."

He said one company of STPF should have had 120 personnel. "It was initially planned for 13 sensitive tiger reserves; 30 per cent posts were meant for local forest-dwellers. Training was to cover wildlife law, weapons and commando work. Eighteen years later, only Maharashtra, Odisha and Karnataka have actually done it."

Madhya Pradesh has nine tiger reserves but has not constituted the STPF. The state has witnessed 54 tiger deaths in the past one year.

"Rajasthan, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu and Arunachal Pradesh announce it in every budget, but it remains pending. States that collect tourism money in the name of tigers have been slow to raise the force meant to protect them," he elaborated.

Uttarakhand had announced the formation of the force last year, especially for Corbett National Park.

LEGAL IMMUNITY TO STPF

The STPF companies receive special training from the state police as well as the paramilitary forces based on a syllabus for skill development, combating poaching, and enabling intelligence-based enforcement in the forest terrain. The STPF personnel, being forest officers, would have policing powers, including the usage of firearms to combat tiger poaching and related offences within the tiger habitat.

Whenever firing is resorted to by the STPF personnel, each such incident shall be enquired into by the Executive Magistrate.

GAPS IN THE PROTECTION FORCE PROGRAMME

Former Principal Chief Conservator of Forest (head of forest force), Karnataka, BK Singh, said those who were appointed in the STPF used political influence to get transferred out of the force.

Singh said while Karnataka and Maharashtra recruited, trained, and armed STPF personnel, other states went for traditional ways like strengthening forest protection staff they regularly recruited and trained. "Those who were recruited did not like to stay in STPF forever and managed their transfer. The policy was faulty as no single person can be expected to be running after poachers and hunters for the entire length of the service period," he said.

Singh added that what was needed was regular recruitment for the STPF. "After five to 10 years, they would be shifted for regular forestry operations, and newly recruited personnel would take their place. This would have ensured continuity of the programme," he noted.

THE MISSING BIG CATS

In August, the National Tiger Conservation Authority initiated an investigation into missing tigers, and possible poaching of big cats in Nagarjunasagar Srisailem Tiger Reserve, Telangana, where 22 tigers have gone missing in the past couple of years. The NTCA has written to all tiger-bearing states, warning their chief wildlife wardens to be on the alert to prevent poaching and illegal trade in tiger products.



More than 100 tigers have been killed in multiple tiger reserves in the past three years. ISTOCK

RATINGS: ★★★★★EXCELLENT | ★★★★★VERY GOOD | ★★★GOOD | ★★AVERAGE | ★POOR

A befitting end to the triquel

FILM **Drishyam: The Conclusion**
DIRECTOR Abhishek Pathak
CAST Ajay Devgn, Jaideep Ahlawat, Tabu, Shriya Saran, Rajat Kapoor, Prakash Raj, Ishita Dutta, Mrunal Jadhav, Kamlesh Sawant, Saurabh Shukla
RATING ★★★

NONIKA SINGH

Can third time be the charm, or unnecessary fatigue? As Ajay Devgn’s successful ‘*Drishyam*’, a remake of Mohanlal’s franchise of the same name, races towards a decisive conclusion, it makes a departure too. In interview after interview, Ajay has claimed that the triquel does not follow the Malayalam original. However, the makers, keenly aware of the truism ‘don’t change a winning combination’, stay with its lead characters and actors.

Director of the second outing, Abhishek Pathak, is firmly in the saddle here as well. Needless to say, it’s still the same case in which the police and the parents of the murdered boy had failed to collect any concrete proof against Vijay Salagonkar (Ajay Devgn). So why would they reopen the case? Reason number one unfolds early on. Tabu’s Meera Deshpande is on the verge of a mental breakdown and her husband Mahesh Deshmukh (Rajat Kapoor) thinks only closure can bring her peace.

In walks the new SP (Crime), and who better than our hugely talented Jaideep Ahlawat to fit into the shoes of an indomitable police officer, Rajveer Singh Tomar. Trust him, however, to not do a Hathiram



Ajay Devgn (L) — secure in his skin and character — lets co-actors Prakash Raj (R) and Jaideep Ahlawat enjoy their moments of glory.

encore. The Haryanvi accent is missing but not the chutzpah or the dare. The actor, who wowed us with the tale of Dharmaraj Yudhista and his dog in ‘*Paatal Lok*’, comes up with yet another dog story. Effective and pertinent, told by Jaideep in his characteristic style, he never loses us. Nor does it make us miss Akshaye Khanna’s act from the previous ‘*Drishyam*’ instalment. Besides, who can utter words like *gaandiv* so effortlessly?

Till the interval, he is the front and centre of the narrative. A face-off between him and Ajay is but obvious and when it happens, it’s a bit improbable, a bit *filmi*. But here, too, he walks away with more than one brownie point to his credit.

If the first half belongs to him and Ajay, in the second part emerges Prakash Raj, playing an ace lawyer arguing the case on behalf of the aggrieved parents.

On the face of it, there is mounting evidence against Vijay, two solid witnesses too. The question once again is not whether or not this *chauthi*-pass will hoodwink his adversaries, but how. The kernel of the idea is still the same: the lengths to which a man would go to protect his family.

However, director Abhishek, who is also credited with the story and co-writing the screenplay, along with Parveez Shaikh and Aamil Keeyan Khan, spares us unwarranted flashbacks. He assumes that the audiences

walking into cinema halls for the third outing are clued in to the backstory. He infuses freshness by not only introducing two stellar actors, Jaideep and Prakash, but also keeping his prized hero in check. Ajay — restrained, unperturbed and unruffled once again — lets both Jaideep and Prakash enjoy their moments of glory.

Prakash is delectably over the top in the courtroom proceedings but to lend credibility to the film’s tenor, he is soon reined in by the judge. Then there is peppering of interesting and relevant humour, with Kamlesh Sawant reprising his part of SI Laxmikant Gaitonde. He reminds us how he is the only permanent member of the law-enforcing machinery



‘Pooja Meri Jaan’ has a genuinely potent film hiding inside it.

Juliet in the dock

ZEE5 **Pooja Meri Jaan**
DIRECTORS Navjot Gulati, Vipasha Arvind
CAST Mrunal Thakur, Huma Qureshi, Vijay Raaz, Vikram Singh Chauhan, Sunita Rajwar
RATING ★★★

VARUN KAUSHIK

What would the world make of Juliet had only Romeo died? The question looms over ‘*Pooja Meri Jaan*’ almost literally.

The film opens with a staging of Shakespeare’s famed tragedy, with Pooja (Mrunal Thakur) and Aniket (Vikram Singh Chauhan) playing the titular lovers. Having met through a theatre troupe, they have been friends for five years. Aniket has loved Pooja for about all five; Pooja, not so much.

Amid rousing applause, Aniket proposes marriage. She doesn’t quite say no, but there isn’t a smile of yes either. A shocked Pooja wears the ring, only for a fight to erupt backstage.

The fight escalates. Aniket dies by suicide. Because romance, Bollywood has taught us, is a strange country where persistence is adorable, obsession is flattering and a woman saying no is apparently a plot twist.

Her rejection becomes evidence. Her personality becomes evidence. Her purportedly long list of boyfriends becomes evidence. In a particularly grim social tradition, the dead man gets sympathy while the living woman gets an investigation. And this is where ‘*Pooja Meri Jaan*’ has a genuinely potent film hiding inside it.

The smartest thing about the screenplay is that it initially refuses to make Aniket an easy villain. He is not introduced twirling a moustache over a vat of toxic masculinity. He is filmy, persistent, apparently affectionate and completely convinced that love is something one eventually wins.

That makes the discomfort more interesting. The film is not asking whether a monster can hurt a woman. It is asking when the charming lover boy stops hearing her and starts rewriting her refusal as a temporary obstacle.

The answer, unfortunately, comes wrapped in a screenplay that some-

times explains its own homework. Everything from the camera treatment to the dialogue is middling and ineffective, leaving a pressing logline better suited to a crisper narrative.

And then comes the courtroom. Deplorable lawyer Jatin (Vijay Raaz) finds himself enamoured with the social-media trial reducing a woman to a hashtag and, after a sermon on how many men are ruined by “fake dowry cases”, approaches Aniket’s family. Fighting for Pooja is Huma Qureshi’s Sana, a corporate lawyer and common friend to both, defending a woman she is not completely sure of.

The talented Qureshi is criminally underserved by the lacklustre script, though she brings welcome steel. Raaz does what Raaz does: perform menace, yet somehow ground it.

But the legal battle, laced with condescension, rarely develops the crackling tension its premise promises.

The irony is that ‘*Pooja Meri Jaan*’ is strongest when it trusts ambiguity. Thakur understands this. She does not play Pooja as some spotless patron saint who has wandered into a misogynistic courtroom by clerical error. Pooja can be impulsive, complicated, occasionally harsh and capable of questionable choices. Good. Let her be.

A woman should not need to be perfectly behaved before her no becomes legally, morally or humanly legible. Thakur gives that contradiction a bruised vulnerability, though flashes of daily-soap affectation creep into her performance. Chauhan has the more thankless task of playing a man who believes his own romantic mythology.

The film’s problem is not its heart. It is that its head keeps getting in the way. There is a sharp film here about rejection, obsession, consent and the social reflex that turns a man’s emotional devastation into a woman’s moral indictment. ‘*Pooja Meri Jaan*’ occasionally gets very close to it. Then, just when it should dig deeper, it reaches for the shovel labelled ‘Message’.

Still, its central question survives the sermon: when a woman says no, why is the first instinct so often to investigate her reasons rather than respect her answer?

A remake that’s fun while it lasts

FILM **Prem Keetanu**
DIRECTOR Apoorv Singh Karki
CAST Veer Pahariya, Aafiya Syed, Aparshakti Khurana, Nikhil Vijay, Rakesh Bedi
RATING ★★★

SUBHASH K JHA

Remakes are tough beasts to handle, especially now when audiences don’t want to see the same film faithfully filmed in another language. But wait. This one actually works.

‘*Prem Keetanu*’ is not a copy-and-paste, what a waste, version of the Malayalam hit ‘*Premalu*’. Director Apoorv Singh Karki, whose earlier anti-rape film ‘*Sirf Ek Banda Kafi Hai*’ shares a direct affiliation to the series ‘*Hunkkaar: The Roar*’ released last week, lets his hair down with this blithe, deceptively frothy take on love *aaj kal*....

Or the swimmingly breezy who-needs-commitment-when-you-have-dating-apps rom-com with enough juice to keep the glow going with the flow even when we know the ending.

The main characters seem believable, even relatable, as they are played by actors who are not glamorous, unattainable stars. Veer Pahariya, debutant Aafiya Syed and the underrated Aparshakti Khurana, who I firmly believe to be a better actor than his brother Ayushmann, give off the nostalgic vibes of Amol Palekar, Vidya Sinha and Asrani from Basu Chatterjee’s ‘*Chhoti Si Baat*’, although ‘*Prem Keetanu*’ is not in any way related to the Basu classic, which boasted



Veer Pahariya’s Vishal is more interested in dating than studies.

of some great songs.

I am afraid the songs in ‘*Prem Keetanu*’ are not only overplayed in the narrative, almost to the point of seeming manifestations of directorial insecurity, they are also very aspirational. It’s like a soundtrack composed by a bunch of school boys for a play based on young sing-along love.

The narrative tends to get overcocky at times. But that quality works in the film’s favour, for what we see here are a bunch of over-reachers who take themselves much too seriously. Veer Pahariya, who made a reasonably positive impact in ‘*Sky Force*’, is cast here as Vishal, a small-townner more interested in dating than studies.

There is an interesting dynamic between Vishal and his roomie Mangal (the Dhanush-lookalike Nikhil Vijay), which assigns the best friend a more creative function than the normal sidekicks we see accompanying the hero.

The “hero” is not so much a hero as a social climber looking for ways to circumvent hard work. A sort of Rakesh Roshan from ‘*Kaamchor*’ transposed to the current times.

The ladder-climbing is not spotlighted, but we feel its presence.

In Cruise control

JOHNSON THOMAS

Alejandro G Inarritu, the director of cinematic gems such as ‘*Amores Perros*’ (2000), ‘*21 Grams*’ (2003), ‘*Babel*’ (2006), ‘*Birdman*’ (2014) and ‘*The Revenant*’ (2015), has finally come up with yet another English language feature winner. And it is likely to be both divisive and devastating to the audience. This latest venture, after an 11-year hiatus, is a biting-witty, big-budget, contemporary socio-political dramedy that floors you with its hard-hitting barbs on the politics of today.

The cinematic experience in ‘*Digger*’ feels exploratory, unique and imaginative. The narrative keeps you enraptured within its fluid transitions while holding fort with pointed messaging that

FILM **Digger**
DIRECTOR Alejandro G Inarritu
CAST Tom Cruise, Riz Ahmed, John Goodman, Sandra Hüller, Michael Stuhlbarg, Jesse Plemons, Robert John Burke, Emma D’Arcy, Burn Gorman, Mercedes Hernandez, Danny Kirrane, Pip Torrens
RATING ★★★★★

keeps it hilarious, innovative and entertaining.

The film plays out as a stirring satire on the world we live in. Tom Cruise is an ageing theatre actor who plays Digger Rockwell, an environmentally unconscious Big Oil oligarch, in a play that looks to be as big budget as the film it resides in.

Tom Cruise plays the eponymous role with cartoonish relish,

while officers before him have come and gone. If like us, you too are misled by Shriya Saran as Nandini and her hapless demeanour, watch her get her moment in the climax.

If Ajay remains in the character all through, the treatment maintains tonal consistency, though one wishes the background music had been toned down. Editing by Sandeep Francis moves between varying areas of action, ensuring tension sustains. Momentum and suspense are maintained, even though we know what will happen in the final scheme of things. Hasn’t Murad Ali (Saurabh Shukla) already told us what is common in all of Vijay’s stories is that the hero doesn’t go to jail. And right up to the moment when the inevitable unveils and details are deconstructed, we are once again entrapped by this *kahani* of a semi-literate cine buff outdoing a bunch of highly educated people in the echelons of power:

Vijay tells us *drishya* (what we see) is more important than *shabd* (what we say), for words imbed lies within. Writing, especially dialogues by Aamil, is solid and packed with intelligent references. There are some loop-holes, but ‘*filmon ka sach homa zaroori nahi, sach dikhna zaroori hai*’. We see the cinematic truth through the lens of the makers and enjoy the line between truth and justice whose definition, too, changes depending upon who is telling the story.

If in the realm of poetic justice, the real *gaandiv* is not *saboot* or *kanoon*; what matters in filmmaking is intent, purpose and execution, very much in alignment here.

WHAT’S STREAMING



DUPAHIYA SEASON 2

PRIME VIDEO

Set in the quirky, no-longer-crime-free village of Dhadakpur, the comedy-drama returns with its signature blend of innocence and madness, along with fresh challenges, bigger chaos and plenty of laughs. Directed by Sonam Nair, it features Gajraj Rao, Renuka Shahane, Sparsh Shrivastava, and Bhuvan Arora.



OHH MY DOG

NETFLIX

It is a heartwarming story that celebrates the unconditional love and loyalty shared between humans and dogs. The film revolves around the touching relationship between a young child and a dog, highlighting their trust and companionship. It aims to deliver a message of kindness, friendship and peaceful coexistence.



KAHAN SHURU KAHAN KHATAM

JIOHOTSTAR

Starring Dhvani Bhanushali and Aashim Gulati, this romantic comedy begins with an unexpected wedding-crashing encounter that sets off a chaotic road journey. What follows is a series of lighthearted mishaps, unexpected turns and a romance that slowly begins to take shape.



MAIN LADEGA

JIOHOTSTAR

Starring Akash Pratap Singh, this inspiring sports drama follows a young man battling personal trauma and conflict at home, who finds strength and purpose through boxing. As he takes on the sport, he begins to fight not just in the ring, but for his own self-respect and a better life.



Tom Cruise plays the eponymous role with cartoonish relish.

donning latex and wearing the eccentric billionaire cowpoke attire. He literally lives the role of an oil tycoon who accidentally causes a global environmental disaster that sets the US on a collision course with Europe, Russia in particular.

Digger is faced with the challenge of coming up with a face-saving effort to save the world from a disaster he has caused, while avoiding getting blamed, and also managing to make a few big bucks out of it.

We are first introduced to Dig-

ger as a devoted cat lover who cares for his ageing feline Maggie, suffering from a multitude of terminal conditions. It’s a feint that gets us thinking positive thoughts about the central character... but not for long.

When Digger hears that the drilling he is doing in Greenland has caused the ice shelf to rupture from the coastline and is on a collision course with Europe, he, along with the US President (John Goodman) and his chief health and science safety officer Ganesh (Riz Ahmed) discuss ways to handle the catastrophe.

A crazy Digger scrambles to spin the crisis in a manner that ensures he comes off clean. The sheer audacity of those machinations will lay bare the behind-the-scenes shenanigans of world leaders and their ilk.

Cruise, with a paunch and a scraggly hairline, showcases his

passion for this deeply complex role of a lifetime. He plays it with nuanced subtlety. This is undoubtedly an Oscar nomination worthy performance. Ahmed and Goodman also look likely to make it to the best supporting actor category nominations.

Cruise’s transformation is astonishing and a large part of the credit should go to the costumes and make-up. Cinematographer Emmanuel Lubezki shot the film on VistaVision, which affords the finished product with a sharper and larger frame of reference.

‘*Digger*’ is a highly effective cinematic work. The marriage of art and entertainment has never been so sublime. The movie is incredibly funny; the technical aspects are brilliant.

This Inarritu-Cruise *jugalbandi* is compelling enough to draw the audience to the theatres in large numbers.

CJP, student bodies, Oppn protest in Delhi, Mumbai for CEC’s ouster

MANIKANT MISHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

An alliance of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) supporters, Opposition and student organisation leaders hit the streets in Delhi and Mumbai on Friday, demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar amid allegations of irregularities in the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Over 700 persons were detained in Delhi as they tried to breach barricades and march towards Jantar Mantar, a move the police foiled, deploying force later in the day.

In Mumbai, Shivaji Park grounds saw a massive gathering of supporters as Abhijeet Dipke-led CJP cadres raised banners and placards with some reading, “Gyanu, it is done bro!” and “The janta has a spine, Gyanu must resign.”

In Delhi, Internet services remained suspended in and around Jantar Mantar with the police not allowing anyone to breach barriers to enter the site, where the CJP had led a massive protest that had culminated in the resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan in July. Dipke on Friday said, “The government is so ineffective that we have had to return to the streets barely two months after our protests in Jantar Mantar in July.”

He also dared Maharashtra



Security personnel detain AISA president Neha Bora during a protest at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on Friday. m

CM Devendra Fadnavis to arrest the agitating youth as hundreds waved flags demanding Kumar’s ouster. The CJP said Friday’s protests were a commencement of a month-long agitation across India, which will end with a rally in Delhi.

Activist Tushar Gandhi, Mahatma Gandhi’s great-grandson, was also present during the protests timed with Gandhi Jayanti. Activists from Left-affiliated student bodies, SFI and AISE, joined as did actors Shabana Azmi, Naseeruddin Shah and singer Vishal Dadlani.

Meanwhile, the Delhi Police did not allow protesters to enter Jantar Mantar on Friday, say-

ing there was no permission for an agitation at the site. Protesters were stopped along all arterial roads as the police made public announcements asking people not to gather at Jantar Mantar in the absence of permission for a protest. Entry and exit gates of 12 metro stations in Delhi were also shut all day and reopened at 9 pm. No online transactions were possible in key markets, including Connaught Place.

The police said around 700 protesters were detained in Delhi before being let off. These included AAP leaders Atishi, Sanjay Singh, Saurabh Bharadwaj and Sanjeev Jha, CPM general secretary MA Baby and leader Brinda Karat,

CPI national secretary P Sandosh Kumar, RJD leader Manoj Jha, activist Yogendra Yadav, AISA president Neha Bora, Rajya Sabha member AA Rahim and former Jawaharlal Nehru Students’ Union president Aishe Ghosh.

Indian Youth Congress workers also joined the protest ahead of a joint call for agitation by the Opposition on the same issue on October 6.

Meanwhile, Kumar has not responded to allegations and the EC has maintained that the SIR exercise has been upheld by the Supreme Court and is lawful. It has said that the exercise aims to remove duplicate, deceased and ineligible voters.

DIPKE CALLS FOR DELHI STIR ON OCTOBER 10

■ CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke said if CEC Gyanesh Kumar doesn’t resign, “cockroaches” from across India will march to Delhi and protest at Jantar Mantar on October 10.

■ He said, “If the Delhi Police tries to stop us, wherever they stop us will become our Jantar Mantar. Ours will be a peaceful andolan. We will walk on the path shown by Mahatma Gandhi.”

■ “It is up to the government and the Delhi Police whether they respect our right to peaceful protest or repeat the brutality we saw on July 20. Every citizen who wants free and fair elections must join,” he added.

75-year-old dies of heart attack after attending protest

A 75-year-old Thane resident, Gopalakrishna Subbaiya Pillai, died of heart attack after he complained of chest pain while attending the CJP protest at Shivaji Park on Friday evening, the police said.

He had reached Shivaji Park around 4.30 pm. Around 5 pm, Pillai felt uneasy and complained of chest pain. His friend and the police personnel deployed at the site came to his aid. A doctor gave him preliminary treatment before he was taken to Sushrusha Hospital in Shivaji Park. His condition deteriorated despite treatment. He was declared dead at the hospital.

Jairam: EC violating law through ECINet system

SHEKHAR SINGH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

Congress MP Jairam Ramesh on Friday accused the Election Commission of violating electoral laws through its ECINet voter roll system. He said the panel’s decision to appoint a committee to review the system had exposed the hollowness of its earlier claim that ECINet had been developed in strict compliance with the law and the Constitution.

Ramesh said the EC should not have needed to establish whether its own system complied with the Representation of the People Act, 1950, and the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, questioning the circumstances in which Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar had allowed the system to be introduced.

He said ECINet was

CONG TO HOLD ORGANISATIONAL MEET

The Congress has convened a key organisational meeting of its general secretaries, state in-charges, PCC presidents and heads of frontal organisations on October 5 amid the INDIA bloc’s campaign over electoral rolls and the EC.

launched on January 22 with the stated objective of enhancing “transparency, credibility and public trust”. “The EC assured the country that the system had been developed in accordance with the Constitution, Representation of the People Acts and the Registration of Electors Rules. All of this was a lie,” Ramesh said.

His remarks came after the EC recently announced that a panel would review ECINet to certify its compliance with the relevant Acts and Rules.

Lawyers’ group sets up inquiry panel led by SC ex-judge on SIR

SATYA PRAKASH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

More than four months after the Supreme Court upheld the validity of the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls undertaken by the Election Commission, the Lawyers Associations for Constitution has formed an inquiry commission comprising former judges to inquire into the validity and impact of the SIR.

Headed by former SC judge Madan B Lokur, the ‘independent inquiry commission’ will have former SC Judge AK Patnaik, former Jammu and Kashmir High Court Chief Justice BD Ahmad, former Delhi HC Judge Rekha Sharma and former Patna HC Judge Anjana Prakash as members, said the association.

Senior lawyers Kapil Sibal, Prashant Bhushan, CU Singh,

On May 27, top court upheld constitutional validity of exercise

PC Sen, Raju Ramachandran, Rebecca M John, Warisha Parasat and Vrinda Grover will assist the commission. The commission will hold public hearings with a target to release its report by December 2026.

On May 27, the Supreme Court had upheld the constitutional validity of the SIR of the electoral rolls undertaken by the Election Commission, saying it advanced the constitutional imperative of free and fair elections.

“The impugned SIR exercise, as conducted, satisfies the requirements of proportionality. The measures adopted bear a rational nexus to the objective sought to be achieved, are not

manifestly excessive, and are accompanied by sufficient procedural safeguards to prevent arbitrary exclusion,” a Bench led by CJI Surya Kant said.

The Bench, which also included Justice Joymalya Bagchi, said the SIR was founded upon a legitimate and constitutionally grounded purpose — restoration of accuracy, completeness, and integrity of the electoral rolls. “We hold that the impugned SIR neither stands in direct conflict with the RP (Representation of People) Act and the 1960 Rules, nor does it detract from the constitutional imperative of free and fair elections,” the Bench said.

It categorically ruled that the Election Commission had the powers to conduct the SIR under Article 324 of the Constitution, read with Representation of the People Act and the Rules framed thereunder.

Poll panel orders special drive for excluded, first-time electors

ANIMESH SINGH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

The Election Commission has directed all chief electoral officers (CEOs) to conduct a special drive for the enrolment of left out and first-time voters.

The directive has come after the poll panel came under fire over the deletion of around 13 crore names in 20 states and Union Territories where the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls has been completed. Questions have also been raised on the need for revising voter lists in the entire country.

In a letter to all CEOs on September 29, followed by a meeting with them on October 1 via video conferencing, the EC asked them to direct all booth-level officers (BLOs) to compare the current electoral roll with the pre-SIR electoral roll and identify voters whose names were there in the pre-SIR roll but not included in the current electoral roll, and prepare a list of such electors. BLOs will undertake house-to-house

visits to ascertain their present status and facilitate enrolment through Form 6, if the person is found eligible to be enrolled as a voter.

The poll body has directed that BLOs may cover at least 20-25 electors in a week so as to complete this exercise within a period of around one month. The officials will also indicate the present status of each such voter in the list prepared by them, the EC said.

The electors for whom Form 6 has been filled up will also be indicated, while the BLOs will also ensure filling up of Form 6 for enrolment of any left out and first-time voters during their house-to-house visits.

BLOs have been asked to share this list with the booth-level agents (BLAs) of the recognised political parties. They will also share the list with the election registration officer (ERO) of the area, who is normally the SDM, along with the filled Form 6 and their field verification report.

ERO is the competent authority to act as deemed fit on these cases as per the

provisions under the Representation of The People Act, 1950, and the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

At the end of this exercise, the booth-wise lists will also be shared by the EROs with the representatives of the political parties, giving them a further opportunity to enable enrolment of any left out voters.

Besides, booth-level camps will be organised to facilitate the submission of applications for enrolment. Special camps may also be organised for enrolment of people living in night shelters, labour colonies as well as for homeless and marginalised persons, the EC told the CEOs.

The CEOs, DEOs (district election officers) and EROs will further undertake appropriate awareness and mobilisation activities through educational institutions, local-level outreach, SVEEP activities, regular press briefings and other suitable platforms to ensure that every eligible citizen is made aware of the opportunity to get enrolled, the poll body ordered.

Oppn attacking EC, CEC to divert attention from poll defeats: BJP

INDORE, OCTOBER 2

Opposition leaders questioning the Election Commission and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar are trying to divert public attention from their own electoral failures, BJP Rajya Sabha member Rajneesh Agrawal said on Friday.

He told reporters here that it was not appropriate to put the Election Commission or other constitutional institutions in the dock “without any facts and logic”. “Those who are talking about the Election Commission or the CEC are those who have faced a series of electoral failures. By doing this, they want to divert attention from their own failures and somehow save face among the public,” he claimed.

Agrawal refrained from commenting on the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-led protest in Mumbai during the day demanding the resignation of Kumar. “The entire Opposition’s narrative against the ruling BJP is based on lies,” he added. — PTI

RK Singh calls for re-poll across states affected by electoral roll revision

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

Former Union Minister and former BJP MP RK Singh on Friday again attacked Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar for ordering restoring names of young and first time voters, who were deleted during the special intensive revision (SIR), saying that the only solution is by holding elections again in those states where they held after the purification exercise was conducted.

In a long post on X, he wrote, “Gyanesh Kumar has now, out of fear, taken a decision to launch a campaign to restore to the electoral rolls the 13 crore 30 lakh people whom he had excluded from the voter lists through various stratagems during the SIR. Kumar may note however that he will not escape punishment for the massive disenfranchisement of the 13 crore 30 lac people. In Bihar, West Bengal, Assam, Kerala and Tamil Nadu, where elections were held after SIR, crores of people were deprived of their right to vote. How can

this be redressed? There is only one solution: elections should be conducted again in these states on the basis of the electoral rolls that was in place before the SIR.”

He further wrote that “Under Section 100 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, if votes have been improperly rejected, the election is to be declared void. In the elections to these states, 2.87 crore voters were not allowed to vote and lakhs of people whose appeals were still pending were ignored”.

Singh said, “The most reprehensible thing is that the Honorable Supreme Court – which is supposed to protect the fundamental rights of people; allowed the most fundamental of fundamental rights in a democracy – the right to vote to be trampled upon, saying how “does it matter?”

Earlier this week, Singh had in an open letter to the CEC accused him of removing names of all the voters who had been listed by the EROs after 2003, without any basis or enquiry.

Rules framed for standardising appointment of tribunal members

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

Seeking to standardise recruitment and eligibility for various tribunal posts, establish a formal inquiry mechanism for misconduct complaints and prescribe service conditions and remuneration, the government has come out with rules for the National Tribunals Commission.

Issued on September 30 and published on Thursday by the Union law ministry, the rules will enable the newly-created National Tribunals Commission appoint chairpersons and members to 16 tribunals and appellate bodies.

According to the National Tribunals Commission and Qualification, Selection and Conditions of Service of Chairperson and Members of Tribunals Rules, 2026, a commission chairperson will get Rs 2.5 lakh per month and commission members Rs 2.25 lakh per month.

A similar pay is applicable to tribunal chairpersons and members. There is a provision for specified exceptions. — PTI

Farmers shouldn’t just be food providers: Gadkari in fresh pitch for biofuel

RINKU BEHERA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari again pitched for ethanol and biofuels as a new economic opportunity for the country, calling for agriculture to be diversified beyond food production into energy and fuel.

He said farmers could become producers of ethanol, Bio-CNG, aviation fuel, bitumen and other green fuels, helping reduce India’s dependence on imported petroleum while creating new sources of rural income.

“India imports petroleum, diesel and gas worth around Rs 22 lakh crore. A farmer should not be only a food provider. The farmer should also become an energy provider, fuel provider, bitumen provider, hydrogen provider and aviation-fuel provider,” Gadkari said while speaking at an event in Patna.

Gadkari highlighted the expansion of ethanol blending in petrol and stressed that the fuel could help create a new

market for agricultural produce while reducing dependence on fossil-fuel imports.

He said flex-fuel vehicles capable of running on high concentrations of ethanol are being developed by major automobile manufacturers, including Toyota, Hyundai, Tata, Mahindra and Mercedes, while two-wheeler manufacturers such as Bajaj, TVS, Hero and Honda have also introduced flex-fuel models. “These vehicles can run on 100% ethanol instead of petrol,” Gadkari said.

Gadkari also said ethanol-based fuel could cost around Rs 70-75 per litre, compared with petrol at around Rs 120 per litre, describing it as an “import substitute, cost-effective, pollution-free and indigenous” fuel.

According to him, after ethanol production from maize and broken rice expanded, maize prices in Bihar and Uttar Pradesh rose to around Rs 2,628 per quintal, compared with an earlier market price of about Rs 1,000 per quintal and an MSP of around Rs 1,800 per quintal.

AI shouldn’t dilute constitutional values, says CJI

SATYA PRAKASH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

Noting that courts could not remain untouched by the rapid transformation brought about by technology, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant has called for embracing digitalisation and artificial intelligence in the justice system while ensuring that technological advancement does not dilute the constitutional values of dignity, equality, liberty and fairness.

Addressing the opening session of the 7th Congress of the Association of Asian Constitutional Courts (AACC) in Samarkand, Uzbekistan, CJI



CJI Surya Kant during the 7th Congress of the Association of Asian Constitutional Courts and Equivalent Institutions in Uzbekistan. p71

Kant said, “Technology is changing the way our societies

function. It is changing the way governments deliver services,

businesses operate and citizens interact with public institutions. Courts, too, cannot remain untouched by this transformation.”

The theme of the AACC is “Constitutional Justice in the Era of Digitalisation and Artificial Intelligence”.

“Artificial intelligence can assist judges and court staff in research and in managing large volumes of information. These are opportunities that we must approach with openness and imagination. “But technology also presents us with a more fundamental question: what must remain

unchanged when everything around us is changing? For Constitutional Courts, the answer lies in the values we are entrusted to protect,” he said.

Later, addressing the plenary session of the AACC, he said AI may supplement research and support the judicial processes, but can never replace the legal acumen or decision-making which must always remain with judges. He said technology must be harnessed to expand access to justice while ensuring that it does not exclude vulnerable citizens or undermine public trust in the judicial system.

Pilots’ body seeks nat’l award for Smit

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

The Federation of Indian Pilots (FIP) has sought a national bravery award for flydubai pilot Captain Smit Machchhar, who was seriously injured in a cockpit attack by his first officer but continued to perform his duties during the emergency and helped bring the aircraft safely to an alternate airport in Saudi Arabia.

In a letter to Prime Minister

Narendra Modi on Friday, FIP president Captain CS Randhawa said Machchhar’s conduct during the September 30 incident warranted “special recognition” and urged the government to consider him for an appropriate national bravery award or civilian recognition.

Flydubai flight FZ1073 was operating from Dubai to Tel Aviv when the incident occurred. In its letter, the FIP

said the passengers and crew had no control over the extraordinary circumstances unfolding inside the cockpit and their safety depended on the flight crew retaining control of the aircraft and managing the emergency. “Despite his injuries and the threat inside the flight deck, Machchhar continued to discharge his responsibilities as pilot-in-command,” he said. — TNS

TN suspends officials for using Hindi on signboard

CHENNAI, OCTOBER 2

Two officials were suspended for violating the official two-language policy of Tamil and English, and using Hindi words on a signboard on a state highway, the Tamil Nadu Government said here on Friday.

The Hindi words were erased from the signboard and depart-

mental action has also been initiated against them, who are assistant engineers with the Highways Department. On a newly installed signboard on Saththankulam-Nazareth State Highway, in addition to Tamil and English, the names of towns were embossed in Hindi as well. — PTI

20th Asian Games

Aichi-Nagoya 2026

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NEERU TO BE FLAG BEARER AT CLOSING CEREMONY

NAGOYA: Ace Indian trap shooter Neeru Dhandra will be one of the flag bearers at the closing ceremony on Sunday after capping a remarkable campaign with two gold medals and a team silver to emerge as one of the most successful athletes at the continental showpiece. The 27-year-old, who returned to India a day after winning her third medal, will travel back to Nagoya on Saturday morning.



FAVOURITES INDIA FACE PAKISTAN IN MEN'S CRICKET FINAL

NAGOYA: World champions India, boasting a formidable line-up of T20 stars, will look to underline their supremacy on the cricket field when they take on Pakistan in the men's gold medal clash. Not an inch would be spared on the pitch and off it — there is little or no chance of players shaking hands. And for a nation that believes in using sport as a soft power, the significance of a gold medal, that too by beating Pakistan, is immense.



SAILOR NETHRA CLAIMS BRONZE IN WOMEN'S DINGHY

GAMAGORI CITY: India's Nethra Kumanan clinched the bronze medal in the women's dinghy event of the sailing competition, securing her first podium finish at the continental showpiece in her fourth appearance. The 29-year-old two-time Olympian logged 14 points. In the men's competition, Vishnu Saravanan ended fourth. The 27-year-old, who is also an Olympian, had won a bronze medal in the previous edition.

Country	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
China	162	81	73	316
Japan	72	83	85	240
Korea	33	39	62	134
Uzbekistan	20	23	22	65
India	16	25	35	76
Iran	15	17	13	45

Lovlina, Parveen, Ankush strike boxing gold as India climb into top-5 of medal standings

NISHIO, OCTOBER 2

Indian boxers delivered a sensational hat-trick of gold medals at the Asian Games with Lovlina Borgohain (75kg), Parveen Hooda (65kg) and Ankush Panghal (80kg) producing contrasting but stirring performances in their respective finals here on Friday.

Lovlina and Parveen ended a 12-year wait by joining legendary MC Mary Kom in the select group of Indian women boxers to have won Asian Games gold. The Manipuri had claimed the flyweight (51kg) title at the 2014 Games in Incheon.

India thus finished atop the boxing medals tally, signing off with six medals, including three gold. It is India's best-ever performance at the Asian Games in terms of gold medals. Besides the gold, Priya Ghanghas (60kg), Kapil Pokhariya (90kg) and Narender Berwal (+90kg) won bronze medals. The country's best overall haul came at the Guangzhou 2010 edition, where the contingent won nine medals — two gold, three silver and four bronze.

Lovlina defeated China's Ziyi Bao 5-0 on her 29th birthday to upgrade the silver she had won at the last edition. Parveen then eked out a narrow 3-2 split-decision win over Paris Olympics bronze medallist Chen Nien-chin of Chinese Taipei to claim her maiden Asian Games gold. Ankush then beat South Korea's Kim Minseong in the final to become the first Indian male boxer since Amit Panghal in 2018 to win an Asian Games gold medal.

"Today is my birthday. It's a very special birthday, I'm feeling really good. I thought I'd have to gift a gold medal on my birthday. It's the first time that I got a present for myself. I gave it my all. I didn't think for a second that I would lose," Lovlina said.

"It was a very tough fight. But I was always thinking that I just have to win. The last round was very tough.

TRIPLE PUNCH



Lovlina beat China's Ziyi Bao in the 75kg final; BELOW: Ankush beat Korea's Kim Minseong in the 80kg final. PTL, REUTERS



I was winning by 2-1 in the first and second round. So I thought I have to just win the third round."

Lovlina made the most of her considerable height advantage, while the 20-year-old Bao constantly tried to close the distance and deny

the Indian space to work. The approach made for a messy contest, with Bao resorting to repeated clinches.

In a departure from her usual approach, Lovlina started aggressively, landing a few punches right away, but Bao was equally

fierce with her counters.

The Chinese southpaw connected a couple of combinations, before Lovlina finished the round strongly with some clean, heavy punches to edge it 3-2.

Trailing, Bao came out aggressively in the second round, looking to close the distance, while Lovlina tried to keep her at bay and create room for her punches.

The Indian managed to find her range towards the end of the round, landing a series of clean blows to take it 4-1 on the judges' cards.

The same pattern continued in the final round, with Bao throwing punches in abundance but struggling to land cleanly. Lovlina remained compact in

defence and picked her moments to counter.

Having done enough to establish her lead, Lovlina slowed the pace in the closing stages and chose not to engage unnecessarily, keeping Bao at a distance and seeing out the contest.

At the last edition, Lovlina had lost to another Chinese boxer, Li Qian, in the final, settling for silver. This time, she made sure there was no repeat of that result.

For Parveen, the victory marked redemption. Her bronze medal from the 2022 Hangzhou Asian Games was stripped following a suspension for whereabouts failures, an episode that also derailed her Olympics hopes amid her father's health issues.

"When all that happened to me, I was mentally down. Everything was over. I had to start from zero. But I was sad for a few days. Then I reset my mind. If I don't train now and don't make a comeback, I will live in regret all my life," she said.

"Because of a small mistake, so much happened. So I decided to take everything the other way around, with interest. In Haryana, gold medal winners get the post of deputy director. It was my dream job."

Ankush has steadily emerged as one of India's most promising young boxers and, in his first year on the senior circuit, the 21-year-old added the Asian Games title to the Commonwealth Games gold he won earlier this year.

He put up an assured and dominant display against Kim. "I was doing well in the training camp for eight months. This is the best year I have seen in 10 years. I got a gold medal. I am feeling good," he said. "I have seen my opponent's bouts. I practised according to him. I was confident that I would win. I was never overconfident that I would beat everyone. I just wanted to do my best."

Ankush started on the front foot, landing a couple of early punches before Kim responded. Both looked eager to establish control, making for a fast-paced opening with quick exchanges and sharp movement. Kim then opted to counter, allowing Ankush to take the initiative, and the Indian edged the round 4-1. Kim came out more aggressively in the second and managed to push Ankush back, but the Indian found ways to escape and responded by landing enough clean punches to take the round unanimously and strengthen his advantage. Ankush took fewer risks in the final round, using his footwork to make Kim chase him around the ring and take a split-decision victory. — PTI

Inside Asiad

India settle for bronze in sepaktakraw

NAGOYA: The Indian team went down fighting 0-2 to hosts Japan in the men's quadrant semifinals to settle for a bronze medal in the sepaktakraw competition. India lost the last-four match 12-15 13-15. India had earlier won each of their Group A matches to top the group, defeating Laos (2-0), Vietnam (2-0) and Myanmar (2-1). On the other hand, Japan had finished second in Group B. Earlier in the day, the Indian women's team was beaten 0-2 (10-15 4-15) by Thailand in a preliminary Group A contest.

Golfer Pranavi takes sole lead in pursuit of gold

NAGOYA: India's Pranavi Urs returned a superb 4-under 66 in the third round to take a three-stroke lead and place herself in strong contention for an individual gold medal in the women's golf competition. The 23-year-old, who is making her Games debut, has a total of 15-under. The Indian women's team comprising Pranavi (66-63-66), Aditi Ashok (71-74-70) and Diksha Dagar (71-73-71) is in the second place, four shots behind the Chinese. Things did not go great for the men's team, though Veer Ahlawat brought home a card of 5-under 65. Ahlawat climbed into the top-10, while Saptak Talwar (66-68-71) is 11th. Yuvraj Sandhu (71-69-71) is T-23. The team is in sixth place.

Men's hockey team eyes historic gold

KAKAMIGAHARA: The Indian men's hockey team will look to bring its best game forward in its bid to defend the gold medal as well as book a spot in the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics when it takes on Malaysia in the summit clash on Saturday. India have never won successive Asian Games gold medals. A victory would make Harmanpreet Singh the first Indian captain to lead the men's team in winning two consecutive gold medals. Manpreet Singh, the most capped Indian hockey player, can set another record by becoming the only player from the country to win three Asian Games gold medals.

Lin wins gold 2 years after gender row

NAGOYA: Taiwan's Lin Yuting won an Asian Games gold in her new weight category two years after she was caught up in a gender dispute at the Paris Olympics. Lin and Algeria's Imane Khelif both won gold in Paris amid a dispute over their eligibility. Lin was cleared to compete earlier this year after World Boxing completed a review of her sex-eligibility status. "After the Paris Olympics, I took a little bit of a break," the 30-year-old said. "Coming back to boxing, I wanted to exceed my performance from the Paris Olympics, try to find my new self and have better capabilities in boxing." Her Olympics title and her first Asian Games crown, won in Hangzhou, both came at 57kg. In Japan, Lin moved up to 60kg, and at the Nishio Gymnasium she used her reach and counter-punching to beat China's Yang Chengyu 5-0 for her second Asian Games gold. Despite her pedigree, Lin said the heavier division made her feel like a novice again.



Women's recurve archery team wins historic gold



Kumkum Mohod, Ankita Bhakat and Kirti Sharma celebrate after winning the gold. REUTERS

NAGOYA, OCTOBER 2

The women's recurve team's stunning win over 10-time Olympics champions South Korea for a historic gold headlined a highly productive day for India in the Asian Games archery competition where the men's recurve and mixed recurve squads signed off with commendable silver medals. The strong recurve performance comes after the compound archers completed a golden

sweep. India have so far secured seven medals — four gold, two silver and a bronze — in the archery event.

The first medal of the day for the Indian contingent came via the women's recurve trio of Ankita Bhakat, Kirti Sharma and 17-year-old Kumkum Mohod, who held their nerve in challenging windy conditions to outshoot the defending champions 5-3 (54-54, 56-56, 55-51, 54-54) and script a memorable triumph.

Kumkum then returned to the range with Dhiraj Bommadevara and combined for a silver medal in the mixed recurve team event, with the Indian duo going down 3-5 (34-38, 35-37, 37-36, 37-37) to China in the final.

The day ended with the men's recurve combination of Bommadevara, Sanjay Bhoge and Neeraj Chauhan settling for a silver following a 1-5 loss (56-56, 50-57, 54-56) to Korea. — PTI

Indian bowlers seek improvement

MULLANPUR, OCTOBER 2

India's under-fire bowling attack would be eyeing an improved outing with the pressure especially mounting on veteran Ravindra Jadeja when the home team takes on the West Indies in the third and final ODI here on Saturday. India have dominated the series but rather than their performance, the talk has centered around the batting friendly nature of the pitches with the surface in the previous ODI producing more than 800 runs.

Among the critics of the conditions have been India head coach Gautam Gambhir, who wants to see an even contest between bat and ball.

With the series already in their pocket, India will look for their new-ball bowlers to finally make an early dent.

While the batters led by skipper Shubman Gill have enjoyed a dream run, the bowling attack has been left searching for answers, picking up just one wicket in the first 10 overs across the two

games and leaking 177 runs in the two powerplays.

India have struggled to get wickets in the middle overs with Kuldeep Yadav not getting much support from the other bowlers. An experienced campaigner like Jadeja is under scrutiny having picked up just three wickets in his last eight games.

At the other end of the spectrum, skipper Shubman Gill has been setting the tone with the bat. The right-hander is averaging 79.3 in home ODIs since 2024 and already has a century and a double century to his name in this series.

Gill's unbeaten 223 in India's record chase of 406 added another landmark to his growing list of ODI achievements, and the skipper will look to cap off the series on another high by completing a hat-trick of triple-digit scores. The batting has otherwise been in fine fettle, with Rohit Sharma providing the early impetus and Virat Kohli also getting a useful outing in the series. — PTI

Brazil come to Kolkata as India face reality check



Brazil's players during a training session in Kolkata on Friday. PTI

KOLKATA, OCTOBER 2

The biggest football night India has ever seen is finally here, with five-time world champions Brazil arriving in Kolkata to face a national side still searching for a place among Asia's established teams in an invitational

friendly at the Salt Lake Stadium here on Saturday.

Brazil, ranked fifth in the world, will meet India in their first-ever international meeting, bringing Real Madrid forward Vinicius Junior, Arsenal defender Gabriel Magalhaes, midfield star

Bruno Guimaraes and veteran Marquinhos. They have arrived in a city where the iconic Yellow jersey enjoys a massive following. For India, ranked 138th, the occasion is as much about testing how far they have come as it is about the spectacle. — PTI

Putin lauds Modi's Ukraine peace push, says he has 'very good ideas'

Consistently talks about ending conflict: Russian Prez after 2 meets with PM

UJWAL JALALI
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

Russian President Vladimir Putin has publicly credited Prime Minister Narendra Modi with repeatedly pressing for an end to the Ukraine conflict, saying the Indian leader has “very good ideas” aimed at finding a mutually acceptable solution.

Putin's remarks at the annual Valdai International Discussion Club meeting amounted to a public acknowledgement of Modi's continued engagement on the Ukraine conflict despite India's close ties with Moscow.

“As for Prime Minister Modi's position on ending wars, I can say that he is one of those world leaders who, despite our very good, even friendly relations, including at the personal level, constantly raises the issue and asks questions about ending the conflict in Ukraine,” Putin said.

“He has very good ideas aimed at finding mutually acceptable solutions,” the Russian President added. Putin said Modi regularly raises the issue during their meetings and remains closely engaged with efforts to end the conflict.



The two leaders met in Bishkek on August 31 on SCO sidelines and again in New Delhi on September 11 during the BRICS summit. FILE

Russian media reports quoted him as describing India's position as neutral but focused on ending the hostilities, while expressing gratitude for Modi's engagement.

The remarks come against the backdrop of two meetings between Modi and Putin in recent weeks. The two leaders met in Bishkek on August 31 on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit and again in New Delhi on September 11 dur-

ing the BRICS summit.

During their September meeting, Modi reiterated that dialogue and diplomacy were the way forward in resolving conflicts and said India was ready to assist in peace efforts.

Meanwhile, Home Minister Amit Shah welcomed Putin's remarks, saying the Russian President's appreciation of Modi's efforts towards global peace was a matter of “immense pride”

for every Indian.

In a post on X, Shah linked Putin's remarks to Mahatma Gandhi's birth anniversary, saying they underscored India's emergence as a “trusted voice for global peace” under Modi's leadership.

“During periods marked by wars, conflicts and turbulence, PM Modi has conveyed the message that solutions do not emerge from battlefields but through dialogue and diplomacy,” Shah said.

He also invoked the Indian philosophy of ‘Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam’, saying India had stepped forward with help and assistance during wars and calamities and that the country's voice now mattered whenever the world faced a global crisis.

Shah said Modi's words were being listened to with “keen attention” internationally.

Putin's remarks come as the Ukraine war continues to occupy a central place in international diplomacy, with India maintaining that dialogue and diplomacy are essential to resolving conflicts.

India has consistently expressed readiness to support peace efforts while maintaining strategic ties with both Russia and other major powers.

TN CM rolls out expanded free bus travel for women

CHENNAI, OCTOBER 2

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Friday launched the expanded ‘Vetri Payanam’ — free bus travel for women — coinciding with Gandhi Jayanti, issuing zero-fare tickets to women passengers at Koyambedu Bus Terminus here.

The scheme, originally announced by the CM under Rule 110 in the Assembly on August 24, aims to ensure that women across Tamil Nadu are not deprived of social and economic opportunities due to transport costs.

Under the expanded initiative, the free travel facility —

previously restricted to ordinary city and town buses and up to 40 km in hilly regions — has now been extended to cover Express, Limited Stop Services (LSS), Deluxe, Suburban Ordinary (Mofussil Ordinary) and Ghat Ordinary services running over 40 km operated by the state's seven state transport corporations.

With this expansion, a total of 12,695 buses will operate 1,68,500 single trips daily under the scheme, benefiting an estimated 84.32 lakh women passengers across the state every day. The CM interacted with passengers and distributed free bus tickets among them. — PTI



Tamil Nadu CM Vijay issues a free bus ticket to a woman in Chennai. PTI



Orange alert issued as Bihar rivers stay above danger mark

PATNA/MUZAFFARPUR, OCTOBER 2

As floodwaters from the swollen Gandak river entered new areas of Bihar's Saran district following embankment breaches on Friday, the CWC issued an ‘orange’ bulletin signalling a severe flood situation at 28 locations across several districts amid rising water levels in other rivers.

The Central Water Commission (CWC) issues the orange bulletin when the water level rises above the danger mark, but remains below the highest flood level.

“The Ganga continued to flow above the danger mark at several locations, including Danapur, Gandhi Ghat, Hath-

dah, Dighaghat, Bankaghat, Mahnar, Kalyanpur, Kahalgaoon and Sultanganj,” according to the bulletin.

At Danapur, the river was at 51.44 m, 0.24 m above the danger level, while Gandhi Ghat recorded 49.69 m, 1.09 m above the danger mark in Patna, it said. In Saran district, floodwater passed through damaged embankments in Panapur and Maker blocks and entered new areas, including Karchaulia, Amnour, Jagdishpur, Maker and Parsa. The Gandak remained above the danger mark at Dumariaghat, Lalganj and Rewaghat, though levels were falling at all three locations. — PTI

SC plea challenges mandate to sing six-stanza Vande Mataram

SATYA PRAKASH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

A Buddhist activist has moved the Supreme Court against the mandatory singing of the full version of Vande Mataram at formal state events.

Contending that replacing the standalone two-stanza version with the six-stanza text from Ananda Math converted India from a “secular republic” into a “theocracy”, petitioner BD Borkar has challenged two circulars issued by the Ministry of Home Affairs in this regard.

Borkar, a Nagpur-based Buddhist activist, submitted that the MHA orders dated January 28, 2026, and July 9, 2026, wrongfully replaced the 79-year-old practice of singing a standalone, non-theistic two-stanza poem.

“Under the guise of providing directions on the playing and singing of an ‘official version’... the impugned orders repealed the existing national song... and imposed a new national song which is the six-stanza civil war song of Ananda Math with its

SECULAR SHIFT
“Replacing the standalone two-stanza version with the six-stanza text from Ananda Math converted India from a ‘secular republic’ into a ‘theocracy’.” BD Borkar, PETITIONER



unconstitutional idolatrous and Islamophobic content,” Borkar submitted.

Forcing citizens to sing the full six-stanza text damages national fraternity and deepens communal divisions, the petitioner contended.

“By imposing sectarian prayer to particular goddesses of one particular religion as the national song of India, the impugned orders convert the character of the polity of India from a ‘secular republic’ to a ‘theocracy,’” he submitted.

Maintaining that a “conscientious objector” should not be punished for refusing to

sing Vande Mataram, the Supreme Court had on September 22 asked the Centre to respond to Carnatic vocalist TM Krishna's petition challenging the law mandating singing of six stanzas of the national song.

A Bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Justice Joyimalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana said the government should keep in mind the 1986 judgment in the Bijoe Emmanuel case protecting children following Jehovah's Witnesses religious practices who said ‘no’ to singing the National Anthem on grounds of conscience.

“Mr Solicitor, we are not inclined to issue notice. But, we would expect that the law of the land, as declared by this court in Bijoe Emmanuel, will govern the Act. What the national song is not in dispute. The declaration of law in Bijoe Emmanuel is not yet questioned. It is for the democratic state to decide what is the national song, whether two stanza or four stanza,” Justice Bagchi had told Solicitor General Tushar Mehta.

Modi, Rahul, Kharge pay tributes to Mahatma, Shastri

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Vice-President CP Radhakrishnan, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi on Friday paid homage to Mahatma Gandhi at Rajghat on his 157th birth anniversary, while also paying tribute to former Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri at Vijay Ghat on his birth anniversary.

Modi and Radhakrishnan joined an interfaith prayer meeting and other commemorative programmes in the national capital, as leaders across the political spectrum recalled the contributions of Gandhi and Shastri to the freedom struggle and nation-building.

The PM said the lives of Gandhi and Shastri, marked by simplicity, courage and service to the nation, would continue to inspire generations. At Rajghat, the PM attended the Sarva Dharma Prarthana, where prayers representing different faiths were offered in remembrance of Gandhi and his message of truth, non-violence and peace.



(From left) PM Narendra Modi, LS Speaker Om Birla and Congress leaders Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi during a ceremony to pay tributes to Mahatma Gandhi in New Delhi on Friday. PTI

He also urged citizens to embrace ‘Swadeshi’ by purchasing at least one Khadi product on October 2 to honour Mahatma Gandhi's legacy on Gandhi Jayanti.

Radhakrishnan also paid homage to former Tamil Nadu Chief Minister K Kamaraj.

In his message on Gandhi Jayanti, the Vice-President recalled Gandhi's faith in truth and non-violence, commitment to justice and belief in human dignity, and called

for reaffirming these values to build a harmonious and inclusive society.

Kharge said Gandhi had led the country's struggle for freedom through a simple life and a message that brought millions of people into the national movement. He said Shastri, meanwhile, had given the country a clear sense of purpose through his call of ‘Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan’ and had led the nation through a difficult period.

Rahul, in a post on X, paid tribute to Shastri and recalled his contribution to the country.

Recalling Shastri's famous slogan, Rahul said the former PM had used ‘Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan’ to underline the importance of both the country's soldiers and farmers and to emphasise their dignity and rights.

Rahul said Shastri's simplicity and commitment to the nation would continue to guide generations.

2.55 lakh gram panchayats hold special sabhas

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

More than 2.55 lakh gram panchayats held special gram sabhas on Gandhi Jayanti to deliberate on transformative governance reforms and initiatives aimed at strengthening local self-governance, improving public services and enhancing the quality of life in rural India.

“These meetings were also used to launch the 2026-27 People's Plan Campaign and initiate the participatory preparation of Gram Panchayat Development Plans for 2027-28,” an official from the Ministry of Panchayati Raj said.

The People's Plan Campaign will enable panchayats to prepare holistic, inclusive and participatory development plans, which will be uploaded on the e-Gram Swaraj portal. Grassroots leaders will discuss government schemes, local development gaps, new criminal laws, digital transformation, cooperatives, the protection of women and children, the Bal Vivah Mukht Bharat and Nasha Mukht Bharat initiatives, and the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026. — TNS

Petroleum offences may attract tougher penalties

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

The government has proposed decriminalising regulatory breaches such as violations of petroleum licence terms and introducing a civil-penalty regime, while retaining or strengthening criminal penalties for serious offences involving public safety, critical infrastructure and unauthorised petroleum operations.

The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas has sought public and industry comments on draft amendments to the Petroleum Act, 1934, proposing a major overhaul of the law's provisions dealing with offences, penalties and enforcement.

The Petroleum Act, 1934,

was enacted to consolidate and amend the law relating to the import, transport, storage, production, refining and blending of petroleum.

“It is proposed to amend the Petroleum Act, 1934, through amendment... to achieve the objectives of de-criminalisation of regulatory issues such as breach of terms and conditions of licences and provides for a mechanism for imposition of civil penalty through an administrative mechanism,” the ministry said, seeking comments on the draft amendments.

The proposed amendments “provide adequate deterrence against specific offences relating to various aspects of petroleum operations”, it added. — PTI

Pb's heritage, bhangra & Diljit feature in PM mementos' e-auction

SURYA S PILLAI
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

Punjab's religious heritage, Sikh history, folk traditions and contemporary popular culture have found a place in the latest collection of Prime Minister's mementos being offered for e-auction, with miniature representations of the Golden Temple, a Bhangra painting and a photo print of singer Diljit Dosanjh's Dil-Luminati Tour among the featured items.

The Ministry of Culture said the Punjab-themed collection brings together “faith, history, music, dance and living traditions”, presenting a mix of traditional heritage and contemporary cultural expression.

Among the prominent pieces are two representations of Sri Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple). One is a detailed miniature model of the shrine, while another places the iconic structure inside a glass dome, creating what the ministry describes as a distinctive floating effect. The collection also

Eighth edition showcases 1,498 gifts & artefacts presented to Modi on different occasions



includes a silver-framed portrait of Guru Nanak Dev, presented by the Gurdwara Managing Committee, Gurubagh, and Varanasi. Sikh history is represented

through an artwork depicting Mata Gujri Ji with the young Sahibzadas, Zorawar Singh and Fateh Singh.

“Moving beyond religious and historical themes, the

collection features a painting of Bhangra, capturing Punjab's traditional folk dance, while a photoprint of Diljit's Dil-Luminati Tour brings contemporary Punjabi music

and its international reach into the auction collection,” the ministry said.

The Punjab-linked items also include saffron gurdwara headscarves with gold-

en threadwork, symbolising humility and reverence in Sikh places of worship.

The ministry said the collection reflects how Punjab's cultural identity spans sacred spaces and spiritual traditions, folk culture and contemporary music.

The items are part of the eighth edition of the PM mementos e-auction, which features 1,498 mementos presented to Prime Minister Narendra Modi on different occasions. The auction began on September 17 and is being conducted through the official PM Mementos portal till October 31.

The wider collection includes artefacts representing India's artistic traditions, traditional craftsmanship, cultural practices, spiritual traditions and sporting achievements.

The proceeds from the auction will support the Namami Gange Mission, the government's programme for conservation, rejuvenation and protection of the Ganga and its ecosystem.

FORECAST

CLEAR SKY

TEMPERATURE

DELHI

MAX: 35°C MIN: 23°C

GURUGRAM

MAX: 35°C MIN: 23°C

FARIDABAD

MAX: 35°C MIN: 24°C

NOIDA

MAX: 35°C MIN: 25°C

SUNSET

SATURDAY 6:06 PM

SUNRISE

SUNDAY 6:14 AM



SAFETY AUDIT FINDS 190 HIGH-RISK PARKS IN CITY

The Delhi Development Authority has completed a safety audit of all 736 parks under its jurisdiction. **P3»**



5 HELD FOR BID TO KIDNAP YOUTH OVER PROPERTY DISPUTE

Gurugram police have arrested five men for attempting to kidnap a youth at gunpoint over property dispute. **P3»**



A VERY SPECIAL MOMENT IN MY JOURNEY: ANIL KAPOOR

Actor's *Subedaar* has won Best Feature Film for India at the Asian Academy Creative Awards. **P4»**



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GREATER NOIDA	130
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401-500	SEVERE
301-400	VERY POOR
201-300	POOR
101-200	MODERATE
51-100	SATISFACTORY
0-50	GOOD

Ganja worth ₹1.55 cr seized at airport, 1 held

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Customs officials at the Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport here have foiled an alleged smuggling attempt and seized 4.43 kg of suspected ganja worth around Rs 1.55 crore from an Indian passenger arriving from Hanoi, Vietnam. According to the Customs Department, the passenger arrived at Terminal 3 on September 29. Based on profiling, Customs officers intercepted the passenger and diverted him to the Green Channel for examination. During the examination of his travel bag, officers found four polythene pouches containing suspected ganja. The passenger was arrested. — TNS

HELPLINE
Emergency response: 112
Women Helpline: 1091
Special cell (Northeast): 1093
Missing person: 1094
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WHAT'S ON
DELHI
Talk: 4th Annual Shamsur Rahman Faruqi Memorial Lecture: India Habitat Centre: 7 pm

A first: PUC centres to come up at interstate bus terminals in Delhi

MANIKANT MISHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Delhi is set to get pollution testing centres at interstate bus terminals for the first time as the government prepares to expand facilities for vehicle Pollution Under Control (PUC) checks. The government is planning five multi-lane PUC centres under a pilot project at Anand Vihar and Sarai Kale Khan interstate bus terminals, along with Burari, Chhattarpur and Dwarka. The centres will allow several vehicles to be tested at the

CONTINUED ON PAGE 3

Over 1K detained as protesters demand CEC's exit

MANIKANT MISHRA & RAHUL GAHLAWAT
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 More than 1,000 people were detained across Delhi on Friday as the police moved to prevent a planned protest at Jantar Mantar against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar. The action came amid prohibitory orders, Metro station closures, Internet shutdown in parts of central Delhi and heavy deployment of police and security forces.

The protest was called by several student, youth and civil society groups on Gandhi Jayanti. Protesters were seeking the removal of CEC Kumar and raising allegations of 'vote chori'. Among those detained were AAP leaders Atishi, Saurabh Bhardwaj and Sanjay Singh, RJD MP Manoj Jha, CPI leaders MA Baby and Brinda Karat, MPs AA Rahim and P Sandosh Kumar, CPI(ML)'s N Sai Balaji as well as student leaders and activists. Around 4.15 pm, two senior RAF officers present near Kerala House told *The Tribune* that more than 1,000 people had been detained in more than 33 buses across Delhi. Several detainees were taken to locations far from

Jantar Mantar remains out of bounds, 11 Metro stations shut



LEFT STUDENT GROUPS TO PROTEST TODAY

Left student organisations have announced that they will return to Jantar Mantar at 1 pm on Saturday to hold a protest demanding the CEC's resignation. They have appealed to people to join the demonstration as Jantar Mantar 2.0 continues.

<< Policemen detain a protester in New Delhi on Friday.

MUKESH AGGARWAL

COPS QUESTION CONTENT CREATORS, INDEPENDENT JOURNALISTS

- Digital content creators and people recording news for independent platforms were among those detained during the SIR protest in central Delhi, with police officers seen questioning whether those covering the events were accredited journalists.
- Near Tolstoy Marg, a Delhi Police official was heard instructing junior personnel: "Those who have one single phone in hand, throw them in the bus. They are no journalist." Following the instruction, police personnel began detaining

people who were carrying phones and appeared to be recording the developments.

- A similar scene was reported near Ashoka Road, where several independent content creators were detained. Among those detained were Rajeev Talwar and Harsh Yadav, who have a substantial following on Instagram.
- At the spot, police personnel were seen asking people about their media credentials. They were also heard instructing personnel to consider only those with a Press Information Bureau (PIB) card as journalists.

blies of five or more people, processions, demonstrations, picketing and dharmas without prior written permission. Shouting slogans and making speeches were also prohibited. The official order also restricted the carrying of firearms, banners, placards, lathis, swords, sticks, brickbats and similar articles without permission. The police said violations would invite legal action under Section 223 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, and other applicable provisions. Security arrangements were tightened around Jantar Mantar, with around 4,000 police and security personnel deployed in the area, according to officials. Drones were used to monitor the situation. The two main approaches to Jantar Mantar, from Sansad Marg and the Kerala House side, were blocked with barricades, buses and police vehicles. The restrictions extended to public transport. The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation announced the closure of entry and exit gates at stations in the New Delhi area, including Janpath, Patel Chowk, Rajiv Chowk, Mandi House and Central Secretariat. The information provided by the authorities referred to

CONTINUED ON PAGE 3

AAP leaders face police action as stir intensifies

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Prominent AAP leaders, including former Delhi chief minister Atishi, Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh, party's Delhi unit chief Saurabh Bharadwaj, MLA Jarnail Singh and national media in-charge Anurag Dhanda, were among those detained as police action intensified around the protest site demanding Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

The action began around 11 am when Bharadwaj was first detained by the police while he was on his way towards Jantar Mantar along with party workers. Later in the day, when MP Sanjay Singh left for Parliament along with some supporters, the police stopped him, he alleged. Singh said an MP was not being allowed to enter Parliament. "When the police stopped me in front of Rashtrapati Bhavan, I started the protest right here. PM Narendra Modi has deployed his entire police machinery to protect vote thief Gyanesh. People will

Fight against 'vote chori' to continue, says Atishi



AAP leader Atishi

drive the vote thieves out of power," he said. He said, "Today, on the birth anniversary of the Father of the Nation, Mahatma Gandhi, I am present under Babu's statue in the Parliament complex. To reach this very Parliament, PM Narendra Modi, in collusion with Gyanesh Kumar, has carried out large-scale vote theft and deleted the names of 13.37 crore people from the electoral rolls across the country." Meanwhile, Bharadwaj stated, "Holding a protest is our constitutional right. The police and the government are saying that permission for the protest was not granted,

CONTINUED ON PAGE 3

No Internet, no UPI: CP traders return to cash

MANIKANT MISHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Connaught Place was left struggling with digital payments on Friday after an Internet shutdown in the area disrupted UPI services, forcing street vendors and businesses to fall back on cash. *The Tribune* spoke to street vendors and staff at cafes in the Connaught Place inner circle, who said cash was the only reliable payment option during the disruption. Staff at Chilli's said payments were being accepted only in cash, leaving customers without cash

unable to make purchases. At Mocha Cafe and Bar, which has broadband Wi-Fi, the disruption created a different kind of rush. Visitors were turning up at the cafe not only to eat but also to access the Internet, send urgent messages and book rides. Divyasri and Katyani, two visitors from Kerala, were among those struggling with the outage. Carrying luggage and moving around Connaught Place, the two said they had been going from one cafe to another asking whether Wi-Fi was available and whether the Internet was working.

Student, youth organisations take to streets

HARSH YADAV
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 A large mobilisation of student and youth organisations at Jantar Mantar on Friday demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar was met with a heavy police presence, with around 1,000 protesters detained as they attempted to reach the protest site. The protest, held on Gandhi Jayanti, saw participation from the Students' Federation of India (SFI), All-India Students' Association (AISA), National Students' Union of India (NSUI), Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI) and other stu-



Security personnel deployed outside the Patel Chowk Metro station in New Delhi. TRIBUNE PHOTO: MUKESH AGGARWAL

dent and youth groups. The organisations raised concerns over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and its alleged impact on

citizens voting rights. The SFI, in a statement, claimed that more than 1,000 activists were detained and taken to police stations

across Delhi. Several of its national-level leaders, including SFI president Adarsh M Saji, general secretary Srijan Bhattacharyya, Aishe Ghosh and S Shilpa, along with DYFI leaders Himagnharaj Bhattacharyya, AA Rahim and Sanjeev Kumar, were among those detained. CPI(M) leaders MA Baby and Brinda Karat were also detained. AISA activists participating in the protest were also detained by the police. The organisation alleged that its members were stopped while attempting to join the mobilisation at Jantar Mantar and taken into custody.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 3

Delhi BJP targets AAP over protest

ANSHITA MEHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 The Delhi BJP on Thursday criticised the Aam Aadmi Party's participation in protests against the Election Commission and the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of

Alleges attempt to divert attention from Punjab

electoral rolls, alleging that the exercise was aimed at diverting attention from issues concerning the party's government in Punjab.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 3

After 9-yr wait, Barapullah-III fails to ease traffic woes

MANIKANT MISHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Nine years after its original completion deadline, Barapullah, Phase III, has opened with a basic traffic-engineering problem: the new elevated corridor can carry traffic faster, but the road network at its receiving end does not appear to have the capacity to absorb the additional flow smoothly. The problem is most visible at the Suryaghadi cloverleaf, where traffic from the newly opened Phase III merges into

the existing Barapullah network. Three lanes coming from Mayur Vihar are added to traffic already moving towards AIIMS from Sarai Kale Khan. At the same time, the surrounding network is carrying traffic from Ashram, Lajpat Nagar, DND and the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway. The result is a concentration of several traffic streams at a limited number of merging and weaving points. This is significant because an elevated corridor does not work independently. Its

Queues persist despite opening of second lane



Vehicles stuck in traffic on the Barapullah Phase-III flyover. FILE

effective capacity is determined not only by the width of the carriageway but also by the capacity of the junctions,

ramps, merges and downstream roads connected to it. In the case of Barapullah, Phase III, the early traffic pattern suggests that the additional road capacity is running into constraints at these connections. The first signs appeared almost immediately after the opening. Traffic travelling from Mayur Vihar towards Sarai Kale Khan faced a queue of nearly 3 km along a corridor of about 3.5 km. Opening the second lane did

CONTINUED ON PAGE 3

Delhi cops seek NBWs against Shahbaz, Ansari in UAPA case

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 The Delhi Police moved the Rouse Avenue Court seeking issuance of non-bailable warrants (NBWs) against Shahbaz Ansari and Rehan Ansari in a case registered under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), involving alleged illegal arms supply and extortion. The application was placed before the Special National Investigation Agency (NIA) court, which directed that it be tagged with the main case file and placed before the Principal District and Sessions Judge (PDSJ), Rouse Avenue Court, on October 5 for consideration and transfer to a court of competent jurisdiction. "Let this application be also tagged along with the said main case and be sent to the court of Learned Principal District & Sessions Judge, Rouse Avenue Court for October 5, 2026," the court said in its order. The development comes in a case in which Delhi Police had arrested Deepak Nanda, also known as Deepak Kha-

tri, and Rishabh Kapoor. Khatri had claimed to be the legal representative of jailed gangster Lawrence Bishnoi. A separate case was subsequently registered by the Uttar Pradesh Police after allegations that Khatri's law degree was forged, following a complaint by a university. Special NIA Judge Anu Grover Baliga extended the judicial custody of Khatri and Kapoor till October 29. The judge, however, recused herself from further hearings in the matter citing personal reasons and directed that the main case file be placed before the PDSJ. Since then, PDSJ Dinesh Bhatt has been elevated to the Delhi High Court, while Judge Baliga is currently officiating as PDSJ. Earlier, on September 5, the Rouse Avenue Court had remanded Khatri and Kapoor to judicial custody after police interrogation. The court noted that the investigation was still underway and that oral testimonies and electronic data collected during the probe indicated the alleged involvement of the accused.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 3

July protest reached Parl, SIR stir stopped before Jantar Mantar



Security personnel patrol Ashok Road in New Delhi on Friday. TRIBUNE PHOTO: MUKESH AGGARWAL

MANIKANT MISHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 The difference between the July 20 protest by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and Friday's SIR demonstration in Delhi was evident in how far the two groups managed to move through the Capital. The CJP protest in July began at Jantar Mantar but later moved towards Parliament. Protesters crossed police barricades at Tolstoy

Marg and Sansad Marg and reached the area around Ashoka Road, bringing the demonstration close to Parliament before security forces stopped the march. However, the SIR protest on Friday did not get as far as Jantar Mantar. The protest had been called at the designated protest site against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and over the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. But multiple

layers of barricades and heavy police deployment prevented protesters from reaching the site. Many protesters said, "The police learnt their lessons well this time." The police had imposed restrictions under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita in New Delhi district. They also closed entry and exit gates at Metro stations around the protest area and regulated traffic on roads leading towards Jantar Mantar. Around

4,000 police, CAPF and RAF personnel were deployed around the protest site, according to officials. Protesters nevertheless attempted to approach Jantar Mantar from different directions. Student groups and political workers were stopped at locations, including Ashoka Road and Tolstoy Marg. The July protest had therefore moved from Jantar Mantar towards Parliament, with

CONTINUED ON PAGE 3

Leaders pay tributes to Bapu, Shastri on birth anniversaries

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta and Delhi Congress president Devendra Yadav on Friday paid tributes to Mahatma Gandhi and former Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri on their birth anniversaries, recalling their contributions to the freedom movement, public life and nation-building.

Gupta, along with Deputy Speaker Mohan Singh Bisht, MLAs and senior officials of the Assembly Secretariat, paid floral tributes to Gandhi on his 157th birth anniversary and Shastri on his 122nd birth anniversary at the Delhi Assembly.

Gupta said Gandhi demonstrated how moral courage could become an instrument of collective action, while Shastri represented simplicity, integrity and a strong sense of public duty. He said their legacies remained relevant to India's democratic and institutional life.

"The strength of democracy is ultimately measured by the seriousness with which institutions discharge the responsibilities entrusted to them and by the confidence they inspire



CM Rekha Gupta pays tributes to Mahatma Gandhi on his 157th birth anniversary at Rajghat.

among citizens," Gupta said.

He also recalled Shastri's slogan "Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan", saying it reflected the contribution of soldiers and farmers to the nation.

Separately, the Delhi Pradesh Congress Committee organised a tribute programme to mark the birth anniversaries of Gandhi and Shastri and the death anniversary of former

Delhi Pradesh Congress president Tajdar Babar.

Yadav said Gandhi's principles of truth, non-violence and Satyagraha remained relevant to social harmony and democratic values. He described Shastri's "Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan" slogan as a lasting recognition of the contribution of farmers and soldiers.

Yadav also recalled Babar's

contribution to the Congress organisation in Delhi, saying she worked to increase women's participation in politics and raised issues concerning weaker and marginalised sections.

He said the lives and ideals of Gandhi and Shastri should be reflected in public conduct rather than being limited to commemorative occasions.

Their ideals still guide public life, says Speaker

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Delhi Legislative Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta on Thursday paid floral tributes to Mahatma Gandhi and former Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri on their birth anniversaries, saying their lives continue to underscore the importance of integrity, simplicity and public service.

"Mahatma Gandhi showed that moral courage could move a nation, while Bharat Ratna Lal Bahadur Shastri demonstrated that simplicity, integrity and an unwavering sense of duty could define the highest standards of leadership. Their lives continue to remind us that the strength of public life ultimately rests on character, conviction and service to the nation," Gupta said.

The Speaker said the occasion reflected two distinct yet interconnected traditions of nation-building. He noted that Gandhi placed truth, non-violence and ethical action at the heart of the freedom movement, while Shastri came to symbolise discipline, humility and resolute leadership during a challenging period in the country's history.

Dubai caller, Haryanvi voice, ₹1-cr demand: Cops foil extortion plot

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 A Rs 1-crore extortion demand from a Dubai number, a caller allegedly told to speak in Haryanvi to make the threat appear local and shooters staying in a rented accommodation in Delhi have led the Delhi Police to an alleged India-Dubai extortion network operating in the name of gangster Goldy Brar, officials said on Friday.

The Special Task Force (STF) of North district arrested three alleged key operatives, including the suspected main conspirator and one of the shooters, and foiled a plan to fire at the residence of a Roop Nagar businessman, the police said.

The case surfaced on September 16 when businessman Praveen Jain received three missed calls around 8.15 pm. Around 9.27 pm, his son Ayush received a call from a UAE-based number. The caller allegedly claimed to be an associate of Goldy Brar and demanded Rs 1 crore, threatening the family with serious consequences if the money was not paid. A case was registered at the Roop Nagar police station on September 17.

The probe soon acquired an international trail. Technical analysis showed the use of virtual private server infrastructure, with one identified IP



The accused in custody of the Delhi Police.

address linked to OVH SAS in France, while digital accounts examined by the police pointed towards the UAE.

Investigators, after questioning persons in Dehradun and Karnal and analysing the communication trail, allegedly identified Dubai-based Aarish as the person who made the threatening call. The police said Aarish, alias "Pista" (32), an alleged Indian operative, had offered Aarish a hefty payment for making the call and instructed him to speak in Haryanvi so that the threat sounded as if it had come from a local criminal.

Aarif was arrested from Vejalpur in Ahmedabad on September 24 with the assistance of the Gujarat Police. His interrogation allegedly provided further leads about the network and the role of Mubarik, alias Gullu, whom the police described as

the main conspirator.

The investigation took another turn when a second Delhi businessman was allegedly targeted using the same UAE number. On September 19, the younger brother of Rohini-based construction businessman Manoj Malik received two WhatsApp calls from the number and a 37-second audio message. The caller allegedly introduced himself as Vikrant from Mahendergarh, claimed links with the Goldy Brar gang and demanded Rs 1 crore within 48 hours, threatening firing.

The police said the investigation into the Roop Nagar case had by then uncovered an alleged plan to fire several rounds at the complainant's residence and then renew the extortion demand. The plan was allegedly prepared about two days before its intended execution.

Focus on segregation of waste at MCD meeting

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Councillors on Friday discussed measures to strengthen solid waste management in Delhi, including four-way segregation at source, registration and compliance of bulk waste generators, recycling and the safety and welfare of sanitation workers at a special meeting of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD).

The meeting, chaired by Deputy Mayor Monika Pant, focused on the provisions of the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026 and ways to improve their implementation at the ward level.

The Chief Engineer briefed councillors on the rules and stressed the need for segregation of waste at source, scientific collection and management, recycling and reuse of resources.

He also explained the requirement for four-way segregation, under which waste generated by households, insti-

tutions, markets and other establishments is to be kept separately according to prescribed categories.

The official also underlined the need for public awareness and behaviour-change campaigns to improve compliance with waste segregation norms.

Pant said effective waste management required coordination between awareness, implementation and citizen participation. She said elected representatives could help spread awareness in their respective wards by working with residents' welfare associations, market associations, institutions and other stakeholders.

She also called for ward-level awareness campaigns, demonstration drives and citizen interaction programmes to encourage source segregation, saying proper segregation could make collection, transportation, processing and recycling more efficient.

Councillors raised local waste management issues from their respective wards and suggested measures to improve segregation, conduct regular awareness campaigns, strengthen the registration and compliance mechanism for bulk waste generators and improve waste collection.

Issues concerning the safety and welfare of sanitation workers were also discussed.

Cops bust fuel-card cyber fraud racket, three nabbed

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 The Cyber Police Station of Delhi's South-East district has busted an alleged interstate cyber-fraud network in which proceeds from APK-based banking fraud were allegedly routed through fraudulently obtained HPCL fuel cards. Three persons have been arrested, while police are probing a financial trail estimated at around Rs 10 crore.

The accused have been identified as Nasir Hussain (34), Sokeen (27) and Ashish Arya (33). Police suspect Hussain to be the kingpin of the network.

The case came to light after South Delhi resident Jitender Kumar Gupta received a WhatsApp message on May 7 containing an APK file purportedly meant to update his courier delivery address. After opening the file, he entered his HDFC net-banking credentials while making a nominal payment of Rs 2. Two unauthorised transactions of Rs 1,99,009.44 and Rs 1,98,009.44 were subsequently made from his account, causing a loss of Rs 3,97,018.88.

An e-FIR was registered at the Cyber Police Station in South-East district under relevant provisions of the BNS, following which an investigation was launched.

According to police, analysis of the money trail revealed that Rs 3.97 lakh of the defrauded amount had been used to recharge an HPCL Drive Track Plus fuel-card customer ID

linked to two trucks. Investigators found transactions worth around Rs 15 lakh through the associated fuel cards.

The police examined telecom records, SIM issuance details, point-of-sale information and fuel-card enrolment records. Video KYC details of one of the cards allegedly led investigators to Sokeen. Following searches in Nuh, Nagina, Pahadi and Bharatpur, Hussain was traced to Dheeriyawas village in Tapukada, Rajasthan. Both were arrested on September 28.

Further investigation led to the arrest of Arya, a former Retail Business Executive with Tristar Management Services Ltd. Police alleged that he enrolled a fuel card without physically verifying the documents submitted and conducted Sokeen's online video KYC without matching his photograph with those on the documents.

The police have identified more than 100 suspected fuel cards so far. Interrogation suggests the accused may have arranged 150-200 such cards, each carrying a limit of Rs 7.5 lakh. Investigators allege the accused procured truck registration certificates and Aadhaar and PAN details from truck owners through the BlackBuck transport platform on the pretext of arranging bookings. The documents were allegedly altered using AI-assisted tools, while fraudulently obtained SIM cards were used for fuel-card enrolment and video KYC.

MANIKANT MISHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 The Delhi Government has moved ahead with its plan to establish mini secretariats across the Capital, with land identified for the proposed facilities in 12 of the city's 13 districts. Old Delhi is the only district where a site is yet to be finalised.

The initiative aims to bring services offered by multiple government departments under one roof, reducing the need for residents to visit different offices for related work. Announced in August last year, the project envisages district-level mini secretariats housing offices of sev-

eral departments within a single complex.

Progress has also been made on the proposed mini secretariat at Dwarka Sector 10 in South-West Delhi. The facility, estimated to cost around Rs 212 crore, is expected to accommodate offices of the Revenue Department, Delhi Jal Board, electricity department and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi's Deputy Commissioner.

The identified sites have been grouped into three categories based on land ownership and availability.

Under the first category, existing government premises will be utilised. These include the Dwarka Sector 10

site in South-West Delhi, the SDM office complex at Chhatarpur in South Delhi, and the DC office complex at Nand Nagri in North-East Delhi.

The second category comprises locations where land will need to be purchased or leased. These include MTNL exchange land in Rohini Sector 3 for North-West Delhi and MTNL land in Shadipur for Central Delhi. For East Delhi, land in the Karkardooma Institutional Area has been proposed to be acquired from the MCD on a 50-year lease.

The third category includes land owned by other government agencies. Sites identified under this category

include the former Gargi College campus of the Education Department in Lajpat Nagar-IV for South-East Delhi, DDA land in Rohini Sector 34 near UER-II for Outer North Delhi, and DDA land at PS Road, Shalimar Bagh, Haiderpur for North Central Delhi.

For New Delhi district, land has been identified at 12 Jamnagar House on Shahjahan Road, which belongs to the Land & Development Office (L&DO). In West Delhi, land belonging to the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board has been earmarked in Raja Garden, while L&DO land in Civil Lines has been identified for North Delhi.

277.56 acres to be declared reserved forest

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 The government has approved the Phase-I notification to declare 277.56 acres of land in the Northern Ridge as reserved forest under Section 20 of the Indian Forest Act, 1927, in a move aimed at strengthening legal protection for the city's green and ecological zones. CM Rekha Gupta said the Northern Ridge, part of the Aravalli range, was an "invaluable" component of Delhi's natural heritage and its protection was crucial for the city's environmental health and future generations. — TNS

CM orders action on civic issues at Azadpur

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday participated in a cleanliness drive in Azadpur under the 'Seva Mera Yogdan' campaign on Gandhi Jayanti and reviewed civic infrastructure in the area, directing officials to address issues related to garbage disposal, encroachments, drainage and damaged public amenities.

During the inspection, Gupta assessed the condition of the central verge, footpaths, roadside walls, drainage network and other public spaces. She sought details from officials regarding garbage accumulation, encroachment of footpaths by fruit vendors

and unauthorised advertisements on walls.

The Chief Minister directed officials to ensure regular cleaning of the central verge and adjoining areas. She also called for the beautification of the underpass and long stretches of walls through murals and wall paintings.

Interacting with fruit vendors occupying parts of the footpath, Gupta said a solution would be worked out that balanced their livelihood needs with the requirement to keep footpaths accessible for pedestrians and maintain cleanliness.

She also appealed to fruit vendors and workers at Azadpur Mandi to ensure that

waste generated during business activities was not dumped on roads or allowed to enter drains, which could disrupt the drainage system.

The Chief Minister further instructed officials to expedite work on the proposed Atal Chowk in the area. According to the Delhi Government, a statue of former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee is scheduled to be installed there in December, following which the junction will be named Atal Chowk.

Gupta said the chowk and connecting road should be kept clean and developed as an attractive public space, with adequate greenery and civic amenities. — TNS

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Rajni Joshi D/o Late Sh. Brij Bhushan Sharma (W/o Ramesh Chander Joshi) R/o H.No. A-173, Sector-15, Gautam Budha Nagar, Noida, U.P. 201301, hereby declare that my Father Late Sh. Brij Bhushan Sharma S/o Late Sh. Chandan Lal had expired on 08.08.2007 and my mother Late Smt. Shanta Sharma W/o Late Sh. Brij Bhushan Sharma had expired on 27.08.2007, and they have left behind their following legal heirs:- 1. Rajni Joshi (Daughter) 2. Updesh Sharma (Son) 3. Praveen Sharma (Daughter) 4. Pankaj Sharma (Son) 5. Indu Malhotra (Daughter) 6. Poonam Kuman (Daughter) There are no other legal heirs of the deceased except the above mentioned. If anyone having any objection regarding this, he/she can raise objection within 30 days from the date of the publication in the office of Telsidar, Gungram, Haryana.

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The Tribune

Voice of the People

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L-G leads heritage walk, launches Delhi Ridge e-book

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Friday led a heritage walk at Sanjay Van, highlighting the capital's natural and built heritage and underscoring the need to make its historical legacy more accessible to the public.

The walk, organised by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) in collaboration with the INTACH Delhi Chapter, was attended by around 200 heritage and nature enthusiasts. South Delhi MP Ramvir Singh Bidhuri, Mehrauli MLA Gajender Yadav and DDA Vice-

INTERACTIVE TRAILS AND DIGITAL MAPS FOR EXPLORERS

- The e-book features eight heritage trails, QR-enabled interpretation tools, digital maps, photographs and researched narratives on monuments spread across the four Ridge zones. An "Inventory of Built Heritage Sites - Ridges of Delhi" has also been prepared, documenting 243 geo-coordinated heritage structures.
- The QR-enabled content will be linked to on-site signages and digital maps, enabling visitors to access information about heritage structures while exploring the designated trails.

Chairman N. Saravana Kumar were also present.

The trail took participants through the Small Fortification, Large Fortification and the historic Lalkot Wall within Sanjay Van. Swapna Liddle, Adviser to the INTACH Delhi Chapter, guided the walk and shared insights into the history, architecture and significance of the conserved

structures.

During the event, Sandhu launched the e-book, "Exploring the Delhi Ridge: Reviving the Heritage of the Lungs of Delhi", prepared jointly by the DDA and the INTACH Delhi Chapter. The digital publication brings together heritage sites located across the Northern, Central,

DDA said the initiative combines documentation and digital technology to make Delhi's heritage more accessible and engaging.

The initiative follows the DDA's recently concluded week-long Heritage Week, which featured activities focused on art, culture and heritage awareness, particularly among young people.

The authority said the heritage walk and e-book launch form part of its broader efforts to preserve Delhi's historical legacy while enhancing green public spaces and ensuring that the city's development remains balanced with its ecological and heritage character.

154 buses challaned, two impounded

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2 The Delhi Traffic Police challaned 154 buses and impounded two others during a special enforcement drive conducted across the city on October 1 to curb traffic violations and promote road safety. The drive focused on violations by buses, particularly dangerous and unauthorised driving practices that can pose risks to other road users and contribute to accidents and traffic congestion, the traffic police said. Enforcement teams carried out checks across various traffic circles and major roads in Delhi. — TNS

Haryana CM launches drive to clear 21 garbage hotspots

SUMEDHA SHARMA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

GURUGRAM, OCTOBER 2 Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday launched the “GVP Mukht Abhiyan”, a 10-day cleanliness drive aimed at clearing 21 garbage vulnerable points (GVPs) across Gurugram. The campaign, launched on the occasion of Gandhi Jayanti, is being undertaken by the Municipal Corporation of Gurugram (MCG).

Part of the “Swachhata Hi Seva 2026” initiative under the Seva Sankalp Abhiyan, the drive will run from October 2 to 11 under the slogan, “10 Din, 21 Kachra Bindu, Ek Gurugram”. To mark the launch, Saini inspected a GVP-free site developed by the MCG on

VULNERABLE POINTS CLEAN-UP SCHEDULE

- **October 2:** Near DHBVN Colony (Mehrauli Road), Sarhol
- **October 3:** Tikri, Sector 18
- **October 4:** Arbana Mall, Subhash Chowk
- **October 5:** Pace City-I, Gaushalia Ground
- **October 6:** Pace City, Singha Chowk
- **October 7-11:** Krishna Colony, near Megapolis Mall, near Indian Gas, Ghata, Banjara Market, Sector 37, Mohammad Heri Road, Daultabad Road, Sector 39, Ullawas and other identified locations.

Mehrauli Road near the DHBVN colony.

‘Citizens’ participation key’

Addressing residents, the Chief Minister said the government could provide infrastructure, facilities and modern technology, but citizens must take responsibility for segregating waste generated in homes and institutions.

He described government

systems, modern technology and public participation as the three pillars of the cleanliness campaign and said the objective was to transform it into a mass movement.

Saini urged residents not to dump garbage in the open, to segregate wet and dry waste at source, and to hand it over only to authorised collection vehicles. He said the initiative was

intended not only to clear existing garbage hotspots but also to prevent waste from accumulating again at the identified locations.

Call to RWAs and residents

The MCG has appealed to resident welfare associations (RWAs), shopkeepers, schools, youth groups and local residents to participate in the campaign and contribute shramdaan in their respective areas. The civic body’s message is to transform every “kachra bindu” into a “sundar bindu”.

Street-play artistes performed at the launch event to spread awareness about cleanliness and waste segregation. The Chief Minister and others present also took a cleanliness pledge.

Why accounts of 71 Gurugram builders have been frozen



EXPLAINER GURUGRAM

SUMEDHA SHARMA

THE Gurugram administration has frozen the bank accounts of 71 builders and promoters over unpaid HRERA dues, marking the district’s largest recovery action. Here is what you need to know about the action.

■ Why were the builders’ accounts frozen by HRERA?

The builders failed to pay penalties and refunds ordered by the Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority (HRERA), Gurugram. Recovery certificates worth Rs 446 crore were pending against them, with several of them due for more than four years.

■ How does a recovery certificate work?

When a builder misses a delivery deadline, HRERA levies a penalty, interest or compensation. If the builder does not pay, the authority issues a recovery certificate and sends it to the district administration. Under Section 40(1) of the RERA Act, 2016, the amount is recoverable as arrears of land revenue and payable to homebuyers. In Gurugram, this last step had stalled, leaving buyers who won recovery certificates with nothing in hand.

Recovery certificates worth ₹446 crore issued by HRERA pending against them



■ Which builder owes the most?

Ansal Housing and Ansal Construction Housing top the list with Rs 91 crore in dues. Raheja follows with Rs 90 crore; Vatika with Rs 80 crore; Parsvnath with Rs 74 crore; and Ramprastha with Rs 57 crore. IREO owes Rs 24 crore, while ILD Millennium owes Rs 8.59 crore.

■ What happens if the builders still do not clear their dues?

Notices have been issued asking the builders to deposit the outstanding amounts immediately. The administration has also begun attaching their movable and immovable properties under the Punjab Land Revenue Act, as applicable to Haryana. If dues are still not realised, officials can use further coercive powers under the land revenue law, including arrest and detention of default-

ers. Deputy Commissioner Uttam Singh said the regulator did its part by penalising builders, but the process remained toothless until the money reached the homebuyer. “No builder will be allowed to sit over amounts that lawfully belong to the homebuyers,” he said.

■ What should homebuyers do?

Homebuyers holding recovery certificates in their favour can contact the office of the District Revenue Officer or the SDM or tehsildar concerned to find out the status of their case. The DC has acknowledged that recovery had stalled in the past. The present action followed a complete review of all pending certificates. He will review progress every week, while SDMs and tehsildars have been directed to complete recovery within fixed timelines.

5 held for bid to kidnap youth over property dispute

SANJAY YADAV

GURUGRAM, OCTOBER 2

The police have arrested five men for allegedly attempting to kidnap a youth at gunpoint over a property dispute. The accused allegedly planned to abduct the victim to pressure his father into either cancelling a property deal or paying money.

According to the police, the incident occurred on September 21 outside Galleria Market. The victim had parked his car and gone to a café. When he returned and was about to get into his

vehicle, one man entered and sat in the front passenger seat, while two others occupied the rear seats. The man in the front allegedly pointed a pistol-like weapon at him and ordered him to accompany them.

When the victim resisted, the accused allegedly tried to fire at him, but the weapon failed to discharge. Showing presence of mind, the youth immediately drove the car forward. As the vehicle started moving, the two men seated in the rear jumped out and fled. A short distance ahead, the complainant was forced to

stop due to a scooter blocking the road. Taking advantage of the situation, the accused seated in the front also got out and escaped. However, the pistol, believed to be a country-made weapon, was left behind in the car.

Based on the victim’s complaint, an FIR was registered at Sector 29 police station.

During the investigation, a Crime Branch team from Sector 43 arrested five accused from Gurugram on Thursday.

The arrested men were identified as Praveen, Sumer Singh, Shiv Shankar, Aman

and Hemant.

The police said interrogation revealed that Praveen had entered into a property deal with the complainant’s father. However, the latter subsequently struck a deal for the same property with another person, leading to a dispute.

Investigators said Praveen developed a grudge and shared the matter with his associate, Sumer. The two allegedly conspired to kidnap the complainant and pressure his father to either complete the property transaction with them or pay money.

FROM PAGE 1

Over 1,000...

11 stations remaining closed, while another announcement put the number at 12. The stations were later opened,

Traffic movement was also regulated around Connaught Place, GPO, Barakhamba Road, Tolstoy Marg, Sansad Marg, Patel Chowk and Ashoka Road. Public vehicles were stopped from entering Ashoka Road, Jantar Mantar Road and Sansad Marg, while commuters were advised to take alternative routes.

Internet services were shut down in and around Connaught Place and Jantar Mantar by the Delhi Police. The disruption affected entire Connaught Place, visitors and gig workers who were trying to process UPI payments.

N Sai Balaji said, “We conducted reces and shortlisted a few routes, but they kept getting closed off during the day. We eventually decided to march from the Vice-President’s enclave.” He said the marching crowd had reached at least 350 people before detentions began.

Several protesters gathered near Kerala House after roads leading to Jantar Mantar were barricaded. Some were dragged into police buses as they attempted to move forward. AAP leaders Atishi, Saurabh Bhardwaj and Sanjay Singh were detained separately while trying to march towards the protest site.

RJD MP Manoj K Jha, while being detained, said, “Today is Gandhi Jayanti. It is shameful that they are behaving like this... This is all ‘Godse-vadi’ people can do on Gandhi Jayanti. They don’t understand the essence of Gandhi.”

A protester detained from Tolstoy Marg told The Tribune that a woman member of the Disha Students’ Organisation was taken into a bus with other activists. The protester alleged that there were initially no women police personnel in the bus and said the detainees were taken to Maidangarhi village, where they were asked for their names, addresses and phone numbers. A woman

police officer later arrived, the protester said. This female protester was released at 8:30 pm.

AAP leaders...

but why would the government grant permission for a protest against itself? Jantar Mantar is a designated site for protests where no separate permission is required. Even then, the AAP formally informed the police and submitted an application around 6 days ago.”

He said, “There are around 10 to 15 police personnel, along with the SHO, sitting outside my house. I sent them a message and also made a video in the morning informing them that I am not at home, so they should carry out their duty, but they have continued to remain there. The house of Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh has been placed under the watch of the CRPF and the Delhi Police, while cops have also been deployed outside the homes of other leaders.”

Atishi said, “We were holding a peaceful protest at Jantar Mantar to protect the country’s democracy and our right to vote. PM Modi’s Delhi Police detained us from Jantar Mantar. From there, they kept AAP leaders and workers in detention at the Fatehpur Beri police station. The fight against ‘vote chori’ will continue. The system in the Election Commission will have to be set right, and Gyanesh Kumar will have to resign. ‘Vote chori’ will not be allowed.”

July protest...

protesters managing to cross barricades and reach the area around Ashoka Road. On Friday, the SIR protesters were stopped on the routes leading to Jantar Mantar itself.

Two protests also differed in their immediate police response. While the July mobilisation saw protesters breaking through barricades as they moved towards Parliament, Friday’s deployment focused on preventing the gathering from reaching its proposed site.

Delhi BJP...

Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra alleged that the protest at Jantar Mantar was not about protecting the right to vote but an attempt to conceal what he described as AAP’s “potential defeat” in Punjab. His remarks came as opposition parties, student groups and civil society organisations gathered in Delhi on Friday.

Malhotra alleged that the AAP-led protest failed to draw ordinary Delhi residents and youth and claimed that around 500-600 party workers and leaders participated. He also accused the protesters of disrupting traffic and Metro services.

Malhotra also targeted the protest organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) in Mumbai, questioning the organisation’s political relevance. He alleged that the protests were being used to shift attention from unemployment and law-and-order issues in Punjab.

“The BJP has always stood firm in defending the right to vote,” Malhotra said, adding that the right to vote did not give anyone the licence to spread what he described as falsehoods or attack institutions.

Delhi BJP spokesperson Praveen Shankar Kapoor separately alleged that the AAP protest reflected “political frustration” and claimed that the party had failed to attract ordinary youth and Delhi residents.

Kapoor alleged that AAP leaders were blaming the Election Commission over the SIR exercise instead of addressing corruption in Punjab. He also claimed that the party was concerned about its electoral prospects in Punjab and Goa and the possibility of losing its national party status.

A first: PUC ...

same time and PUC certificates to be issued.

The move will also benefit buses arriving in Delhi from other states. Drivers will be able to get their vehicles tested at the bus terminals and

obtain pollution certificates. At present, some buses enter Delhi without a pollution certificate.

The proposed centres are part of the Delhi Government’s plan to increase access to pollution testing facilities across the capital. The multi-lane system will allow more vehicles to be checked at a time.

Student, youth...

The NSUI separately organised a march from its headquarters at 5 Raisina Road towards Jantar Mantar. Its national president Vinod Jakhar was detained along with hundreds of NSUI members after the police barricaded the route, the organisation said.

Addressing protesters before his detention, Jakhar said, “Today, the message from the NSUI is clear - CEC Gyanesh Kumar must resign and face arrest. You may detain hundreds of students, but you cannot detain the voice of democracy.”

The student organisations alleged that the SIR exercise could exclude sections of the population from the electoral rolls and demanded greater transparency and accountability in the electoral process. They particularly raised concerns about its possible impact on marginalised communities and voters whose names or documents may face scrutiny during the revision exercise.

Delhi cops...

Special Judge Prashant Sharma, while dealing with the defence submissions, had observed, “At this stage, I find that for the purpose of completion of investigation, further judicial custody of accused persons is required.” The court had also taken into account the contents of previous orders under which the accused had been sent to police custody.

The Delhi Police had earlier sought custodial interrogation of Khatri on August 26, stating that investigators needed to analyse around 100 GB of data extracted from the phone of one of the accused.

The police also referred to questioning by the Intelligence Bureau (IB) and the National Investigation Agency (NIA).

Khatri had been apprehended at the Indira Gandhi International Airport on August 25 after a lookout circular was issued against him.

After 9-yr wait...

not immediately remove the congestion. Traffic continued to build at the points where vehicles were required to merge with existing flows.

The issue is particularly clear at the Suryaghadi junction. Traffic entering from Phase III does not enter an empty road. It joins a system that is already handling several major movements. When multiple streams converge at the same point, vehicles have to change lanes, merge and negotiate limited road space. Even if the upstream road has more lanes, the effective throughput is restricted by the downstream bottleneck.

The Ashram end presents a similar challenge. Traffic from the DND, Sarai Kale Khan and the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway already converges in the area. Phase III adds another movement to this network. Instead of eliminating a conflict point, the project has therefore added traffic to an already heavily loaded part of the road system.

The authorities have begun examining changes to the traffic arrangement, including the possibility of altering the Suryaghadi movement and directly linking Phase III traffic with Phase I. Barricades have also been used near the Mayur Vihar end to regulate the volume entering the corridor. For now, the early traffic pattern suggests that the problem is not simply a lack of road space on Phase III. It is the capacity of the connections around it. The elevated road has added a faster route, but its benefit depends on whether the bottlenecks beyond it can handle the traffic that the new route is designed to bring.

Safety audit finds 190 high-risk parks

ANSHITA MEHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 2

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has completed a safety audit of all 736 parks under its jurisdiction following directions from Lt Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu. Based on the findings, 190 parks have been categorised as high-risk, 258 as medium-risk and 288 as low-risk, paving the way for priority-based interventions.

The DDA said immediate measures are being implemented in high-risk parks, including improved lighting,

enhanced security arrangements and increased night patrolling.

The audit identified 520 parks requiring additional lighting. Work has been taken up on priority in 231 parks, while lighting installations have already been completed in 106 parks following the audit conducted last week.

The authority has also identified 163 parks where gates need strengthening, with unlockable gates being converted into lockable ones. Safety information boards have been installed in 115 parks, and

work on 484 additional signages is under way.

At present, CCTV surveillance is available in only 16 parks. Following the audit, 323 more parks have been identified for the installation of CCTV cameras.

The audit also highlighted boundary-related vulnerabilities. Repair and missing-grill work has been completed in 233 of the 399 parks identified for such interventions. Corrective measures have also been planned around toilets and abandoned structures.

Year on, auto service hubs yet to get green approval

Pollution control board has made environmental consent compulsory for service centres

SUMEDHA SHARMA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

GURUGRAM, OCTOBER 2

More than a year after the Haryana State Pollution Control Board (HSPCB) made environmental consent compulsory for automobile service centres, a majority of an estimated 5,000 such units across Gurugram, Faridabad and Rewari still operate without a green nod. Apparently, there have been very few inspections to enforce the norms.

In a policy order dated August 1, 2025, the board placed automobile service stations and workshops in the orange category. This means each unit must obtain Consent to Establish (CTE) and Consent to Operate (CTO) under the Air and Water Acts. It must also obtain authorisation under the Hazardous and Other Wastes (Management and Transboundary Movement) Rules, 2016. Operating without these approvals is a violation of norms and can lead to closure, prosecution and environmental compensation.

The orange label reflects moderate pollution potential, but the numbers add up. A service centre handles used engine oil, grease, spent coolant, brake fluid, discarded lead-acid batteries,

oil-soaked rags and filters. Washing bays add detergent-laden wastewater, and painting and denting units add paint residue and solvents. If untreated effluent flows into drains or open land, it can contaminate groundwater and choke storm water channels.

The risk is most acute in Gurugram and Faridabad, where thousands of garages, vehicle dealerships and washing outlets operate amid already overexploited groundwater reserves. Rewari’s industrial belt, including Dharuhera and Bawal, further compounds the problem. Hazardous waste such as used oil and batteries needs authorised handling, a step unauthorised units skip altogether.

Haryana Industries and Environment Minister Rao Narbir Singh acknowledged the gap. “We will soon be launching a drive to identify and nail erring service centres,” he said.

“It has been brought to my notice that even the big names have failed to get the environment clearance, and the major-

ity claim ignorance about it,” he added. While Gurugram and Faridabad remain in deep slumber, environment activists in Rewari are taking the lead.

Acting on a grievance filed on the CM Window by Kharkhara resident Parkash Yadav on July 31, 2026, HSPCB’s regional office inspected Neeraj Auto Care in Dharuhera on September 1. It found the unit operating “illegally” without CTE, CTO or hazardous waste authorisation. The inspection brought to the fore a bigger menace rampant across such centres, many of which operate even within auto manufacturing units.

The complainant has separately questioned an RTI reply from the board’s Rewari office dated July 22. He said it gave limited figures on service stations and showed no clear action against unpermitted units. He has sought a district-wide survey of service centres, washing units and workshops, and a check on commercial use of domestic water connections and unauthorised borewells.

SALMAN BACKS PREM KEETANU



Salman Khan attended the Mumbai screening of Prem Keetanu supporting actors Veer Pahariya and Aafiya Sayed ahead of its release. The superstar greeted and hugged the newcomers, while patiently posing for paparazzi. The romantic comedy released nationwide on October 2.

Tribune Life

Style

DELHI | SATURDAY | 3 OCTOBER 2026

Courageous

Varun Dhawan has praised Captain Smit Machchhar for his courage during the Fly-Dubai mid-air crisis. "Salute to our Capt. Smit Machchhar. Your courage and bravery fills all of us with pride," he wrote.



WHAT'S HOT

eat

GO SAATVIK

ENJOY the Saatvik Bhoj Navratri Thali at 24/7 and Baluchi at The Lalit. Available from October 11 to 19, from 12 noon to 11 pm. Indulge in a thoughtfully curated spread of festive, saatvik flavours, crafted especially for the Navratri season. Price: ₹999.



play

IT'S A DREAM!

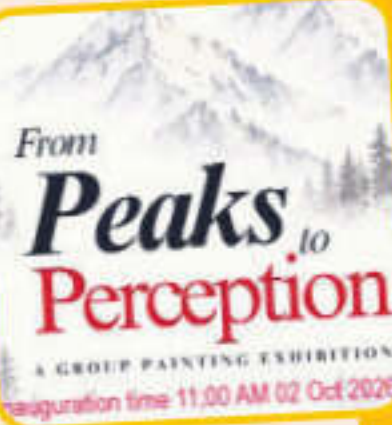
JASMINE Sandlas brings her Dream Girl India Tour to Mohali for an epic musical journey of soulful melodies and powerhouse Punjabi hits. Expect raw energy, bold vocals and back-to-back bangers, with fans singing along to every word. Catch her at the Outside Arena, CP67 Mall, Mohali, on October 10.



IOVE

DIFFERENT STROKES

THE University Institute of Film and Visual Arts (UIFVA), in collaboration with five noted artists from Punjab and Himachal Pradesh, presents From Peaks to Perception, a group painting exhibition showcasing nearly 80 works under one roof. The exhibition is on display at Punjab Kala Bhawan, Sector 16, Chandigarh, until October 5, 2026.



MONA

FOR nearly 25 years, Dr Mandeep Garg has been a part of the world of medicine at the Post Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research (PGIMER), Chandigarh. A radiologist by profession, he has spent most of his adult life immersed in the demanding world of medicine.

Now, he is stepping into an entirely different world — the movies.

Garg makes his acting debut with the Punjabi film The Last Treatment, a suspense thriller in which he plays a renowned surgeon caught in a moral dilemma. For someone who has spent decades navigating medicine, playing a doctor on screen has been an unexpected yet deeply personal journey.

FROM STAGE TO SCREEN

Dr Garg is originally from Bandi, a small village in Bathinda district. He completed his primary schooling there before moving to Bathinda and eventually Chandigarh. After his MBBS from Government Medical College, Faridkot, he pursued his MD and further training in radiology at PGI, including three years of senior residency, before joining the faculty.

But alongside medicine was another side of his personality. During school and college, Garg participated in stage performances and hosted events. He also had a brief stint in modelling. "There was always something burning deep inside me — a flair for acting," he recalls. Medicine eventually took over, but he never wanted to abandon that creative instinct.

FROM DUBAI TO A FILM SET

His entry into cinema came by chance. About two years ago, Garg was approached by a Bollywood production team for a music video for a legendary singer. He travelled to Dubai for the shoot, but the song was eventually held up by copyright issues and never released. The experience, however, opened another door. Members of the crew noticed his screen presence and later approached him for a film. "I just grabbed the opportunity." That opportunity became The Last Treatment.

After nearly 25 years as a radiologist at PGIMER, Dr Mandeep Garg makes his acting debut as a surgeon facing a moral dilemma in the Punjabi suspense thriller The Last Treatment



BALANCING BOTH WORLDS

Taking on a lead role did not mean stepping away from medicine. Instead, the film had to fit around his professional commitments. A substantial portion was shot during his summer vacation, while the remaining scenes were completed during his winter break. For Garg, medicine and acting represent two very different but equally meaningful parts of his life. He credits medicine with giving him his identity, respect and social recognition, while acting has allowed him to keep alive a passion he has carried since childhood.

DOCTOR CAUGHT IN MORAL DILEMMA

While the film is a crime thriller, Dr Garg says its emotional heart lies in the relationship between a father and daughter. The story follows an ethical doctor who finds himself trapped in circumstances where protecting his family could mean compromising his principles. "How he survives through it — that is what you have to watch in the movie," Garg says.

His medical background naturally gave him familiarity with the professional environment portrayed on screen. But he approached the role as an actor, describing Dr Raman Kataria as a gentle and refined character.

WHEN MEDICINE MEETS CINEMA

Medical thrillers often portray hospitals, pharmaceutical companies and doctors through stories of corruption and ethical compromises. As someone who actually works in the medical profession, Garg believes such films inevitably draw from real-life situations, even as filmmakers dramatise them for entertainment. "At the end of the day, it is commercial cinema," he says. For him, cinema borrows from everyday life but adds twists and dramatic elements to make those stories engaging for audiences.

LEARNING FROM THE VETERANS

As a first-time actor, Garg says working with experienced Punjabi performers was an important part of the journey. "When you work with experienced actors like Hobby Dhalliwal, you learn a lot," he says. Their presence, he adds, also motivated him to raise his own performance.

COMING HOME TO PUNJABI CINEMA

Dr Garg's family has been central to his new journey. His wife, a dermatologist, has supported him throughout the process, making personal sacrifices along the way.

A real doctor, playing a reel one, though one whose ethics are tested in circumstances far removed from his own professional life...

The Last Treatment releases on Chaupal on October 3.



Manoj Tiwari returns to Ramlila stage

The actor-singer and politician turns Kewat as Luv Kush Ramlila goes hi-tech

ANSHITA MEHRA

This Dussehra, Manoj Tiwari will trade the political stage for the Ramlila stage, stepping into the role of Kewat at the Luv Kush Ramlila. The actor-singer and BJP MP, who has previously played Parshuram and Angad, will portray the boatman who helps Lord Ram, Sita and Lakshman cross the river, performing the sequence with songs in his own voice.

For Tiwari, the role also continues a childhood association with the tradition. "My good fortune is that I have been associated with Ramlila in my village since childhood, and that tradition continues even today," he said.

The role is part of an ambitious 2026 production that seeks to bring together the traditional Ramayana narrative

with film-style technology and large-scale visual effects at the Red Fort grounds.

Luv Kush Ramlila Committee president Arjun Kumar said the production would use technology to create a more immersive presentation. "This time, you will see many new things. We are using AI, 3D mapping, visual effects and other new technologies to present the Leela in a new way."

The committee said this year's production will also feature an eight-track digital sound system. Around 50 film-industry artists will join nearly 250 local performers from Delhi, while costumes and make-up are being handled by artists from Mumbai's film industry.

The stage itself will be 150 feet long, 60 feet wide and 45 feet high. One of its key

attractions will be a large Meenakshi Devi temple-inspired set, created with the involvement of artists from Hyderabad, Kolkata, Mathura, Vrindavan and Delhi. The structure will feature handcrafted detailing and lakhs of LEDs, with the action unfolding across three levels.

The organisers are also taking the action into the air. Two large cranes will be used for aerial sequences, including a presentation of Hanuman flying around 250 feet above the ground with Ram and Lakshman on his shoulders. The Sita Haran sequence will also be staged at height. The Ram-Ravan battle, meanwhile, will use 3D mapping, simulated sparks and lighting effects to heighten the spectacle.

The celebrations begin before the main Ramlila. On October 9, school students from Delhi-NCR will present the complete Ramayana, followed by a devotional programme and Bhajan Sandhya on October 10. The main Ramlila will run from October 11 to 21, with Dussehra and the burning of Ravan, Kumbhakarna and Meghnath scheduled for October 20. The festivities will conclude with Bharat Milap and Ram's coronation on October 21.

The committee is also giving this year's edition an environmental and youth-focused touch with the slogan, "Ghar Ghar Ram, Ghar Ghar Tulsi". It plans to distribute 5,100 tulsi plants. Tiwari's return adds a familiar face to a production that is looking firmly towards the future, using technology to reimagine one of India's oldest performance traditions.

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'A very special moment in my journey'

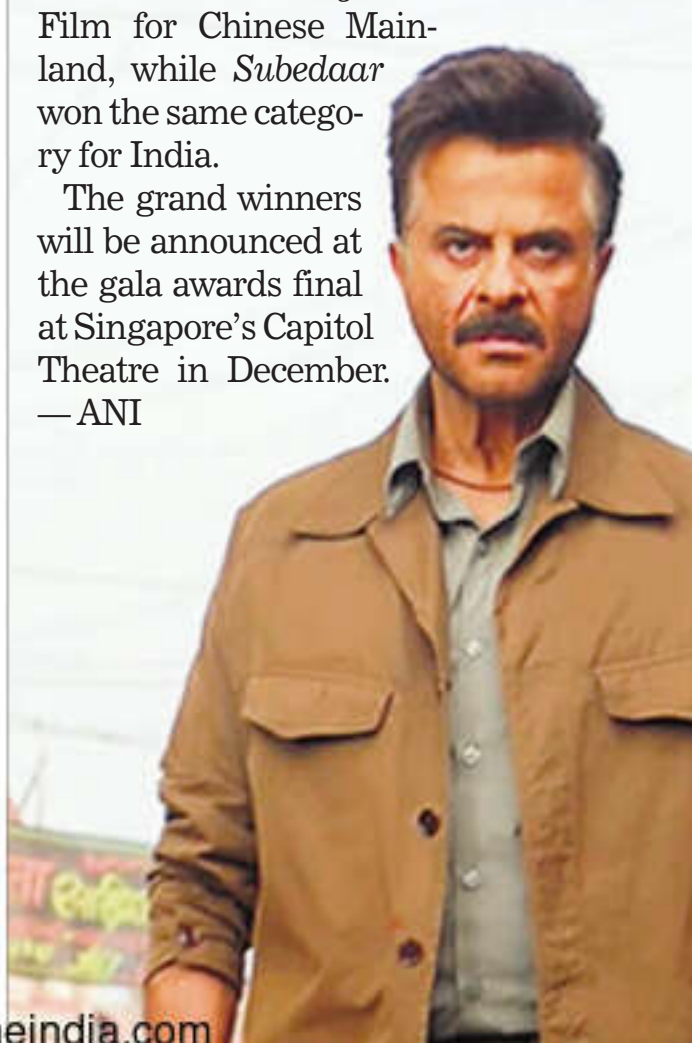
Anil Kapoor's Subedaar has won Best Feature Film for India at the Asian Academy Creative Awards, while the actor has been nominated in the Best Actor in a Leading Role category for his performance in the movie.

Kapoor plays retired soldier Subedaar Arjun Maurya in Suresh Triveni's action-drama. "A very special moment in my journey. Honoured to be nominated for Best Actor in a Leading Role for Subedaar at the @asianacademycreativeawards, representing India. Grateful to the entire team and everyone who has supported the film," he wrote. Subedaar was released on Amazon Prime Video on March 5.

Meanwhile, films fronted by international star Jackie Chan and Kapoor were among the 335 national winners announced by the Asian Academy Creative Awards.

The Shadow's Edge won Best Feature Film for Chinese Mainland, while Subedaar won the same category for India.

The grand winners will be announced at the gala awards final at Singapore's Capitol Theatre in December. — ANI



CHAT UP

TRIBUTE TO MAHATMA GANDHI

Students of sand artist Sudarsan Pattanaik's Sand Art Institute created a sand animation in Puri on the occasion of Gandhi Jayanti on Friday. The artwork also showcased the students' ability to create a sand-based animation within a short period, with the student highlighting that the work took around 30 minutes to complete.



OLIVIER ACCUSES HALLE BERRY

Halle Berry has been accused of physically abusing her 12-year-old son by her ex-husband Olivier Martinez, who has filed a petition seeking a temporary restraining order against the actress and sole custody of their son. Martinez alleges that on September 26, Berry "physically abused our son Maceo, by jumping on him, putting her hands around his neck choking him."



LIFETIME AWARD FOR JULIANNE MOORE

Oscar-winning actress Julianne Moore will receive the Lifetime Achievement Award at the 21st edition of the Rome Film Fest, which is set to take place from October 13 to 25. Moore will be honoured during the Rome screening of her new film The Debut, which is part of the festival's Grand Public section.



BIG B SUFFERS KNEE INJURY

Amitabh Bachchan recently revealed that he suffered a knee injury while shooting for Kaun Banega Crorepati 18. "Godwa mei humara chot lag gaya hai. Kyu bataye bhaaisahab. Kal shooting shooting mei fisal gawa paa, gire dhadam se... (I've hurt my knee. What can I say? Yesterday, while shooting, my foot slipped, and I fell down with a thud)," he said.



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